



ENGLISH

Senior FIVE



Student's Book

Copyright Page

© 2025 Rwanda Basic Education Board

All rights reserved.

This book is the property of the government of Rwanda.
Credit must be provided to REB when the content is quoted.

FOREWORD

Dear Students,

The Rwanda Education Board is honoured to present the **Senior Five English Student's Book**, which serves as a guide to competence-based teaching and learning. It is designed to ensure consistency and coherence in the teaching and learning of English at Senior Five level. Rwanda's educational philosophy aims to help you achieve your full potential at every level of education, preparing you to integrate successfully into society and take advantage of employment opportunities.

As part of ongoing efforts to improve the quality of education, the Government of Rwanda emphasises the importance of aligning teaching and learning materials with the syllabus to facilitate the learning process. Many factors influence what you learn, how effectively you learn, and the competences you acquire. These factors include the relevance of the content, the quality of teachers' pedagogical approaches, the assessment strategies used, and the instructional materials available.

Special attention has been given to activities that support the learning process and enable you to develop your ideas and make new discoveries through practical tasks carried out individually or with your peers. With the support of your teachers, whose role is central to successful learning, you will acquire appropriate skills and learn how to apply them in real-life situations. This will help you develop positive values and attitudes that will enable you to improve your own life and contribute to national development.

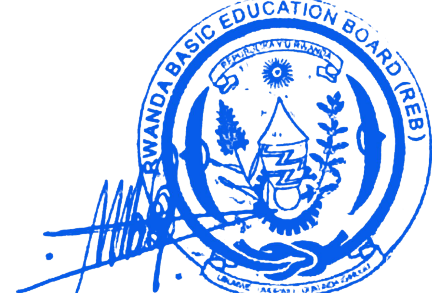
This approach differs from traditional learning theories, which view learning mainly as the process of receiving knowledge from a more knowledgeable person, usually the teacher. In the competence-based curriculum, learning is considered an active process through which learners construct and develop knowledge and meaning. Concepts are mainly introduced through activities, situations, or scenarios that help learners acquire knowledge, develop skills, and adopt positive attitudes and values.

Active learning engages you in carrying out tasks and reflecting on what you are doing. You are also encouraged to bring your own experiences and prior knowledge into the learning process. To use this textbook effectively, you are expected to:

- Develop knowledge and skills by completing the activities provided;
- Communicate and share relevant information with other learners through presentations, discussions, group work, role plays, case studies, investigations, and research conducted in the library, online, or outside the classroom;
- Participate actively and take responsibility for your own learning;
- Carry out research and investigations by consulting printed and online resources and knowledgeable people, and present your findings;
- Ensure that every group member contributes effectively to assigned tasks through clear explanations, well-supported arguments, critical thinking, responsibility, and confidence in public speaking; and
- Draw appropriate conclusions from the findings of learning activities.

I sincerely extend my appreciation to everyone who contributed to the development of this textbook, particularly the Rwanda Education Board staff who organised and coordinated the process from its inception. Special appreciation also goes to the teachers who supported the development process throughout.

Comments and contributions that may help improve this textbook in future editions are welcome.



Dr. MBARUSHIMANA Nelson

Director General

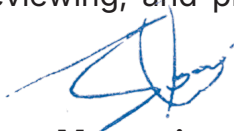
ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I wish to express my sincere appreciation to all the individuals and institutions that played a significant role in the development of this Senior Five English Student's Book. Its successful completion would not have been possible without the active participation, commitment, and valuable contributions of various education stakeholders.

I am deeply grateful to the curriculum specialists, English language teachers, content developers, editors, illustrators, and reviewers whose knowledge, experience, and dedication contributed to the preparation and improvement of this textbook.

Special acknowledgement goes to the education partners and institutions that provided technical guidance, professional expertise, and constructive feedback throughout the development process.

Finally, I extend my sincere gratitude to the staff of the Rwanda Education Board, particularly those from the Curriculum, Teaching and Learning Resources Department, who coordinated and participated in the entire process of writing, reviewing, and producing this textbook.



Joan Murungi,

Head of Curriculum, Teaching and Learning Resources Department/REB

Table of Contents

FOREWORD	iii
ACKNOWLEDGEMENT	v
PATRIOTISM.....	1
Introduction	2
1.1: Patriotism towards one's country	2
1.2. Listening: Talking about youth participation in nation-building	7
1.3.Speaking: Talking about patriotic values	10
1.4. Language structure	11
1.5. Speech Writing and delivery.....	21
1.6 End of unit assessment.....	24
ANTI-SOCIAL BEHAVIOURS	27
Introduction.....	28
2.1. Causes And Impacts Of Anti-Social Behaviours	28
2.2: Listening: Avoiding Anti-Social Behaviours.....	36
2.3: Speaking: Anti-Social Behaviour Prevention	39
2.4: Language Structure	41
2.5. Debate.....	49
2.6. Argumentative Writing	53
2.7. Writing Formal Communications For Community Issues	57
2.8.End Of Unit Assessment	60
FRIENDSHIP AND VALUES.....	64
Introduction.....	65
3.1: Values In Friendship	65
3.2. Speaking: Traditional Vs Modern Values (Speaking)Learning	68
3.3.Listening: Importance Of Friendship	69
3.4 Language Structure	71
3.5: Literature	77
3.6. Creative Writing	92
3.7 End Of Unit Assessment	93

JUSTICE AND HUMAN DIGNITY.....	96
Introduction.....	97
4.1. Justice, Corruption And Human Rights.....	97
4.2. Listening.: Facing Injustice	101
4.3.Speaking: Fighting Injustice (Dramatic Performance)	103
4.4. Language Structures	105
4.5 Literature: Key Features In African Drama	111
4.6 End Of Unit Assessment.....	114
TRADITIONS AND CHANGE.....	118
Introduction.....	119
5.1. Cultural practices	119
5.2. Listening: Cultural Change	125
5.3.Speaking: Traditional beliefs and change.....	127
5.4. Language Structures	127
5.5 Literature: African Literary Traditions Across Three Periods (precolonial, colonial and post-colonial)	131
5.6 Writing	138
5.7 End of Unit Assessment	139
ENVIRONMENT	143
Introduction.....	144
6.1. Talking about environmental protection.....	145
6.3. Speaking: Talking about Climate Change and Environmental Conservation.....	150
6.4. Language Structure	151
6.5. Writing: Official Documents.....	156
6.6 End-of-Unit -assessment:	165
TECHNOLOGY	168
Introduction.....	169
7.1. Talking about digital innovations	169
7.2. Speaking: Pros and cons of the use of Artificial intelligence (AI) in education.	174
7.3. Listening: Talking about online safety	175
7.4. Language Structure	177
7.5. Literature Focus: Non-Fiction	181
7.6. End of Unit Assessment.....	184

MEDIA AND DIGITAL COMMUNICATION.....	186
Introduction.....	187
8.1. Social Media Influence.....	187
8.2. Listening: Media Bias	191
8.3. Speaking: Misinformation And Responsible Communication	192
8.4. Language Structures	194
8.5. Media Types And Digital Content Creation	212
8.6. End-Of-Unit Assessment.....	216
 GENDER EQUITY AND EMPOWERMENT	 225
Introduction	226
9.1. Gender roles	226
9.2. Speaking: Equal opportunities	229
9.3. Listening: Combating discrimination	230
9.4 Language Structure	232
9.5 Literature	238
9.6. End of Unit Assessment	240

UNIT 1

PATRIOTISM



Key Unit Competence:

Critically analyse and communicate ideas related to patriotism, citizenship, and national development through oral and written texts.

Learning objectives

By the end of this unit, you will be able to:

Knowledge and understanding

1

1. Explain the concept of patriotism and its importance in national development.
2. Identify the key features, structure, and language commonly used in speeches and public addresses.
3. Recognize and use appropriate grammatical structures (tenses, modals, conditionals, relative clauses, reported speech) in patriotic contexts.

Skills

2

1. Interpret patriotic texts and speeches.
2. Write and deliver effective patriotic speeches.
3. Listen to and summarise speeches, identifying key ideas and persuasive techniques.
4. Apply correct grammar in speech writing and oral communication.

Attitudes and values

3

1. Show love, loyalty, and pride toward their country.
2. Demonstrate unity, respect, and civic responsibility in school and community.
3. Develop confidence, discipline, and honesty in communication.

Introduction

Introductory activity

Introductory activity



A group of Senior 5 students from Rwanda is selected to participate in an **International Youth Innovation Competition**. During the event, each team must design a campaign to promote their country to the world.

While preparing their presentation, the students disagree about what they should present.

1. **Aline** suggests focusing on modern achievements such as technology, business, and Rwanda's role in global cooperation.
2. **Eric** argues that they should present traditional culture, national symbols, and heritage because these represent the country's identity.
3. **Grace** thinks they should focus on global issues such as climate change and human rights to show that Rwanda's youth are responsible global citizens.

The team has limited time and can only focus on **one main theme** for their presentation. Each student strongly believes that their idea is the best way to represent Rwanda.

Discussion questions

- If you were a member of this team, which idea would you support and why? Think about:
- What should be more important when representing a country: tradition, modern achievements, or global responsibility? Explain.
- Can a country promote its national identity while also being part of the global community? How?
- What role should young people play in promoting their country's image to the world?

1.1: Patriotism towards one's country

Learning activities 1.1

A. Reading

Learning activity 1.1.1



Take a moment to think about this question, then share your ideas with others.

1. What comes to your mind when you hear the word **patriotism**?

Activity 1.1.2



Reading comprehension

The local leader is addressing students in a school. Read the speech carefully to identify the advice on how young people can become responsible citizens.



Dear students,

It is always a privilege to stand before young citizens who represent the energy, creativity, and promise of our nation. When I look at you, I do not simply see students preparing for examinations; I see the generation that will shape the Rwanda of tomorrow. The future of a country is not decided only in government offices or international meetings. In many ways, it is decided in classrooms, communities, and in the minds of young people who are willing to imagine a better future.

Rwanda's journey has not been easy. Our history reminds us that nations are not built by chance or by luck. They are built through sacrifice, resilience, and determination. The Rwanda we see today is the result of citizens who believed that our country could rise again with dignity and hope.

Because of this history, patriotism is not an abstract concept for us. It is a responsibility that each generation must carry forward. Patriotism means more than expressing love for one's country through words or symbols. Of course, national symbols such as the flag or the national anthem are important because they represent our shared identity.

However, **true patriotism is demonstrated through actions.**

True patriotism asks us difficult questions:

What contribution am I making to my country?

How can my knowledge, my skills, and my character help my community and my nation?

A nation is not simply a piece of land or a collection of institutions. A nation is its people. It is built by citizens who take responsibility for the wellbeing of their society. In other words, **the strength of Rwanda lies in the choices and actions of its citizens.**

Young people have a particularly important role in this process. You possess qualities that are essential for progress: curiosity, creativity, courage, and the willingness to question existing ideas. These qualities can drive innovation and positive change. However, talent and intelligence alone are not enough. For talent to make a difference, it must be guided by discipline, integrity, and a strong sense of purpose.

Education therefore plays a crucial role in shaping the future of our nation. Education should not only prepare students to pass examinations or obtain certificates. Its deeper purpose is to develop critical thinkers, responsible citizens, and individuals who are capable of solving real problems in society. A well-educated generation is the greatest asset that any nation can possess.

At the same time, we live in a rapidly changing world. Globalization has connected societies in ways that were unimaginable in the past. Today, young people communicate with others across continents, exchange ideas through technology, and learn about cultures far beyond their own communities.

This global interaction brings many opportunities. It allows us to learn from others, adopt useful innovations, and participate in international cooperation. However, it also raises an important challenge: **how can we engage with the global community while preserving our national identity?**

The answer lies in confidence. A confident nation is one that can open itself to the world while remaining firmly rooted in its values. Our culture, language, and traditions are not barriers to development; they are the foundation upon which development can be built.

There is a wise saying that reminds us: *a tree that forgets its roots cannot stand strong.* In the same way, a nation that forgets its identity risks losing the very values that give it strength.

This does not mean rejecting the outside world. On the contrary, it means engaging with the world thoughtfully and responsibly. We should learn from others while also sharing the strengths of our own culture and experience.

Young people therefore have an important role to play as ambassadors of their nation. Whether you are studying, working, or travelling abroad, you represent your country. Your behaviour, your values, and your achievements shape how others see Rwanda.

This is why character matters as much as knowledge. A nation's reputation is built not only through economic growth or technological progress but also through the integrity and responsibility of its citizens.

Let me therefore ask you a question: **What kind of citizens do you want to become?**

Will you be citizens who simply observe problems and complain about them?
Or will you be citizens who take initiative and search for solutions?

Will you wait for change to come from others?

Or will you become the generation that creates change?

The future of Rwanda will not be built by speeches alone. It will be built through daily actions — by students who study seriously, by citizens who respect the law, by communities that work together, and by leaders who serve with integrity.

Nation-building is not a short journey. It requires patience, cooperation, and a long-term vision. But if each generation accepts its responsibility and contributes its best efforts, progress becomes inevitable.

I believe strongly in the capacity of Rwanda's youth. Your ideas, your creativity, and your determination can help solve the challenges of today and shape the opportunities of tomorrow.

Remember that the Rwanda we dream about will not appear by magic. It will be created by your work, your character, and your commitment to serve your nation with honesty and pride.

You are not only the leaders of tomorrow. **You are also the builders of today.**

Thank you.

B. Vocabulary

Activity 1.1.3.

I. MATCH EACH WORD/PHRASE IN COLUMN ONE WITH ITS ACCURATE MEANING IN COLUMN TWO BASED ON THE ABOVE SPEECH:

Word/Phrase	Definition
1. Resilience	a) The ability to recover from difficulties
2. Integrity	b) Moral honesty and strength of character
3. Discipline	c) Control over one's actions and behaviour
4. Global interaction	d) Contact and communication between people from different countries
5. Patriotism	e) Love for and commitment to one's country
6. Initiative	f) Readiness to act or take the lead without being told
7. Sacrifice	g) Willingness to give up something for a greater good

II. REPLACE THE HIGHLIGHTED WORD WITH A MORE ADVANCED SYNONYM FROM THE BOX:

Commitment *perseverance* *accountability* *vision* *engagement*

- a) Nation-building requires long-term **effort**.
- b) Citizens must take **responsibility** for their actions.
- c) Young people should show **involvement** in their communities.
- d) Leaders need a clear **plan for the future**.

III. REWRITE AND COMPLETE EACH SENTENCE BY FILLING IN THE BLANK WITH AN APPROPRIATE WORD OR PHRASE TAKEN FROM THE SPEECH.

- a) Young people can help bring positive change.
→ Young people can _____ positive change.
- b) A country depends on its people.
→ The strength of a nation _____ its citizens.
- c) Education helps people think critically.
→ Education develops _____.
- d) We must interact with other countries carefully.
→ We must engage with the global community _____.

IV. USE CONTEXT TO GUESS THE MEANING OF THE UNDERLINED WORDS/ PHRASES:

- "Patriotism means more than expressing love for one's country through words or symbols."
- "Globalization has connected societies in ways that were unimaginable in the past."
- "Education should develop critical thinkers, responsible citizens, and individuals capable of solving real problems in society."
- "A confident nation is one that can open itself to the world while remaining firmly rooted in its values."

C. Comprehension questions

Learning activity 1.1.4



Re-read the above text and answer the following questions

1. The speaker claims "The future of a country is not decided only in government offices or international meetings." What does this imply about the role of ordinary citizens, especially young people?

2. Why does the speaker describe patriotism as “not an abstract concept” for Rwanda?
3. According to the speech, why are talent and intelligence alone insufficient for national progress?
4. What is the significance of the saying: “*a tree that forgets its roots cannot stand strong*” in the context of nation-building?
5. The speaker repeatedly asks questions to the audience, e.g., “*Will you wait for change to come from others?*” What is the purpose of using these rhetorical questions?
6. How does the speech connect education to the responsibilities of citizens?
7. What challenge does globalization pose according to the speaker, and how should young people respond?
8. How does the speaker link **character** to a nation’s reputation?

Application activity 1.1



A. Write a short paragraph (120–150 words) explaining how young people can contribute to nation-building. In your response, use at least five of the following words: **resilience, integrity, innovation, globalization, identity, commitment, responsibility.**

B. Summarise the speech in about 100 words, highlighting the role of young people in nation-building, the importance of character and education, and the balance between globalization and patriotism.

1.2. Listening: Talking about youth participation in nation-building

Learning activities 1.2

Learning activity 1.2.1



In every nation, the strength of patriotism is reflected not only in words, but in the active participation of its citizens, especially the youth, whose ideas, energy, and commitment play a crucial role in shaping sustainable national development. As a young person, how are you contributing to the development of Rwanda?

Learning activity 1.2.2



Listen to the speech about the role of youth in nation-building. Answer questions that follow

Dear citizens,



Young people play a vital role in shaping the future of any nation. As energetic, creative, and adaptable individuals, they possess the potential to drive meaningful change in their communities. Nation-building is not only the responsibility of leaders or governments; it also depends on the active participation of youth in social, economic, and political life.

One of the key contributions of young people is innovation. Through new ideas and the effective use of technology, youth can provide solutions to modern challenges such as unemployment, environmental issues, and access to education. In addition, young people promote social cohesion by encouraging unity, tolerance, and respect for diversity.

Education equips youth with the knowledge and skills necessary to contribute responsibly to society. However, knowledge alone is not enough. Values such as integrity, discipline, and responsibility are essential for sustainable development. When young people act with strong character, they become role models and responsible citizens.

Moreover, youth participation in community service and leadership helps strengthen democratic values and accountability. By taking initiative and engaging in constructive activities, young people become active agents of change. Ultimately, the future of a nation depends on how well its youth are prepared and committed to building a better society.

Thank you.

A. Comprehension

I. Choose the correct answer to the following inferential and critical thinking questions based on the speech above.

1. Why does the speaker emphasise that nation-building is not only the responsibility of leaders?

- A. To highlight that youth must share the burden of taxes
- B. To show that sustainable progress requires participation from all citizens, including youth
- C. To argue that governments are incapable of leading without young people
- D. To suggest that international organizations should take over national duties

2. What underlying assumption does the speech make about the role of education in youth development?

- A. Education alone guarantees responsible citizenship
- B. Knowledge must be combined with values to create responsible citizens
- C. Education is less important than wealth and political power

D. Only technical skills matter for innovation

3. How does the speaker connect youth innovation with national challenges?

- A. By claiming that technology can solve unemployment, environmental issues, and education gaps
- B. By suggesting that innovation is mainly useful for entertainment and sports
- C. By stating that innovation is unnecessary in traditional societies
- D. By arguing that innovation should replace government policies entirely

4. What is implied about the relationship between youth values and their role as role models?

- A. Strong character makes youth effective examples for others in society
- B. Values are irrelevant compared to knowledge and skills
- C. Role models are only found among political leaders, not youth
- D. Discipline and integrity prevent youth from participating in leadership

5. Why does the speaker link youth participation in community service to democratic values?

- A. Because service activities weaken government authority
- B. Because active involvement fosters accountability and strengthens democracy
- C. Because community service is a substitute for political campaigns
- D. Because democracy depends only on leaders, not citizens

6. What can be inferred about the speaker's vision of the nation's future?

- A. It depends mainly on military strength and defense systems
- B. It is shaped by the preparedness and commitment of youth to build society
- C. It relies on foreign countries and international aid
- D. It is determined by the wealth of political leaders

II. After listening, fill in the gaps with the missing words.

- a) Nation-building is not only the responsibility of _____; it also depends on the active participation of youth in social, economic, and political life.
- b) By taking initiative and engaging in constructive activities, young people become _____ agents of change. Ultimately, the future of a nation depends on how well its youth are _____ and committed to building a better society.

1.3.Speaking: Talking about patriotic values

Learning activities 1.3

Learning activity 1.3.1



Look at the picture below and describe what is happening. In your description, explain the values shown in the picture and why those values are important in everyday life.



Learning activity 1.3.2



Scenario

Suppose you are traveling abroad or meeting visitors from other countries and you sit together to share coffee. Discuss how young people can represent their country positively, the patriotic values that guide their behavior, and why these values are important in building respect and unity among nations.

Learning activity 1.3.3



Your community is facing challenges such as littering, damage to public property, lack of unity, and low participation in community activities. Imagine that local leaders have invited you to share ideas on how to improve the situation. Explain the practical solutions you would suggest, the patriotic values needed to solve these problems, and why these values are important for building a strong and responsible community

1.4. Language structure

A. The use of Past, present, and future tenses (achievements, general truth, and vision or commitment)

Learning activities 1.4.

Activity 1.4.1



Read the following speech addressed to young citizens about patriotism, responsibility, and national values. As you read, write down sentences that describe past achievements, general truths, vision, or commitment.

Dear young citizens of our nation,

True patriots *serve* their country with honesty and dedication. They *respect* national symbols and *value* unity above personal gain. Our history *reminds* us of the sacrifices made by those who came before us. Our heroes *fought* bravely for independence, and their courage *inspired* generations that followed. The president once *said* that every citizen has a role in building a strong nation.

If we *work* together, we *will continue* to strengthen our communities and our institutions. If our ancestors had not *resisted* oppression, we *would not enjoy* the freedoms we have today.

Education *plays* a crucial role in shaping responsible citizens. Young people *develop* skills that *prepare* them to solve real problems. If students *study* diligently and *practice* integrity, they *will achieve* success and contribute to national growth.

In the coming years, young leaders will be promoting peace and responsibility in their communities. By 2035, citizens will have been working together for many years to achieve sustainable development and national unity.

We *will celebrate* achievements while *learning* from challenges. Leaders *have emphasised* that patience, cooperation, and vision *are* essential for progress. Let us remember that if we *commit* to service and unity, our nation *will continue* to shine as a beacon of hope.

Activity 1.4.2 Read the notes in the box below carefully and do the activities that follow.

1. Past Tense

a) Simple Past Tense

This tense is used:

- To describe something **already done or accomplished**.
- To highlight **success, experience or milestones**.

Signal words:

- already, completed, achieved, won, succeeded, accomplished, last year, yesterday, in 2000.

Examples:

- She won the national essay competition last year.
- The team built a new library in the village.
- He completed his studies with excellent grades.
- The students organized a fundraising event for their community.

b) Past Perfect Tense

Past Perfect is used to talk about an action that was completed before another action in the past.

Structure:

Subject + had + past participle

Examples:

- a) She had finished her studies before she started her business.
- b) They had built the school before the government helped.
- c) He had saved enough money before he opened the shop.

We use Past Perfect to show:

- 1. Achievements completed before a certain time in the past
- 2. Achievements completed before another past action
- 3. Life accomplishments before a later event

Examples:

- 1. By 2020, she had graduated from university.
- 2. By the age of 25, he had started his own company.
- 3. They had completed the project before the deadline.

2. Future Tense – For Hope, Promise, or Commitment

a) Simple future

This tense is used:

- To show plans, expectations, or pledges.
- To often highlight/emphasise determination, encouragement or vision.

Signal words:

- will, shall, plan to, aim to, promise to, intend to, hope to

Examples:

- a) We **will build** more schools in rural areas.
- b) I **promise to protect** the rights of every citizen.
- c) The government **will provide** healthcare for all.
- d) Students **will work** together to keep their community clean.
- e) We **hope to achieve** peace and unity in every neighborhood.

Future tense is often used in **speeches to inspire and motivate**

Useful Future Tense Structures for Commitment & Hope

Function	Structure	Example
Promise	Will +verb	I will help you
Decision	Will+ verb	I will study harder
Plan	be going to + base verb	We are going to build schools
Prediction	will + base verb	The country will grow

Future continuous	will be + V-ing	I will be working
Future perfect	will have +past participle	We will have finished
Hope	hope +subject+ will+verb	I hope we will succeed
Intention	intend to+verb	I intend to improve education
Future Perfect Continuous	will have been + verb-ing	By 2040, citizens will have been working together for many years to strengthen national unity

b) Future Continuous for Ongoing Actions in the Future

The Future Continuous tense is used to describe an action that will be in progress at a specific time in the future.

Structure:

Subject + will be + verb-ing

Examples:

- a) At this time next year, I will be studying at university.
- b) The government will be building more schools in rural areas.
- c) Young people will be working together to promote peace and unity.

We use Future Continuous to show:

1. Actions that will be continuing in the future
2. Planned future activities
3. Ongoing efforts or responsibilities

c) Future Perfect for Hopes and Plans.

Future Perfect is used to talk about something that will be completed before a specific time in the future.

Structure:

Subject + will have + past participle

Examples:

- a) By 2030, I **will have finished** my studies.
- b) By next year, she **will have started** her business.
- c) By the end of the project, we **will have completed** the work.
- d) Future perfect continuous for duration of actions

d) Future Perfect Continuous for Duration of Actions is used to describe an action that will continue up to a certain point in the future.

Structure:

Subject + will have been + verb-ing

Examples:

- a) By 2030, she will have been teaching for ten years.
- b) By next year, they will have been working on the project for six months.
- c) By 2035, our leaders will have been promoting national unity for many years.

We use Future Perfect Continuous to show:

- 1. Duration of an activity before a future time
- 2. Long-term commitment or effort
- 3. Continuous actions leading to future achievement

I. Complete the following sentences correctly to express promises and hope and then present a short speech using future forms.

- 1. In the future, we will
- 2. Our country will
- 3. Young people will
- 4. Education will
- 5. We are going to
- 6. I promise I will
- 7. If we work together, we will
- 8. By 2035, we will have

II. Complete the sentences using past tenses to express past achievements

- 1. By 2020, many young volunteers (participate) in national development programs.
- 2. The community (build) a health centre before the government provided extra support.
- 3. The youth group (raise) enough funds before they started the environmental protection campaign.
- 4. The students (train) in leadership skills before they joined the national service program.

5. She (organize) three patriotism awareness campaigns before she became a national youth leader.
6. By the age of 25, he(launch) a project that created jobs for local people.
7. The youth association (complete) the community service project before Independence Day celebrations began.

B. Conditional Sentences

Learning activity 1.4.3



In the sentence, *"If we work together, our country will prosper,"* identify the part that shows the **cause (condition)** and the part that shows the **effect (result)**, then explain what condition must be met for the result to happen.

Learning activity 1.4.4



Read these notes and then do activities that follow:

Conditional sentences show **cause and effect**—what happens if a condition is met. They are usually divided into **three main types**, plus **mixed conditionals**.

a. First Conditional (Real future possibilities)

- **Form:** If + present simple, ... will + base verb
- **Use:** To talk about real or likely future situations.

Examples

1. If students study seriously, Rwanda will have responsible and educated citizens."
2. "If young people use their creativity wisely, they will help solve the challenges of today."
3. "If citizens work together, the country will prosper."
4. "If Rwanda preserves its culture and values, it will remain strong in a globalized world."

b. Second Conditional (Hypothetical / unlikely situations)

- **Form:** If + past simple, ... would + base verb
- **Use:** To talk about unlikely, imagined, or hypothetical situations.

Examples

1. If young people ignored education, the nation would lose an important asset.
2. If Rwanda forgot its culture and values, it would lose part of its identity.
3. If citizens did not take responsibility, the country would not progress.

c. Third Conditional (Past hypothetical situations)

- **Form:** If + past perfect, ... would have + past participle
- **Use:** To talk about what **could have happened** in the past but didn't.

Examples

1. "If past generations had not shown resilience and determination, Rwanda would not have risen again with dignity and hope."
2. "If citizens had not believed in rebuilding the nation, the Rwanda we see today would not have existed."
3. "If young people had ignored their responsibilities, positive change would not have taken place in society."

d. Mixed Conditionals

- Combine **past conditions** with **present/future results**.

Past action → Present consequence.

Examples:

1. "If past generations had not rebuilt Rwanda with determination, the country would not be progressing today."
2. "If citizens had not preserved Rwanda's values and culture, the nation would not have a strong identity today."
3. "If young people had ignored education in previous years, Rwanda would not have skilled and responsible citizens today."

I. Complete with the correct form of the verb in brackets.

1. If we _____ (prioritize) children's education, every child in Rwanda _____ (have) a fair chance.
2. If my father _____ (not get) a scholarship, I _____ (not be) here today.
3. If people in small towns _____ (expect) government to solve all problems, they _____ (be) disappointed.
4. If Rwanda invested more in education, it _____ (develop) faster.
5. If young people _____ (participate) actively in community work, they _____ (contribute) to national development.

II. A student wrote the following paragraph using conditional sentences, but some of the sentences contain grammatical and syntactic errors. Read the paragraph carefully, identify the errors in the conditional sentences, then edit and rewrite the paragraph so that all the ideas are grammatically correct.

If citizens will respect the law, the country would be peaceful. If people worked together, the nation will grow stronger. If leaders listened to the citizens, the country will have developed faster. If communities cooperate with local authorities, development projects would succeed easily.

If young people had participated actively in national programs, unemployment will decrease today. If every child studied seriously, Rwanda will become one of the most developed countries in Africa. If families support education, many students would achieved better results.

III. Complete and expand the ideas meaningfully

- If citizens neglect their responsibilities, ...
- If the youth had been more involved in community service, ...
- If every leader were accountable, ...
- If we had preserved our cultural values better, ...

C. Direct and reported speech

What do you think about the following statement:

"In communication, people may report what others have said either by using the speaker's exact words or by expressing the same message in their own words".

Activity 1.4.5



Analyse the following sentence and answer questions

a) The president said, "Unity is the foundation of development."

b) The president said that unity is the foundation of development.

Questions

1. How are these two sentences different?
2. Which one shows the speaker's original words, and which one shows the message being reported?

Activity 1.4.6



Read the notes below and answer questions that follow

Direct and reported speech

1. Direct speech

Direct speech is quoting exactly what someone said.

Form: uses quotation marks to enclose the exact words.

Example

The president said, "We are all Rwandans, and our unity is the foundation of our country's strength and development."

Tip: Pay attention to punctuation, capitalization, and verb tense.

2. Reported (Indirect) Speech

Reported speech refers to Reporting what someone said without quoting them word-for-word.

- **Form:** No quotation marks; adjust tense, pronouns, and time expressions.

Basic Rules:

Verb tense usually shifts back in the past:

- Present → Past, e.g., "I am tired" → He said he was tired.
- Present perfect → Past perfect, e.g., "We have done our work" → He said they had done their work.
- Will → Would, e.g., "We will succeed" → He said they would succeed.

Pronouns change to match the new subject.

Time and place words may need adjustment:

- today → that day, tomorrow → the next day, here → there.

Examples from the text:

1. **Direct:** "We must remain united and committed to building a brighter future," the speaker said.

Reported: The speaker said that citizens had to remain united and committed to building a brighter future.

2. **Direct:** "How can young people show patriotism?" the journalist asked.

Reported: The journalist asked how young people could show patriotism.

3. Reporting Questions

- **Yes/No questions:** Use *if/whether*
 - Direct: "Are we serving Shamus as well as he was serving us?"
 - Reported: He asked if they were serving Shamus as well as he was serving them.
- **Wh-questions:** Keep the question word, shift tense
 - Direct: "Why are you here tonight?"
 - Reported: He asked why they were there that night.

4. Reporting Commands, Requests, or Advice

- **Imperatives:** Use *tell / ask / advise* + infinitive
 - Direct: "Turn off the television sets."
 - Reported: He urged them to turn off the television sets.
- Requests:
 - Direct: "Please support education for all children."

Reported: He asked them to support education for all children.

The reporting verb reflects intention, tone, and function.

Function	Reporting Verbs	Example
Informing	said, stated, explained	She explained that the system was efficient.
Advising	advised, recommended	He recommended that students use digital tools.
Warning	Warned	The teacher warned that misuse could be harmful.
Suggesting	suggested, proposed	She suggested using online platforms.
Arguing	argued, insisted, claimed	He argued that technology improves learning.

I. Rewrite the following paragraph using direct speech.

The teacher told the students that they had to love their country. One student said that he wanted to become a doctor to help his country. The teacher advised him to work hard and serve his people. The student promised that he would not disappoint his country.

II. A. Scenario: Students are in a youth meeting discussing how to build their country.

Each student gives an opinion. Another student reports it to the class.

Example

Direct speech

- "We must fight against corruption."
- "We should help poor people."
- "Young people must respect national laws."
- "We should protect the environment."
- "Unity is very important for our country."

B. Scenario:

A journalist from Rwanda Broadcasting Agency (RBA TV) interviewed a national hero during a commemoration event in Rwanda. The following is the dialogue they had.

Journalist (RBA TV): "Good morning. We are here at the commemoration event in Rwanda. I am honored to speak with one of our national heroes. Sir, what does being a hero mean in our country, Rwanda?"

Hero: "Good morning. In Rwanda, a hero is someone who puts the country first, shows courage, and works for unity and peace."

Journalist: "What role did you play in serving our nation?"

Hero: "I contributed by helping rebuild our community and promoting reconciliation among people."

Journalist: "That is inspiring. What message do you have for young people in Rwanda today?"

Hero: "Young people should study hard, respect others, and take responsibility for building a better future."

Journalist: "How can they show patriotism in their daily lives?"

Hero: "They can show patriotism through their actions—being honest, helping others, and protecting national values."

Journalist: "Finally, what is your hope for Rwanda's future?"

Hero: "I believe Rwanda will continue to grow stronger if young people stay united and committed."

Journalist: "Thank you very much for your time."

TASK:

Rewrite the interview as a formal news report. Maintain the original meaning while adjusting tense, pronouns, and sentence structure appropriately.

Application activity 1.4



V. Independence Day Speech.

Scenario:

You have attended the event where His Excellency the President gave an Independence Day speech, celebrating national freedom and unity and encouraging citizens to stay patriotic and build a better future together.

Extract:

"Our nation has overcome many challenges. We must remain united and committed to building a brighter better future. Do not forget the sacrifices of our heroes. Work together and protect our values. On this Independence Day, I call upon all citizens to uphold patriotism and continue strengthening our nation through hard work and unity."

Task:

Report this speech to your grandmother who did not attend the Independence Day celebrations

1.5. Speech Writing and delivery

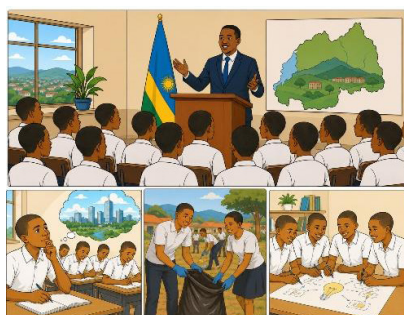
Learning activities 1.5

Activity 1.5.1



Look at this paragraph below and answer the questions:

Dear citizens of Rwanda,



It is always a privilege to stand before young citizens who represent the energy, creativity, and promise of our nation. When I look at you, I do not simply see students preparing for examinations;

I see the generation that will shape the Rwanda of tomorrow. The future of a country is not decided only in government offices or international meetings.

Questions:

- How does the writer begin the text?
- Looking at the features, what type of text is this?

Key notes

Tips for speech writing

1. Know your audience

- Understand **who will listen to your speech** (students, teachers, community members).
- Use language and examples they can easily understand.

2. Have a clear purpose

- **Decide why you are giving the speech.**
- **The purpose may be to inform, persuade, motivate, or entertain.**

3. Organize your speech well

A good speech has **three main parts**:

a) Introduction

- Greet the audience.
- Introduce the topic.
- Capture attention with a quote, question, or interesting fact.

Example:

"Good morning everyone. Today I would like to talk about the importance of unity in building a strong nation."

b) Body

- Present **2–3 main ideas**.
- Support them with **examples, facts, or stories**.

c) Conclusion

- Summarise the main ideas.
- End with a strong message or call to action.

Example:

"Let us work together to promote unity and respect in our community."

4. Use simple and clear language

- Avoid complicated words.
- Use short and meaningful sentences.

5. Use examples and stories

1. Stories make speeches **interesting and memorable**.

Tips for delivering a speech

Delivering a good speech isn't only about what you say—it's also how you say it. Here are some practical tips to improve your speech delivery

1. Know your material: Understand your topic well instead of memorizing every word.
2. Practice out loud: Practice several times before the actual speech. Rehearse in front of a mirror, record yourself, or practice with friends.
3. Speak clearly and at the right pace: Avoid speaking too fast because people may not understand.
4. Use eye contact: Look at different people in the audience instead of staring at your notes.
5. Use body language: Use natural hand gestures to emphasize important ideas.
6. Control your voice: Vary your tone, pitch, and volume to keep the audience interested.
7. Manage nervousness: Take deep breaths before speaking.
8. Engage the audience: Ask a question, share a short story, or use an example. This keeps listeners interested and attentive.

9. End strong

- Finish with a clear conclusion, key message, or call to action.
- A strong ending makes your speech memorable.

NOTE: Good speakers are not born—they become good through practice and preparation

Activity 1.5.2



You have been invited as a youth representative to deliver a speech at The Rwanda Youth Leadership Forum. During the event, young people from different schools and communities will discuss how they can contribute to national development. Prepare a short speech (2–4 minutes) on the topic: "The Role of Young People in Building a Strong Nation." In your speech, include rhetorical questions, persuasive expressions, and national values such as unity, patriotism, responsibility, and hard work.

Application activity 1.5



I. Write a paragraph about what you would do in each situation.

Scenarios:

- You see people destroying school property. What do you do?
- A friend speaks badly about your country in public. What do you say?
- There is a community cleaning day but your friends want to play. What do you do?
- You find a lost national flag on the ground. What should you do?
- People are not following rules in your community. What advice do you give them?

1.6 End of unit assessment

End of unit assessment



Read the following passage and answer questions on it.

The Meaning of Patriotism



The old man stood quietly beside the flagpole as the sun slowly rose over the town square. The early morning air was cool and silent, yet his thoughts were full of memories. He had lived through decades of change—wars, elections, celebrations, and difficult times. As he looked at the flag waving gently in the wind, he reflected on what patriotism truly meant.

To many people, patriotism was loud and visible. It was seen in parades, fireworks, and national songs sung with pride. Yet the old man believed that the deepest form of patriotism was often quiet and unseen.

It was present in the teacher who stayed late to help struggling students, the farmer who worked tirelessly to feed the nation, and the young doctor who served patients in remote villages.

For him, loving one's country did not mean believing it was perfect. On the contrary, true patriots were those who recognized their country's flaws and worked tirelessly to correct them. Throughout history, courageous citizens had challenged injustice, demanded equality, and defended freedom not because they hated their country, but because they loved it deeply.

He remembered a lesson his father once told him: "A patriot is not someone who praises his country only in its moments of glory, but someone who stands by it during its trials and helps it grow stronger." That wisdom had guided him throughout his life.

As the sun climbed higher into the sky, people slowly began to gather in the square. Children laughed, workers hurried to their jobs, and the town awakened with energy. The old man smiled softly. He realized that patriotism was not only found in great speeches or heroic acts. It lived in everyday responsibility—in honesty, service, and the determination to build a better future for the generations yet to come.

Section A: Comprehension

1. What examples of quiet patriotism are mentioned in the passage?
2. What lesson did the old man learn from his father?
3. According to the text, why do true patriots challenge injustice?
4. What message about patriotism does the author convey in the story?

5. Why does the author contrast loud patriotism with quiet patriotism?
6. How does the setting of the town square contribute to the theme of the text?
7. Explain the symbolism of the flag in the passage.

Section B: Vocabulary

Choose the correct meaning of the underlined words.

1. The old man reflected on what patriotism **truly** meant.
 - a) rarely
 - b) genuinely
 - c) secretly
 - d) angrily
2. The teacher stayed late to help **struggling** students.
 - a) successful
 - b) hardworking
 - c) having difficulties
 - d) intelligent
3. True patriots recognize their country's **flaws**.
 - a) strengths
 - b) achievements
 - c) weaknesses
 - d) traditions
4. The father spoke about the country's moments of **glory**.
 - a) success and honor
 - b) sadness
 - c) confusion
 - d) danger
5. Patriotism involves **determination** to build a better future.
 - a) hesitation
 - b) strong commitment
 - c) fear
 - d) anger

Section C: Grammar

1. Rewrite the following sentences using the correct forms of the verbs in brackets

- a) "By the time the national festival began, we _____ (complete) our preparation."
- b) "Before we launched the literacy campaign, we _____ (train) all volunteers."
- c) "By 2028, we _____ (establish) several new youth centers."
- d) "By the time the national competition begins, we _____ (train) all participants."

2. You are writing a summary of a speech. Rewrite the following statements appropriately.

- a) "We are facing many challenges today, but we will overcome them," the leader said.
→ The leader acknowledged that _____
- b) "The teacher encouraged the students to act responsibly so that they could change their community."
→ The teacher encouraged students that _____
- c) "I have seen great improvement in this country over the years," the elder said.
→ The elder noted that _____
- d) Combine the ideas into one smooth report:

"Young people are creative," the speaker said.

"They will drive innovation in the future," he added.

→ The speaker said that _____

Section D: Writing

Write a composition of **150–200 words** on one of the following topics:

- a). Write a speech encouraging young people to love their country.
- b) Write a speech explaining why patriotism should be demonstrated through actions rather than words.
- c). You are asked to speak at a national youth conference.

Topic: how young people can contribute to national development.

Task:

Write a speech using a variety of conditional structures to:

- Show real possibilities
- Imagine ideal situations
- Reflect on past mistakes
- Suggest future improvements

UNIT 2

ANTI-SOCIAL BEHAVIOURS



Key Unit Competence:

Critically analyse and communicate ideas about anti-social behaviours, their causes, consequences, and prevention while promoting responsible citizenship and ethical conduct.

Learning objectives

By the end of this unit, you will be able to:

Knowledge and understanding

1

1. Explain what anti-social behaviours are and their impact on individuals, families, schools, and communities
2. Identify rules for an effective debate
3. Recognize and use advanced grammar structures (modals, passive voice, complex and conditional sentences, connectors, rhetorical forms, nominalisation, emphatic structures, reported speech) in persuasive communication.

Skills

2

1. Analyse short stories and extracts to identify social issues and messages
2. Write structured argumentative texts with logical flow, supporting ideas with facts and quotations.
3. Plan and participate in debates, performing roles such as proposer, opposer, moderator, timekeeper, and audience.
4. Use persuasive language effectively in both writing and oral presentations.

Attitudes and values

3

1. Demonstrate respect, empathy, and fairness in discussion.
2. Promote civic responsibility and ethical behaviour in their communities
3. Critically reflect on the consequences of anti-social behaviours

Introduction

Have you ever seen people damaging property, bullying others, or ignoring rules in your community? In this unit, you will explore different forms of anti-social behaviour and understand how they affect individuals, schools, and society. You will read and analyse texts, discuss real-life situations, and share your opinions through debates and writing. As you learn, you will also practise using advanced English structures to express your ideas clearly and persuasively. By the end of the unit, you will be able not only to explain anti social behaviours, but also to suggest practical solutions and promote positive values in your community.

Introductory activity



Read about Brian and discuss the questions that follow.

Brian, a Senior 5 student at GS IMENA, was known for being serious with his studies. Recently, he started attending weekend house parties with a group of popular students.

At these parties, alcohol and drugs were common. At first, Brian felt uncomfortable and refused to join. But his friends kept insisting, saying, "Everyone does it" and "It helps you relax."

Not wanting to feel left out, Brian slowly gave in. What started as "just once" became a habit. Soon, he began missing classes, losing focus, and performing poorly at school.

One day, he sat alone and asked himself, "How did I get here?"

Questions

1. Why did Brian finally give in to peer pressure?
2. What problems is Brian beginning to face?
3. What would you advise Brian to do now?

2.1. CAUSES AND IMPACTS OF ANTI-SOCIAL BEHAVIOURS

Learning activities 2.1

A. Reading

Activity 2.1.1



1. Have you ever felt pressure from friends to do something you knew was wrong or risky? How did you respond, and why?
2. What early warning signs in your own behaviour or in others might show that someone is beginning to lose direction in life?

Activity 2.1.2



Some people break rules, bully others, or ignore social values. Why do people act in that way? Read **"The threshold of forfeiture"**, explore antisocial behaviours, their causes, and their effects on society.

The threshold of forfeiture

The descent had been incremental, almost imperceptible. By the time Claudien found himself crouched behind the *Nyabugogo* taxi park at 11:47 PM with a pair of pliers and a tremor in his hands, he could no longer identify the precise week when he had crossed from nuisance to offender.

Three months earlier, he had been a final-year student at **Groupe Scolaire Rugunga**, articulate, favoured by his English teacher, and known for his ability to recite Ingrid Jonker from memory. His mother sold tomatoes at the Kimironko market. His father had left for Uganda in 2019 and had not been heard from since. The family subsisted on roughly 45,000 RWF per month, a sum that accommodated rent, charcoal, and little else.

The first deviation was a cigarette. An older boy, MUHASHYI, twenty-two, unemployed, with yellowed fingernails and a perpetual half-smile, offered it outside the school gate. Claudien had refused twice. The third time, he accepted, not from craving but from a more corrosive impulse: the desire to stop explaining why he always said no.

Within two weeks, he was smoking five cigarettes daily. The money came from skipping lunch. His mother noticed his weight loss but attributed it to academic pressure. "He is a serious boy," she told a neighbour. "He would never disappoint me."

Disappointment, however, is a threshold, not a destination.

Gambling followed. MUHASHYI introduced him to *Abaheta*, an informal betting ring conducted after dark near the abandoned market stalls. The stakes were modest at first, 200 RWF, then 500, then the equivalent of a day's food. Claudien won occasionally. The dopamine surge was unlike anything he had experienced from poetry. When he lost, he borrowed. When he could not repay, MUHASHYI smiled that half-smile and said, "There are other ways to settle."

The first theft was a mobile phone, lifted from a sleeping passenger on a Kigali city bus. Claudien sold it for 35,000 RWF. He repaid his gambling debt. He bought his mother new sandals. She wept with gratitude, unaware of the transaction's moral architecture.

The second theft was cash, 12,000 RWF from the offering basket at the Pentecostal church his mother had attended for fourteen years. The usher noticed the absence but could not prove who had taken it. Suspicion fell on a known homeless man who frequented the area.

By the time Claudien began using *kanyanga* (illicit gin), his academic performance had collapsed. His English teacher, Madame Uwamariya, called him aside. «Your essays have become cynical,» she said. «There is a bitterness now that was not there before. What has happened to you?»

He wanted to say: *I am no longer the boy you taught. I am a person who steals from God and justifies it by calling survival.*

Instead, he said nothing.

The night of the pliers, Claudien intended to break into a container shop that sold phone accessories. He had been promised 40,000 RWF by a contact of MUHASHYI's. As he knelt behind the taxi park, a sound stopped him, not a siren, not a voice, but the distant chorus of a choir rehearsing in a nearby church. The song was familiar. His mother hummed it while washing clothes.

He remained there for sixteen minutes. Then he placed the pliers on the ground, walked to the main road, and used his last 500 RWF to call Madame Uwamariya.

"I need help," he said. "I think I am turning into someone I do not recognise."

She arrived within forty minutes. She did not ask questions. She drove him to a centre in **Remera** that offered substance abuse counselling and reintegration support for young offenders. The intake counsellor, a man named Théogène who had himself spent two years in prison for theft before rehabilitation, asked Claudien a single question: «Do you want to stop, or do you want to continue in a way that will end with you dead or imprisoned?»

Claudien did not answer immediately. When he did, his voice was steady.

"I want to stop."

The story does not end with triumph. Relapse remains possible. But six months later, Claudien had completed his counselling, returned to school, and written an examination essay titled "The Architecture of Forfeiture," which Madame Uwamariya read aloud to the class without revealing the author.

"He writes like someone who has seen the edge," she said, "and chosen to step back."

B. Vocabulary

Activity 2.1.3



I. CHOOSE THE CORRECT MEANING OF THE UNDERLINED WORD OR PHRASE AS USED IN THE TEXT.

1. "The descent had been incremental, almost imperceptible."
A. Sudden and dramatic
B. Gradual and step-by-step
C. Unplanned and accidental
D. Immediate and obvious
2. "...from craving but from a more corrosive impulse..."
A. A healthy desire
B. A destructive inner urge

- C. A temporary feeling
- D. A physical illness
- 3. "...a **perpetual half-smile...**"
 - A. A forced smile
 - B. A constant, never-ending expression
 - C. A shy smile
 - D. A hidden smile
- 4. "...unaware of the transaction's **moral architecture.**"
 - A. The financial structure
 - B. The physical design
 - C. The ethical foundation behind the act
 - D. The social setting
- 5. "**Suspicion** fell on a known homeless man..."
 - A. Praise
 - B. Doubt or belief of wrongdoing
 - C. Support
 - D. Trust

II. CHOOSE THE MOST APPROPRIATE WORD TO COMPLETE EACH SENTENCE.

- 6. Claudien's behaviour showed a gradual into risky actions.
 - A. improvement
 - B. descent
 - C. success
 - D. growth
- 7. The teacher noticed a tone in his writing.
 - A. cheerful
 - B. cynical
 - C. careless
 - D. humorous
- 8. The family struggled to on a small monthly income.
 - A. expand
 - B. survive
 - C. invest
 - D. celebrate
- 9. The counsellor asked a question that required deep reflection.
 - A. simple
 - B. careless
 - C. probing
 - D. confusing

III. VOCABULARY AND INFERENCE

- 10. What does the word "**threshold**" most closely suggest in the story?
 - A. A physical door
 - B. A limit or critical point

- C. A place to hide
- D. A new beginning

11. What can be inferred from the phrase **"relapse remains possible"**?
- A. Recovery is guaranteed
 - B. The problem is completely solved
 - C. There is still a risk of returning to old habits
 - D. The situation is unchanged
12. The phrase **"he writes like someone who has seen the edge"** suggests:
- A. He enjoys danger
 - B. He has experienced serious consequences
 - C. He is a creative writer
 - D. He is confused

IV. CHOOSE THE CORRECT FORM OF THE WORD IN BRACKETS.

13. His actions showed a lack of(responsible).
- A. responsibility
 - B. responsible
 - C. responsibly
 - D. irresponsibly
14. The programme focused on social (integrate).
- A. integrating
 - B. integration
 - C. integrated
 - D. integrate
15. His behaviour became increasingly(risk).
- A. risk
 - B. risky
 - C. risked
 - D. risking

V. SYNONYMS AND NUANCED MEANING

16. Which word is closest in meaning to **"cynical"** as used in the text?
- A. Hopeful
 - B. Trusting
 - C. Doubtful and negative
 - D. Careless
17. Which word is closest in meaning to **"imperceptible"**?
- A. Very clear
 - B. Impossible to notice
 - C. Very loud
 - D. Extremely fast
18. Which word best replaces **"subsisted"** in the sentence?
- A. Lived on very little
 - B. Improved quickly
 - C. Worked hard
 - D. Saved money

19. Which sentence best uses the word **"forfeiture"** correctly?
- A. He enjoyed the forfeiture of his success
 - B. His actions led to the forfeiture of trust
 - C. Forfeiture means gaining more opportunities
 - D. She celebrated her forfeiture
20. Which sentence best reflects the meaning of **"incremental change"**?
- A. The situation changed suddenly
 - B. The situation improved step by step
 - C. The situation stayed the same
 - D. The situation became worse immediately

C. Reading comprehension

Activity 2.1.4



Read again the text "The threshold of forfeiture". Answer the following comprehension questions

1. The narrator states that Claudien accepted the first cigarette "not from craving but from a more corrosive impulse: the desire to stop explaining why he always said no." What does this reveal about the social psychology of peer pressure among adolescents in economically disadvantaged contexts?
2. Analyse the significance of the following sentence: "Disappointment, however, is a threshold, not a destination." What does the author imply about the nature of moral decline?
3. When Claudien bought his mother new sandals with proceeds from the stolen phone, "she wept with gratitude, unaware of the transaction's moral architecture." Explain what the phrase "moral architecture" signifies in this context. Why is the mother's ignorance tragically significant?
4. Compare Claudien's silence when confronted by Madame Uwamariya with his eventual phone call to her. What psychological shift does this progression represent?
5. The story concludes with Madame Uwamariya stating that Claudien "writes like someone who has seen the edge, and chosen to step back." What does "the edge" symbolise, and why is the act of choosing significant?
6. The text presents multiple causal factors: poverty (45,000 RWF monthly income), absence of father, peer influence (Muhashyi), substance dependency, and gambling addiction. Rank these factors in order of significance according to your analysis. Justify your ranking with textual evidence.

Application activity 2.1



The text below presents facts, data, and expert opinions about anti-social behaviour among young people in Rwanda. Read it carefully and answer the comprehension questions that follow.

Patterns of youth offending in Rwanda, 2019–2024

Executive Summary

Between 2019 and 2024, the Rwanda Investigation Bureau (RIB) documented 4,872 cases of alleged anti-social behaviour involving persons aged 14–21. Of these, 34% involved substance abuse (illicit gin, cannabis, and imported narcotics), 28% involved petty theft and burglary, 18% involved gambling-related disputes, 12% involved gang-related intimidation, and 8% involved vandalism of public infrastructure. Notably, 71% of these young offenders had been exposed to at least two of the following risk factors: parental absence due to labour migration, untreated substance dependency within the household, primary caregiver unemployment, or residence in an informal settlement with inadequate lighting and policing.

Section 1: Substance abuse as gateway behaviour

Dr. Aline Mukashema, a clinical psychologist at the Rwanda Biomedical Centre (RBC), observes: “We have stopped treating drug use among adolescents as an isolated deviance. It is almost always preceded by some form of social or economic precarity. The adolescent who smokes cannabis at sixteen is very often the same adolescent who, at fourteen, had no adult supervision between 4 PM and 8 PM.”

The data support her claim. Among juveniles apprehended for theft, 63% tested positive for one or more psychoactive substances at the time of arrest. Among those involved in gambling rings, 57% reported using alcohol or *kanyanga* to «lower inhibition» before betting.

Section 2: Gambling and the normalisation of risk

The proliferation of mobile betting platforms (e.g., *BetPawa*, *SportyBet*) has introduced a new vector of anti-social behaviour. Whereas traditional gambling required physical presence, contemporary adolescents can place bets from schoolyards using borrowed smartphones. The Ministry of Youth reports that 12% of secondary school students in urban sectors have gambled at least once in the preceding month, with 3% meeting the clinical criteria for problem gambling (inability to stop, borrowing money to gamble, gambling during school hours).

“Gambling is not merely a financial problem,” states Commissioner Mayira Rukundo of RIB. “It normalises the belief that reward can be obtained without labour. That belief, once internalised, makes theft feel like a logical extension rather than a moral violation.”

Section 3: Fighting and territorial intimidation

Fighting among adolescents, once dismissed as “boys being boys,” has been reclassified as a priority concern following a 2023 incident in **Nyanza District** in which a sixteen-year-old sustained a traumatic brain injury after a dispute over a bicycle parking space. The assailant, aged seventeen, had previously been warned for fighting on nine separate occasions. No rehabilitative intervention had been offered.

“We have a punitive reflex but not a rehabilitative infrastructure,” admits a MINALOC official who requested anonymity. “We fine the parents. We suspend the student. We rarely ask: what is the function of this fighting? Is it status? Is it self-defence? Is it substance-induced? Until we ask those questions, we are merely processing recidivism, not preventing it.”

Section 4: Successful Interventions

Three interventions have demonstrated statistically significant reductions in serious anti-social behaviour:

Intervention	Location	Reduction in repeat offending
Cognitive behavioural therapy (CBT) for substance-using adolescents	Kicukiro District	58% over 18 months
Vocational training (welding, tailoring, mechanics) paired with literacy instruction	Rubavu District	64% over 12 months
Restorative justice circles involving both offender and victim, facilitated by trained <i>Abunzi</i> mediators	Huye District	71% over 24 months

The Huye model is particularly notable because it requires the offender to articulate, in writing, the specific harm caused to the victim and to propose a reparative action. “The act of writing changes something neurological,” explains Dr. Mukashema. “You cannot write ‘I threw a stone at his head’ without confronting the gravity of that sentence.”

Conclusion

Anti-social behaviour among Rwandan youth is neither random nor inexplicable. It is patterned, predictable, and, to a significant degree, preventable. The evidence from Kicukiro, Rubavu, and Huye suggests that punishment without rehabilitation achieves temporary compliance but rarely lasting change. Conversely, interventions that address the underlying causes (substance dependency, economic hopelessness, lack of adult supervision) and that treat the adolescent as capable of repair rather than irredeemably deviant produce superior outcomes.

The question is not whether Rwanda has the resources to scale these interventions. The question is whether the political will exists to reallocate resources from detention to rehabilitation.

Illustrative Case Study: Patterns of Youth Offending, 2019–2024

Questions

I. CHOOSE THE CORRECT ANSWER.

1. What percentage of documented juvenile cases involved substance abuse according to the RIB data?
a) 18% b) 28% c) 34% d) 57%
2. Among juveniles apprehended for theft, what percentage tested positive for psychoactive substances?
a) 57% b) 63% c) 71% d) 58%
3. According to the Ministry of Youth, what percentage of urban secondary students have gambled at least once in the preceding month?
a) 3% b) 12% c) 18% d) 28%
4. Which intervention achieved a 71% reduction in repeat offending?
a) CBT in Kicukiro b) Vocational training in Rubavu c) Restorative circles in Huye d) Fines in Nyanza
5. The MINALOC official who requested anonymity stated that Rwanda has:
a) "A rehabilitative infrastructure but no punitive reflex"
b) "A punitive reflex but not a rehabilitative infrastructure"
c) "Neither punitive nor rehabilitative capacity"
d) "Both punitive and rehabilitative excellence"

II. ANSWER THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS WITH EVIDENCE FROM THE TEXT

6. According to Dr. Mukashema, what almost always precedes drug use among adolescents?
7. Commissioner Rukundo argues that gambling normalises what specific belief? Quote his exact words.
8. Describe the 2023 incident in Nyanza District and its consequence.
9. What must the offender do in the Huye restorative justice model that Dr. Mukashema claims "changes something neurological"?
10. According to the conclusion, what is the question Rwanda must answer regarding intervention scaling?

2.2: LISTENING: AVOIDING ANTI-SOCIAL BEHAVIOURS

Learning activities 2.2

Activity 2.2.1



Discuss the following:

1. Why do some young people start using drugs even when they know the risks?
2. How can addiction influence a person's decisions and behaviour?
3. What kind of support can help someone stop harmful behaviour?

Activity 2.2.2



Listen carefully to an excerpt from a counselling session at a mental health clinic in Remera. The psychologist is Dr. Niyonsaba, and the client is Muteze, a nineteen-year-old. As you listen, pay attention to key details and ideas, then answer the questions that follow.

Dr. Niyonsaba: (*calm, measured*) Muteze, during our last session, you mentioned that you began using cannabis at age fifteen. Can you describe the circumstances of that first use?

Muteze: (*quiet, slightly defensive*) It was at a friend's house. His older brother had some. Everyone was doing it. I didn't want to be the one standing outside.

Dr. Niyonsaba: You didn't want to be the one standing outside. That phrase is significant. Help me understand — what would have been so terrible about standing outside?

Muteze: (*long pause*) You'd be laughed at. They'd say you're a child. Still dependent on your mother.

Dr. Niyonsaba: So at fifteen, being perceived as independent — as not needing your mother — was more important than abstaining from a substance that you now recognise caused you problems?

Muteze: I didn't recognise that then. I thought I could control it.

Dr. Niyonsaba: And when did you realise that you could not control it?

Muteze: (*voice changes — become softer*) When I stole the bicycle. I had not eaten properly for three days. I had spent my food money on cannabis. I was not thinking about consequences. I was thinking about the next hour only.

Dr. Niyonsaba: The next hour only. That is a description of addiction, Muteze. Not weakness — addiction. There is a difference. Weakness is a moral failure. Addiction is a neurological condition that can be treated. Do you understand the distinction I am making?

Muteze: (*long pause*) I think so. Weakness means I chose badly. Addiction means my brain changed.

Dr. Niyonsaba: Precisely. And that change can be reversed, but not through punishment alone. It requires you to learn different coping strategies. When you feel the urge to use cannabis, what do you currently do?

Muteze: I try to sleep. Or I walk. Walking helps sometimes.

Dr. Niyonsaba: Those are not ineffective strategies, but they are passive. Let us develop an active strategy. Between now and our next session, I want you to identify one person — one adult — whom you trust enough to call if the urge becomes overwhelming. Not a friend your age. An adult. Do you have such a person?

Muteze: (*hesitant*) My aunt. She lives in Nyamirambo. She does not judge.

Dr. Niyonsaba: Excellent. This week, I want you to tell your aunt that you may call her. You do not need to explain why in detail. You can say, «Auntie, I am struggling right now, and I need to hear a calm voice.» That is all. Can you do that?

Muteze: I can try.

Dr. Niyonsaba: Trying is sufficient. One more question: the bicycle you stole — have you thought about the person from whom you stole it?

Muteze: (*quietly*) Every day.

Dr. Niyonsaba: What do you think he lost beyond the bicycle itself?

Muteze: (*after long silence*) Trust. He probably trusted his neighbours before. Now he locks everything. Even things that cannot be stolen.

Dr. Niyonsaba: That is a remarkably insightful answer. The diversion programme will require you to write him a letter. Not an excuse. Not a list of your hardships. A letter that names specifically what you took from him, including the trust. Will you be able to write that letter?

Muteze: I do not know if I have the words.

Dr. Niyonsaba: You have the words. You just used them. The question is whether you have the courage. That is a different matter entirely.

Narrator: The session continues. Muteze agrees to write the letter. The recording ends.

Listening comprehension questions

I. RECALL

1. At what age did Muteze begin using cannabis?
2. Why did he start using it?
3. What did Muteze steal?
4. What made him realise his behaviour was a problem?
5. What does Muteze do when he feels the urge to use drugs?
6. Which person does he identify as someone he can call?
7. What does Muteze say he took from the bicycle owner?
8. What is he asked to write?

II. UNDERSTANDING AND ANALYSIS

9. What does Muteze mean when he says he was “only thinking about the moment”?
10. Why is it important to understand addiction as a condition rather than weakness?
11. How does theft affect victims beyond losing property?
12. What does Dr. Niyonsaba mean by saying Muteze needs “courage”?

III. REFLECTION QUESTION

13. Muteze's aunt has not been told about his theft or substance use. Dr. Niyonsaba advises Muteze to call her without full explanation. Do you consider this ethical? Should the aunt be informed of the context? Write a 50–70-word response justifying your position.

Application activity 2.2



Listening again the session. For each statement below, identify the exact phrase used by Dr. Niyonsaba in the script that conveys the same idea in a more therapeutic and supportive way. Complete the table using the correct quotations from the text.

Aggressive/therapeutic alternative	Dr. Niyonsaba's actual phrase (quote from script)	Why this phrasing is more effective
"You made a terrible choice."		
"You are addicted and need to admit it."		
"You must apologise to the victim."		
"Find someone to call or you will fail."		

2.3: Speaking: Anti-social behaviour prevention

Learning activities 2.3

Activity 2.3.1



Discuss the following:

1. Can a person's difficult life situation reduce their responsibility for wrong actions? Why or why not?
2. What is more important in justice: punishment or helping someone change?

Activity 2.3.2



*In real life, when harm occurs, it affects many people and requires more than punishment, it requires understanding and repair. In this activity, you will take part in a **restorative justice role-play**, where the offender, victim, and community members meet to discuss the harm and agree on solutions. As you perform the dialogue, speak clearly, show emotion, and respond respectfully according to your role.*

Facilitator (Abunzi mediator):

We are gathered to discuss the harm caused and to find a way to repair it. This is not about punishment, but about responsibility, understanding, and restoration. I ask everyone to speak honestly and respectfully.

Théogène (Victim):

That night changed many things for me. I was injured, and I could not work for several weeks. As a taxi driver, no work means no income. I struggled to provide for my family. Even now, I feel unsafe working at night.

Facilitator:

Thank you for sharing that. Mayira, you may respond.

Mayira (Offender):

I want to begin by apologising. What I did was wrong. I was under pressure from debts and influenced by drugs, but I understand that this does not excuse my actions. I hurt you physically and financially, and I regret it deeply.

Facilitator:

Can you explain what led you to that situation?

Mayira:

I had been gambling for months and lost money. I also used cannabis regularly. I felt trapped and desperate. I made a decision without thinking about the consequences.

Théogène's Daughter:

Your actions affected more than just my father. We were worried about his health and how we would survive without his income. We also felt fear and anger. It is not easy to trust people again.

Facilitator:

Thank you. Mayira's mother, please share your perspective.

Mayira's Mother:

I am deeply sorry for what my son has done. As a mother, I feel ashamed and responsible. I have struggled to provide for him, and I did not realise how serious his situation had become. I want him to change and rebuild his life.

Community Representative:

As a community, we must ensure both justice and safety. Mayira must take responsibility, but we should also support his rehabilitation so that this behaviour does not happen again.

Facilitator:

Thank you all. Based on what has been shared, I propose the following: Mayira will compensate Théogène in agreed instalments. He will participate in community service. He will attend substance abuse counselling. He will write a formal apology letter.

Let us now discuss whether this is fair and if any adjustments are needed.

Théogène:

I agree with compensation and the apology. I also want assurance that he will truly change.

Mayira:

I am willing to follow all these conditions. I want to change.

Community Representative:

We can monitor his progress through local leadership.

Facilitator:

Then we will record this agreement. Today, we have taken a step towards repair, not just punishment.

Application activity 2.3



Create and act out your own **dialogue** based on the situation below:

A 17-year-old student is caught stealing school materials because her family cannot afford them. The school administration wants to punish her, but the teacher argues for support instead.

2.4: LANGUAGE STRUCTURE

1. Passive Voice

Activity 2.4.1



Read the sentences below and discuss them.

1. "Mayira broke the driver's wrist."
2. "The driver's wrist was broken during the incident."
 - What is the main difference between the two sentences?
 - Which sentence focuses more on the **action or result** rather than the person?

❖ In formal discourse, the passive voice allows the writer or speaker to foreground the action or consequence rather than the agent. This is particularly useful when the agent is unknown, irrelevant or deliberately omitted.

❖ **Examples:**

Active (agent-focused)	Passive (action/consequence-focused)
Police arrested three adolescents for gambling.	Three adolescents were arrested for gambling.
Someone stole 80,000 RWF from the church offering.	80,000 RWF was stolen from the church offering.
The Abunzi committee will propose a reparative action.	A reparative action will be proposed by the Abunzi committee.

Activity 2.4.2: Rewrite the following extract from a RIB incident report using passive voice wherever appropriate. You may need to make decisions about which agents to retain.

“Officer Mukantabana responded to a noise complaint at 2 AM. She found six youths consuming kanyanga near the market. She confiscated the bottles. She issued verbal warnings. She did not make any arrests. The youths dispersed.”

Activity 2.4.3: The following paragraph overuses the active voice, creating an accusatory tone. Revise it to a more neutral, professional tone using passive constructions.

«Parents neglect their children. This neglect causes anti-social behaviour. Schools fail to identify early warning signs. The government does not fund rehabilitation centres adequately. Communities stigmatise returning offenders.»

2. Subordinating Conjunctions

Activity 2.4.4

Read the two sentences:

A. Some young people engage in anti-social behaviour.

B. They lack proper guidance.

Join the two sentences into **one sentence** by adding a linking word such as *because*, *when*, *if*, or *although*. Discuss what the linking word shows — a reason, a condition, or a contrast.

- Subordinating conjunctions establish logical relationships between clauses. In analytical writing about anti-social behaviour, precision in these relationships signals sophisticated reasoning.

Examples:

Conjunction	Logical relationship	Example
<i>Whereas</i>	direct contrast	Whereas punishment addresses past acts, rehabilitation addresses future potential.
<i>insofar as</i>	to the extent that	The diversion programme succeeds insofar as it treats addiction as a medical condition.
<i>provided that</i>	condition with qualification	Restorative justice can be effective, provided that the offender demonstrates genuine remorse.
<i>even if</i>	Concession	Even if the adolescent completes the programme, relapse remains possible.
<i>given that</i>	reason (assumed fact)	Given that 63 percent of theft offenders test positive for substances, screening should be mandatory.

Activity 2.4.5: Combine each pair of sentences using the conjunction indicated. Pay attention to meaning and punctuation.

1. Sentence A: The diversion programme has a 78 percent success rate.
Sentence B: Relapse remains a real possibility for some participants. (**even if**)
2. Sentence A: Gambling normalises the belief that reward can be obtained without labour. Sentence B: This normalisation makes theft feel less morally significant. (**insofar as**)
3. Sentence A: Community service reparations can be meaningful.
Sentence B: The offender understands the specific harm caused. (**provided that**)
4. Sentence A: Many parents want immediate punishment for adolescents who offend. Sentence B: The data suggest that punishment without rehabilitation is less effective. (**whereas**)
5. Sentence A: Substance dependency alters brain chemistry.
Sentence B: Adolescents who use drugs have reduced impulse control. (**given that**)

Activity 2.4.6: Complete each sentence with a logical independent clause.

1. Whereas formal prosecution creates a criminal record, _____.
2. The *Abunzi* mediation process can restore community trust, provided that _____.
3. Even if an adolescent completes the diversion programme successfully, _____.
4. Given that gambling platforms are easily accessible via mobile phones, _____.
5. Insofar as boredom without structured alternatives constitutes a risk factor, _____.

3. Linking words

Activity 2.4.7

Read the two sentences:

A. Muteze stole a bicycle to get money.

B. He later felt regret and wanted to change.

Join the ideas by adding a linking word at the beginning of the second sentence (e.g., *however, therefore, as a result, meanwhile*).

- ❖ Linking words (conjunctive adverbs) connect ideas across sentence boundaries. They signal to the reader how the upcoming sentence relates to the previous one.

Linking word	Function	Example
<i>Consequently</i>	Result (often negative)	<i>The adolescent developed a gambling addiction. Consequently, he accumulated debts he could not repay.</i>
<i>Nevertheless</i>	contrast despite previous point	<i>The data show that diversion works. Nevertheless, many communities still demand punitive responses.</i>
<i>Furthermore</i>	addition of evidence	<i>Substance abuse impairs judgment. Furthermore, it increases the likelihood of impulsive theft.</i>
<i>Conversely</i>	direct opposition of idea	<i>Punishment may produce short-term compliance. Conversely, rehabilitation aims for long-term behavioural change.</i>
<i>Accordingly</i>	logical action following from premise	<i>The literature indicates that untreated addiction predicts recidivism. Accordingly, the diversion programme mandates counselling.</i>

Activity 2.4.8: Insert the appropriate linking word into each blank. Choose from: **consequently, nevertheless, furthermore, accordingly.**

The MINIJUST report reveals that 63 percent of juveniles apprehended for theft tested positive for psychoactive substances. (1) _____, the correlation between substance use and property crime is statistically robust. (2) _____, this does not prove causation; some adolescents may have used substances after committing theft as a coping mechanism. (3) _____, a longitudinal study tracking substance use prior to offending would be necessary to establish causality. (4) _____, the report recommends mandatory screening at the point of apprehension rather than after formal charges. Conversely, most other sectors have not yet implemented this recommendation.

4. Nominalisation

- ❖ Nominalisation transforms **verbs or adjectives into nouns**. This creates lexical density (packing more meaning into fewer words) and is characteristic of formal, academic, and policy writing.

Examples:

Verb/ Adjective	Nominalisation	Example in context
<i>to develop</i>	Development	<i>The development of a gambling addiction often precedes property crime.</i>
<i>to normalise</i>	Normalisation	<i>The normalisation of betting among adolescents concerns policymakers.</i>
<i>to fail</i>	Failure	<i>Failure to intervene early correlates with recidivism.</i>

to resist	Resistance	<i>Resistance to rehabilitation programmes declines when trust is established.</i>
to escalate	Escalation	<i>The escalation from verbal intimidation to physical violence occurred rapidly.</i>

Activity 2.4.9: Rewrite each sentence using nominalisation of the underlined verb or adjective. Make all necessary changes to make sentence meaningful.

1. Adolescents who use substances are more likely to commit theft. → Substance _____.
2. When a community stigmatises returning offenders, they are more likely to reoffend. → Community _____.
3. Parents who fail to supervise their adolescents inadvertently enable risk-taking. → Parental _____.
4. If the government invests in rehabilitation centres, recidivism rates decline. → Government _____.
5. Adolescents who refuse to participate in mediation cannot benefit from restorative justice. → An adolescent's _____.

Activity 2.4.10: Transform the following informal paragraph into a formal policy paragraph using nominalisations. Change sentence structures as needed.

Informal: «When adolescents feel bored, they start looking for excitement in wrong places. They might start gambling or using drugs. If the government builds more youth centres, this might help. But building centres is not enough. We also need to train adults to run activities.»

5. Emphatic Auxiliary

❖ The emphatic auxiliary (**do/does/did + base verb**) is used to:

1. Contradict a negative assertion
2. Add emphasis to a verb that would otherwise be unmarked
3. Create rhetorical force in persuasive speech

Examples:

Function	Example
Contradiction	<i>Critics claim that diversion does not work. It does work, as the 78 percent success rate demonstrates.</i>
Emphasis	<i>Some adolescents do change. We must not give up on them.</i>
Rhetorical force	<i>We do have the resources. The question is whether we have the will.</i>

Activity 2.4.11: Respond to each statement with a contradiction using the emphatic auxiliary.

1. "None of these adolescents genuinely regret their actions."
→ That is inaccurate. Several of them _____.
2. "The government does not allocate sufficient funds to rehabilitation."
→ With respect, the Ministry of Health _____.
3. "Muteze did not write a sincere apology letter."
→ I disagree. He _____, as the victim confirmed.
4. "Rwandan communities do not support restorative justice."
→ The evidence from Huye suggests otherwise. They _____.

Activity 2.4.12: Write a short persuasive speech (60-80 words) arguing that society should invest more in rehabilitation. Use the emphatic auxiliary at least three times. Begin with: "It is often said that rehabilitation is too expensive. But..."

6. Emphatic Structure (It is/was... that/who...)

- ❖ The cleft sentence (emphatic structure) foregrounds a specific element — the subject, object, adverbial, or reason — by placing it after **"It is/was"** and before **"that/who."**

Examples:

Emphasised element	Example
Subject (person)	<i>It was Commissioner Mugisha who designed the diversion programme.</i>
Subject (thing)	<i>It was boredom without structured alternatives that the interview identified as a risk factor.</i>
Object	<i>It was the bicycle, not the cash, that Muteze stole.</i>
Adverbial (time/place)	<i>It was during the third counselling session that Muteze acknowledged his addiction.</i>
Reason	<i>It was because of untreated gambling debts that Mayira resorted to robbery.</i>

Activity 2.4.13: Transform each sentence using the emphatic structure to emphasise the underlined element.

1. Peer pressure often initiates first substance use. → It is.....
2. Failure to intervene early is the strongest predictor of recidivism. → It is.....
3. Claudien called Madame Uwamariya (not his mother). → It was.....

4. The victim's loss of trust matters more than the monetary value of stolen goods.
→ It is.....
5. Because he lacked coping strategies Muteze relapsed. → It was.....

7. Question forms

❖ In formal contexts (interviews, assessments, cross-examinations), question forms require precision. Four types are particularly useful:

Type	Structure	Example (ASB context)
Yes/No	Auxiliary + subject + verb	<i>Has the adolescent participated in any rehabilitative programme?</i>
Wh-	Wh-word + auxiliary + subject + verb	<i>What specific harm did the victim experience beyond material loss?</i>
Tag	Statement + auxiliary + pronoun	<i>The diversion programme has reduced recidivism, hasn't it?</i>
Indirect (polite)	Could you tell me / I wonder / Do you know + embedded clause	<i>Could you tell me whether the offender has expressed remorse?</i>

Activity 2.4.14: Imagine you are an Abunzi facilitator in a restorative justice meeting involving Mayira (offender), the victim (Théogène), Mayira's mother, and a community representative.

Complete the following by writing appropriate questions. Use respectful and formal language.

1. Ask Mayira a yes/no question about his responsibility: → _____
2. Ask Théogène (the victim) a question about the impact of the incident: → _____
3. Complete a polite tag question addressed to Mayira's mother:
→ You were not aware of Mayira's behaviour before the incident, _____?
4. Complete an indirect question to the community representative:
→ Could you tell me _____?

8. Polite and Hedging Expressions

- Hedging softens statements or opinions to sound more polite.

The following expressions are appropriate for formal contexts:

Function	Hedging expression
Expressing uncertainty	It seems that... / It appears that... / I may be mistaken, but...
Making suggestions	One might consider... / It might be helpful to... / Perhaps it would be beneficial if...
Disagreeing respectfully	I take your point, though I wonder if... / With respect, I am not entirely convinced that...
Acknowledging limitation	This is not to say that... / I do not mean to imply that... / That said, it is also true that...

Activity 2.4.15: In Abunzi mediation, speakers must avoid blaming language and use polite, neutral expressions to encourage understanding. Rewrite each statement below into a respectful version. You may adjust the wording as needed, as long as the meaning is maintained and the tone is softened.

1. "You are lying about your son's behaviour." → I do not wish to accuse, but it seems that _____.
2. "The victim is exaggerating his injuries." → With respect, I wonder whether _____.
3. "You clearly do not care about the harm you caused." → I appreciate that this is difficult, though one might ask whether _____.
4. "Your proposal is completely unrealistic." → I understand your perspective. That said, one might consider whether _____.
5. "The police failed to investigate properly." → I do not mean to criticise unnecessarily, though it appears that _____.

Application activity 2.4



I. Revise the following poorly written paragraph about youth offending. Correct all grammatical errors, nominalise where appropriate, add linking words, and adjust the tone from accusatory to professional.

"Young people today are bad. They steal and fight and do drugs. The government doesn't care. Parents don't watch their kids. It's very sad. We need to do something. But I don't know what."

II. Analyse the podcast below. Identify the language techniques used (e.g. **passive voice**, **nominalisation**, **linking words**, **hedging**, **indirect questions**, **emphatic structures**) and explain their effect in communication. Then, perform the podcast, taking the roles of host and guest.

PODCAST: Civic Reckoning

HOST (Grace): Welcome to *Civic Reckoning*. I am Grace. Today we are discussing why some young people move from acceptable behaviour to anti-social behaviour, and how society can prevent it. My guest is MUGISHA, a RIB officer.

GUEST (MUGISHA): Thank you for inviting me.

Grace: The fictional case-study report estimates that over 4,800 cases of youth anti-social behaviour were recorded between 2019 and 2024, with many involving substance abuse and theft.

MUGISHA: That is concerning. However, while the figures are alarming, they must be interpreted alongside the broader socio-economic conditions affecting young people.

Grace: You mentioned risk factors. When substance abuse and lack of parental supervision are combined, the likelihood of engaging in anti-social behaviour increases significantly.

MUGISHA: For example, consider a young person from Rubavu district who dropped out of school, began gambling, and later became involved in theft to repay debts.

Grace: Could you please explain why early intervention is often more effective than punishment in such cases?

MUGISHA: That is an important question. It is not always easy to identify early warning signs in adolescents, but research shows that timely support can significantly reduce reoffending rates. It is lack of early intervention that often leads to repeated offences.

Grace: Some people believe rehabilitation is not effective. What is your response?

MUGISHA: Even if some cases appear resistant to change, evidence from districts such as Huye and Kicukiro shows that rehabilitation programmes can significantly reduce recidivism. Therefore, we should strengthen community-based support systems.

Grace: Finally, this leaves us with one question for society: how can we balance accountability and rehabilitation in dealing with youth offenders?

2.5. DEBATE

Learning activities 2.5



Debate is an important way of sharing ideas, expressing opinions, and listening to different points of view. In this section, you will learn how to prepare debate notes, organise arguments, give reasons, and respond to opposing ideas clearly and confidently.

Debate Rules

1. Respectful communication

All participants must speak **politely and respectfully** to opponents and the audience.

- Do not interrupt other speakers.
- Avoid personal attacks.
- Focus on **ideas and arguments**, not individuals.

Example:

1. Appropriate: *"We respectfully disagree with the previous argument because the evidence suggests otherwise."*

2. Use of formal language

Students must use formal and academic language throughout the debate.

Avoid informal expressions such as:

- "You're wrong."
- "That makes no sense."

Instead say:

- "This argument appears to be unsupported by evidence."
- "However, there is another perspective to consider."

3. Evidence-based arguments

*Every argument must be supported with **reasons, examples, facts, or research.***

Acceptable evidence may include:

- Statistics
- Real-life examples
- Research findings
- Historical events
- Logical reasoning

Example:

"According to several studies, young people who receive positive guidance at home are less likely to engage in anti-social behaviour."

4. Clear structure of arguments

Each speaker should organize their ideas clearly using a logical structure:

- State the claim
- Provide supporting evidence
- Explain the impact

Example:

- Claim: Peer pressure influences youth behaviour.
- Evidence: Many surveys show that teenagers are influenced by their friends.
- Explanation: As a result, they may imitate risky or anti-social actions.

5. Use of linking words

You must connect ideas using appropriate linking expressions.

Examples:

Adding ideas

- Furthermore
- Moreover
- In addition

Contrasting ideas

- However
- On the other hand
- Nevertheless

Concluding

- Therefore
- In conclusion
- To sum up

6. Rebuttal rule

Debaters must respond directly to the opposing team's arguments.

A rebuttal should:

- Identify the opponent's argument
- Explain why it is weak or incomplete
- Present a stronger alternative

Example:

"The opposing team argued that media is the main cause of anti-social behaviour. However, this argument ignores the influence of family and community environments."

7. Useful debate expressions

Giving opinions

- We strongly believe that...
- Our position is that...

Adding ideas

1. Furthermore...
2. In addition...

Disagreeing politely

1. However, we respectfully disagree because...
2. On the other hand...

Concluding

1. In conclusion...
2. Therefore...

Activity 2.5.1



Different solutions are proposed to address anti-social behaviour in schools and communities. In small groups, prepare your arguments for and against common solutions for each of the topics below by preparing:

- Three arguments supporting the motion
- Three arguments opposing the motion
- Two examples or pieces of evidence (from real life, school, or community)
- A short closing statement (3–4 sentences) using linking words such as therefore, however, moreover, and in conclusion

MOTIONS

1. Schools should suspend students involved in bullying.
2. Community service is a better punishment than school suspension for anti-social behaviour.
3. Parents are mainly responsible for preventing anti-social behaviour in young people.
4. Teenagers who engage in vandalism should be required to repair the damage they cause.

Present your arguments to the whole class. Listen to others and compare different viewpoints.

Activity 2.5.2



Work in groups to prepare and take part in a class debate on the following topics:

Topics

- a) Anti-social behaviour is a result of society, not individual choice
- b) Punishment can change behaviour
- c) Peer pressure is stronger than parental influence
- d) Social media increases bad behaviour

2.6. Argumentative Writing

Learning activities 2.6

Argumentative writing is a way of expressing your opinion on an issue and supporting it with clear reasons and evidence. In this section, you will learn how to present your ideas logically, convince your reader, and respond to opposing views effectively and respectfully.

Argumentative essay Writing tips

1. Clear topic and position

- Choose a specific issue that is debatable (e.g., drug abuse among youth).
- State your position clearly in the introduction (thesis statement).
 - Example: "This essay argues that drug abuse not only damages individual health but also undermines societal stability."

2. Introduction

- Start by introducing the topic and why it matters.
- Use general statements to give context, then narrow down to your thesis.
- Use linking words for cause and contrast: eg: Because, Although.

Tip: Avoid vague statements; be specific.

3. Body paragraph structure

- **Start each paragraph with a topic sentence** that introduces the main argument.
 - Example: "Firstly, drug abuse severely affects physical and mental health."
- **Provide evidence and examples:** facts, studies, or real-life examples.
 - Example: "Studies show that young people who abuse drugs are more prone to severe mental health issues."
- Use **linking words** to connect ideas:
 - **Cause & Effect:** because, consequently, as a result
 - **Addition:** moreover, furthermore, similarly
 - **Contrast:** although, nevertheless, however

4. Counterargument (optional but strong)

- Acknowledge the opposing viewpoint and **refute it logically**.
 - Example: "Although laws exist to control drug trafficking, enforcement alone cannot solve deeper social issues."
- Shows **critical thinking** and strengthens your argument.

5. Conclusion

- **Summarize your main points** without introducing new ideas.
- Restate your **thesis** in a strong way.
 - Example: *"Because the consequences are far-reaching, it is imperative that communities, schools, and governments work together."*
- End with a **call to action** or a thought-provoking statement.

6. Language and Tone

- Use a formal, academic tone (avoid slang or casual language).
- Use strong verbs to persuade: must, require, need, should.
- Include precise vocabulary: anti-social behaviour, rehabilitation, community cohesion, neurological development.

7. Linking words and phrases

- cause/effect: because, consequently, therefore, as a result
- contrast/concession: although, however, nevertheless
- addition: moreover, furthermore, similarly
- example: for instance, such as

8. Grammar tips

- Use complex sentences with subordinating conjunctions: although, because, when, since.
- Use passive voice where appropriate to emphasize actions or effects:
 - Example: "Young people who abuse drugs are significantly more prone to develop severe mental health issues."
- Use emphatic structures for important points:
 - Example: "It is imperative that communities work together to prevent substance abuse."

9. Organization

- Follow the logical flow: Introduction → Body → Counterargument → Conclusion.
- Each paragraph should focus on one main idea.

10. Revision

- Check for:
 - a) Clear thesis and topic sentences
 - b) Proper linking words
 - c) Grammar, punctuation, and spelling
 - d) Logical flow of ideas

Activity 2.6.1



Read the essay “*The dangers of drug abuse among youth*” carefully. While reading, take notes on how the writer presents ideas, supports arguments, and uses language effectively. Then answer the questions below.

Essay: The dangers of drug abuse among youth.

Drug abuse has become one of the most pressing anti-social behaviours affecting modern society. **Because** drugs alter the mind and body, individuals often engage in actions that harm themselves and others. Many youths are drawn to drugs out of curiosity, peer pressure, or the desire to escape reality. **Although** the short-term effects may seem pleasurable, the long-term consequences are devastating. This essay argues that drug abuse not only damages individual health but also undermines societal stability and the moral fabric of communities.

Firstly, drug abuse severely affects physical and mental health. Substances like heroin, cocaine, and synthetic drugs disrupt brain function, impair judgment, and weaken the immune system. **Consequently**, addicts are more likely to experience chronic illnesses, accidents, and even premature death. Moreover, drug abuse often leads to psychological disorders such as anxiety, depression, and psychosis. **For instance**, studies show that young people who abuse drugs are significantly more prone to develop severe mental health issues **because** their neurological development is interrupted during critical growth stages.

Secondly, drug abuse hurts social relationships and community cohesion. **When** individuals prioritize drugs over responsibilities, families and friendships deteriorate. **Furthermore**, criminal activities like theft, fraud, and gang involvement are often linked to drug addiction. **Nevertheless**, society sometimes fails to provide adequate support for prevention and rehabilitation, allowing the cycle of abuse to continue. **Although** laws exist to control drug trafficking, enforcement alone cannot solve the deeper social and emotional issues that drive substance abuse.

In addition, drug abuse impedes educational and professional success. Young people who become addicted frequently drop out of school or underperform academically. **As a result**, their employment opportunities are limited, perpetuating poverty and social inequality. **Similarly**, workplaces face challenges when employees struggle with addiction, leading to reduced productivity and increased accidents. These effects highlight that drug abuse is not merely a personal problem but a social crisis that requires collective action.

To combat drug abuse effectively, both preventive education and rehabilitation programs are essential. Awareness campaigns should target schools and communities to educate youths about the risks of substance abuse. **Moreover**, access to counseling and medical treatment can help addicts recover and reintegrate into society. **Although** such interventions require significant resources, the long-term benefits outweigh the costs.

Therefore, tackling drug abuse is crucial for fostering healthier individuals and stronger communities.

In conclusion, drug abuse is a destructive anti-social behaviour that affects health, relationships, education, and society at large. **Because** the consequences are far-reaching, it is imperative that communities, schools, and governments work together to prevent and address substance abuse. **Although** challenges exist, proactive strategies can reduce the prevalence of drug abuse and restore hope to vulnerable youths.

Activity 2.6.2



Questions:

1. What is the main topic of the essay?
2. What position (argument) does the writer take?
3. Identify the **thesis statement** in the introduction.
4. How many body paragraphs are in the essay? What is the main idea of each paragraph?
5. Give one example or piece of evidence used to support the arguments.
6. Does the writer include any opposing idea or counterargument? If yes, how is it addressed?
7. What linking words or phrases are used to connect ideas? List at least four.
8. How does the writer conclude the essay? What makes the conclusion effective?
9. Comment on the language and tone used. Is it formal or informal? Give examples.
10. Is the essay well organised? Give reasons for your answer.

Activity 2.6.3



You are going to practise writing a complete argumentative essay by developing clear ideas, supporting them with examples, and organising them effectively.

Write a **500-word argumentative essay for each of the topics below**. In your essay:

- State your position clearly
- Present well-developed arguments with supporting evidence
- Use appropriate linking words
- Write a clear introduction and conclusion

Topics

1. The rise of social media has increased anti-social behaviour among youth.
2. Strict penalties are necessary to reduce drug abuse.
3. Schools should prioritize environmental education to combat climate change.

2.7. Writing Formal Communications for Community Issues

Learning activities 2.7

A. Formal letter writing

Activity 2.7.1



Understanding how to write a formal letter is important for communicating issues clearly and respectfully to authorities. Read the letter below and observe how each part is organised.

Kigali, Rwanda

Tel: 073 875 3333

Email: usoza71@gmail.com

9th March 2026

The Mayor
Kigali City Council

Dear Sir/Madam,

RE: Concern about drug abuse among youth in the community

I am writing to bring to your attention the growing problem of drug abuse among youths in our community. **Because** drug addiction adversely affects both individual health and social cohesion, urgent intervention is required.

Over the past year, there has been a noticeable increase in cases of substance abuse, particularly among teenagers. **Consequently**, school performance has declined, and incidents of theft and vandalism have risen. I kindly request that the council implement preventive measures, such as awareness campaigns in schools and accessible rehabilitation programs for affected youths.

Moreover, engaging local community leaders and parents in educational workshops could help address the root causes of drug abuse. **In addition**, regular monitoring and counseling services would ensure sustained support for vulnerable individuals.

I trust that your office will take prompt action to address this pressing issue. I am available to provide further information or assist in organizing community initiatives.

Yours faithfully,
Cris

Structure of a formal letter

- **Sender's address and date** (top right)
- **Recipient's address** (left, below sender)
- **Salutation:** Dear Title + Name/Position
- **Introduction:** State the purpose of the letter clearly.
- **Body:** Explain the issue, provide evidence, suggest solutions.
- **Conclusion:** Summarize, politely request action, provide contact details.
- **Closing:** Yours faithfully / Yours sincerely,
- Signature and Name

Application activity 2.7



I. Schools need rules and guidance to maintain discipline and a good reputation. One important way to do this is by addressing issues like cheating during examinations. Imagine some students at your school have been caught cheating during examinations, which negatively affects the school's reputation. Write a formal letter to the school principal suggesting ways to reduce cheating.

B. Memo

A memo is a short and clear message used to share information within an organisation, school, or office. In this section, you will learn the purpose, format, and language of a memo, and how to write effective memos for communication

Structure

- **Header:** To, From, Date, Subject
- **Body:**

1. Introduction: Purpose of the memo
 2. Details: Explain the problem and its impact
 3. Recommendation/Action: Suggest solutions or actions
- **Closing:** Optional signature or name

Sample Memo

To: School Administration

From: Head of Student Council

Date: 9 March 2026

Subject: Addressing Anti-Social Behaviour Among Students

This memo is to highlight the rising incidents of drug use and bullying among students. **Because** these behaviours negatively affect academic performance and school discipline, immediate measures are required.

It is recommended that the school organize workshops on substance abuse, increase supervision in common areas, and provide counseling services.

Furthermore, collaboration with parents and local authorities will enhance preventive efforts.

Thank you for your attention to this matter.

Head of Student Council

II. Imagine that some school property, such as desks, walls, and windows, has been damaged by vandalism. Write a memo from the School Principal to all students reminding them of school rules and encouraging respect for school property.

C. Notice (Public Announcement)

A notice is a short and clear piece of writing that gives important information to the public. In this section, you will learn how notices are written, their purpose, their format, and the type of language used in notice writing.

Structure of a notice

1. **Heading:** NOTICE
2. **Purpose:** One-line description of the issue
3. **Body:** Details, who is affected, instructions or actions to be taken
4. Date & Signature

Sample Notice

NOTICE

Subject: Awareness Campaign on Anti-Social Behaviour

Residents are kindly informed that a community awareness session on **anti-social behaviour** will take place on **15 March 2026** at Amahoro Stadium. Because behaviours such as bullying, vandalism, theft, and public disturbances negatively affect the safety and well-being of the community, everyone is encouraged to attend.

The session will begin at **8:00 AM**, and participants will learn how to prevent anti-social behaviour and promote respect for others. Community leaders and experts will provide guidance, and attendees will be acknowledged for their participation.

Issued by: Kigali Community Development Committee

Date: 9 March 2026

III. Imagine that your community has been experiencing problems with littering and vandalism in public places.

Write a notice (80–100 words) to inform residents about a community meeting where solutions to these issues will be discussed

2.8. End of Unit Assessment

End of unit assessment



Section A: Reading and Analysis

Listen to the following podcast and answer the questions.

Welcome to today's podcast on **discrimination in schools**, an issue that continues to affect many students around the world. Discrimination occurs when individuals are treated unfairly because of their race, gender, religion, social background, disability, or other personal characteristics. Unfortunately, such behaviour is still present in many learning environments.

One of the **main causes of discrimination** is **stereotyping and prejudice**. Students sometimes form negative opinions about others based on misinformation or cultural bias. **Moreover**, a lack of awareness and education about diversity can contribute to discriminatory attitudes. **In addition**, peer pressure may encourage some students to exclude or mock others who appear different from them.

The **effects of discrimination** can be very serious. Students who experience discrimination often feel isolated, anxious, and less confident. **Consequently**, their academic performance may decline because they feel unsafe or unwelcome at school. **Furthermore**, discrimination can damage relationships among students and create a hostile school environment. In extreme cases, victims may even stop attending school regularly.

However, schools and communities can take **effective steps to address this problem**. First, schools should promote **inclusive education** that teaches students about respect, equality, and cultural diversity. **For instance**, teachers can organize workshops and discussions that encourage empathy and understanding. **Additionally**, schools should implement clear policies against discrimination and bullying, ensuring that students feel protected and supported. Counseling services and peer-support programs can also help victims cope with emotional stress.

Parents and community leaders also play an important role. **By working together**, families, educators, and community members can create a safe environment where every student feels valued and respected.

In conclusion, discrimination in schools is a serious issue with lasting consequences. **Nevertheless**, through education, awareness, and cooperation, schools can build inclusive communities that celebrate diversity and promote respect among all learners.

Thank you for listening.

Questions

- a) What is the main topic of the podcast?
- b) What are the main causes of discrimination mentioned in the podcast?
- c) How can discrimination affect academic performance?
- d) What steps can schools take to address discrimination?
- e) What would you do if you saw a student being discriminated against?
- f) Do you think awareness programs are effective? Why?

Vocabulary

Write your own sentences using the words below

- a) hostility
- b) empathy
- c) prejudice
- d) discrimination

Section B: Grammar and Language Use

Rewrite the sentences using the structure indicated.

1. Students must respect school rules. (Use **passive voice**)
2. If students abuse drugs, they harm their future. (Rewrite using a **conditional sentence**)
3. "Bullying damages students' confidence," the counselor said. (Rewrite in **reported speech**)
4. We should work together to stop anti-social behaviour. (Use an **emphatic structure**)
5. Drug abuse destroys health. It also affects education. (Join using a **connector**)

Section C: Listening

Listen to the following extract and answer questions.

Extract

The school playground used to be a place of laughter and friendship. However, in recent months, several incidents of bullying and vandalism have been reported. Some students damage school property or intimidate others because they want attention or power. Consequently, many learners feel unsafe and uncomfortable during breaks. Teachers and parents are therefore working together to promote respect, responsibility, and positive behaviour among students.

Questions

1. Identify **two examples of anti-social behaviour** mentioned in the extract.
2. What **effect do these behaviours have on other students**?
3. Explain the **author's message about civic responsibility**.
4. Identify **two linking words** used in the passage and explain their function.
5. What solutions are suggested to address the problem?

Section D: Writing

Choose **ONE** task.

Task 1: Argumentative Essay

Write **200–250 words** on the topic:

"Drug abuse is one of the most dangerous anti-social behaviours among youth."

Include:

- A clear **introduction**
- Two or three arguments
- Linking words
- A **strong conclusion**

Task 2: Formal Communication

Write ONE of the following official documents:

1. **Formal Letter** to the school principal suggesting ways to reduce bullying.
2. **Memo** to teachers addressing cheating during examinations.
3. **Notice** informing students about an anti-drug awareness campaign.

UNIT 3

FRIENDSHIP AND VALUES.



Key Unit Competence:

Critically analyse and communicate ideas about friendship and human values through oral and written texts while fostering positive interpersonal relationships.

Learning objectives

By the end of this unit, you will be able to:

Knowledge and understanding

1

1. Identify the key features of a poem (tone, rhythm, persona, and message)
2. Identify poetic devices and their meanings
3. Describe different forms of poetry and their purposes
4. Recognise and use adjectives, adverbs, prepositions, and relative clauses accurately in describing relationships and emotions

Skills

2

1. Read, interpret, and analyse poems for literal and figurative meaning
2. Create original poems about friendship and values
3. Apply appropriate grammar structures in both written and spoken contexts
4. Express ideas clearly and creatively with appropriate tone and style

Attitudes and values

3

1. Appreciate the importance of friendship, empathy, and respect
2. Demonstrate kindness, loyalty, and ethical behaviour in interpersonal interactions
3. Reflect on moral lessons derived from poems

INTRODUCTION

Friendship is an important part of human life. Through poetry, people express ideas about love, loyalty, and values. In this unit, you will explore how poets use language to share messages about relationships and community.

You will learn to understand figurative language and poetic devices, while improving your grammar skills such as adjectives, adverbs, prepositions, and relative clauses.

By the end, you will be able to write and present your own poems, showing creativity and understanding of good values.

Introductory activity



Discuss the following questions:

1. What does friendship mean to you? Give examples from your own life.
2. What values (such as loyalty, honesty, kindness, respect) do you think are most important in a good friendship? Why?
3. Can you think of a proverb, saying, or song in English, Kinyarwanda, or any other language that talks about friendship or human values? Share it with your group and explain its meaning.
4. Think of a time when a friend showed you kindness or stood by you during a difficult moment. How did that experience make you feel?

3.1: Values in Friendship

Learning activities 3.1

A. Reading

Activity 3.11



A Friendship is built on shared values such as respect, honesty, care, family, and community. However, different societies and cultures sometimes have different beliefs and ways of life, and these differences can affect how people understand relationships, family, and friendship.

Questions

1. What values are necessary for building a strong friendship?
2. How can differences in culture or beliefs affect friendship?

Activity 3.1.2



Read The poem "Their Civilization" and find out how society that claims to be civilized lacks important human values. Then answer questions that follow.

THEIR CIVILISATION

By Ochieng Orwenjo

Theirs is uncivilised civilisation,
They have table manners
Meals singly silently taken.
They love in church
And hate in court.
Their families, Private and Confidential
No grandparents and extended uncles.
They love selfishly
Polygamy is heathen; a mistress good.
They keep their dead in cemeteries
A dead man is dead.
A child can have a mother
But no father
That is their civilisation,
So dearly cherished.

Activity 3.1.3



B. Vocabulary

I. Find words from the poem "Their Civilisation" that match the following definitions:

No.	Definition	Word
1	Kept secret or private	
2	Valued greatly; held dear	
3	In a way that lacks concern for others	
4	Lacking culture or social refinement	
5	A place where dead people are buried	
6	A person considered irreligious or uncivilised	
7	Alone; one at a time	
8	The practice of having more than one spouse	

II. Complete the following sentences using words from the word bank below

Word Bank: *civilisation, cherished, confidential, selfishly, heathen, cemetery, singly, manners*

1. She kept the letter _____ because it contained personal information.
2. True friends do not love _____; they share and care for one another.
3. The old photograph was her most _____ possession.
4. Good table _____ are a sign of respect for the people you eat with.
5. They visited the _____ to pay their respects to the departed.
6. In the poem, the poet describes a _____ that is contradictory and flawed.

III. Create your own sentences using each of the following words as used in the poem.

1. Civilisation
2. Cherished
3. Confidential
4. Selfishly
5. Heathen

C. Comprehension

Activity 3.1.4



Re-read the poem "Their Civilization" by Ochieng Orwenjo again carefully, then answer the comprehension questions below.

1. What is the tone of the poem? Is the poet admiring or criticising the civilisation he describes? Support your answer with evidence from the poem.
2. Explain the contradiction in the opening line: "Theirs is uncivilised civilisation." What does the poet mean by this?
3. According to the poet, how do "they" treat family relationships? What African values does the poet seem to promote instead?
4. What does the poet mean by "They love in church / And hate in court"? What hypocrisy is being exposed here?
5. Explain the line: "Polygamy is heathen; a mistress good." What double standard is the poet highlighting?
6. What does "A child can have a mother / But no father" suggest about family values in the civilisation being described?

7. What message about friendship, community, and human values does this poem convey?
8. Identify any two poetic devices used in this poem and explain their effect.
9. Do you agree with the poet's view? Give reasons for your answer based on your own observations or experiences.

3.2. Speaking: Traditional Vs modern values (speaking)

Activity 3.2.1



In some families today, older and younger generations sometimes see life differently. Older people often value respect, family unity, and shared responsibilities, while young people may focus more on independence, technology, and personal choices. These differences can lead to misunderstandings, but also to meaningful conversations.

- a) What differences in values can exist between older and younger generations?
- b) How can people from different generations better understand

Activity 3.2.2



Role-play a conversation below between a teenager and a grandfather. Practise and perform the dialogue with appropriate tone and expression.

Characters:

- Student A: Grandfather

- ❖ You believe in traditional values.
- ❖ You think young people today are too focused on technology and independence.
- ❖ You want the teenager to respect family traditions and spend more time with family.

1. Student B: Teenager

- ❖ You believe modern life is different and people need freedom.
- ❖ You think technology and friendships are important.
- ❖ You want to explain your point of view while still respecting your grandparent.

Grandfather:

My child, I have noticed that you spend too much time on your phone these days. In our time, we valued family conversations and respect for elders.

Teenager:

Grandparent, I understand your concern, but things are different now. We use our phones to learn, communicate, and stay connected with friends.

Grandfather:

But what about your family? You hardly sit with us anymore. In the past, evenings were for sharing stories and learning from one another.

Teenager:

That is true, and I agree family time is important. But I also need time with my friends and space to make my own choices.

Grandfather:

Independence is good, but do not forget where you come from. Our values keep us united and respectful.

Teenager:

I respect our traditions, but I think we can combine both. I can spend more time with family and still live in a modern way.

Grandfather:

That would make me happy. Balance is important. We must not lose our values as the world changes.

Teenager:

I agree. I will try to manage my time better and stay connected with the family.

3.3.Listening: Importance of friendship

Learning activities 3.3

Activity 3.3.1



Friendship plays an important role in our lives. True friends support us in both good and difficult times. Discuss the following questions and share your ideas with the class:

1. What is a true friend?
2. What qualities should a good friend have?
3. When do we need friends the most?

Activity 3.3.2



Listen carefully to the poem "A True Friend" and identify key ideas and details. Then answer questions.

A true friend walks in when the world walks out,
A gentle voice that steals the storm of doubt.
Through laughter shared and tears that softly fall,
A faithful heart that answers every call.
They do not judge, they do not turn away,
But stand beside you on the darkest day.
With open arms and words both kind and true,
A friend like this reflects the best in you.

Author: Anonymous

Choose the correct answer.

1. What does a true friend do when others leave?
A. Ignores you
B. Walks in and stays
C. Laughs at you
D. Calls others
2. What does "a gentle voice that steals the storm of doubt" suggest?
A. A friend creates confusion
B. A friend speaks loudly
C. A friend brings comfort and calm
D. A friend avoids problems
3. According to the poem, when does a true friend support you?
A. Only during happy times
B. Only at school
C. During both good and difficult times
D. Only when asked
4. What does the poem say about judging?
A. Friends judge each other
B. Friends ignore mistakes
C. True friends do not judge
D. True friends complain

5. What happens on "the darkest day"?
- A. A friend leaves
 - B. A friend stands beside you
 - C. A friend forgets you
 - D. A friend laughs
6. What does a true friend reflect in you?
- A. Your weaknesses
 - B. Your fears
 - C. The best in you
 - D. Your past

Activity 3.3.3



Listen carefully to the poem "A True Friend". Then complete the sentences below by filling in the missing words.

1. A true friend walks in when the world _____ out, offering comfort when others leave.
2. Through laughter shared and _____ that softly fall, a faithful heart answers every call.
3. They do not judge, they do not _____ away, but stand beside you on the darkest day.
4. With open arms and words both kind and _____, a friend like this reflects the best in you.

The poem suggests that friendship helps overcome _____ and supports personal growth.

3.4 LANGUAGE STRUCTURE

Learning activities

A. Adjectives and adverbs for description

Activity 3.4.1: Read the following extract from "Their Civilization" and answer the questions below:

*Theirs is uncivilized civilization,
They have table manners
Meals **singly** **silently** taken.
They love **selfishly**_
Polygamy is heathen; a mistress good.*

1. Look at the underlined word in the extract above. What does it describe?
2. Check the bolded words in the extract. How do they affect the meaning?
3. What is the role of these descriptive words in the poem?

Notes

Adjectives and Adverbs

Adjectives are words that describe or modify nouns. They tell us about the quality, size, colour, or state of something.

Examples: uncivilised, good, dead, private, confidential

Adverbs are words that modify verbs, adjectives, or other adverbs. They tell us how, when, where, or to what extent an action is performed.

Examples: singly, silently, selfishly, dearly

Tip: Many adverbs are formed by adding -ly to an adjective (e.g., careful → carefully, selfish → selfishly). However, not all -ly words are adverbs (e.g., friendly is an adjective).

Example: A friendly letter

Activity 3.4.2



Say whether the underlined word in each sentence is an adjective or an adverb:

1. She spoke softly to her frightened friend.
2. The loyal dog waited patiently by the door.
3. He gave a generous gift to the homeless family.
4. They celebrated joyfully after the good news.
5. The brave soldier walked quietly through the forest.

Activity 3.4.3



Rewrite the following sentences by adding at least one adjective or one adverb to make them more descriptive:

1. The friend helped me.
2. The children played in the garden.
3. She read the poem.
4. The boy walked to school.

Activity 3.4.4



Read carefully and fill in the blanks with the correct form of the word in brackets.

During the school debate, the hall looked _____ (quiet) at first, but the students quickly spoke _____ (passionate) about their ideas. The microphones worked _____ (clear), allowing everyone to hear the arguments. One speaker appeared _____ (confident), though he answered a tricky question rather _____ (nervous). The judges listened _____ (attentive) and gave _____ (fair) comments at the end.

B. Prepositions for relationship and emotion

Activity 3.4.5



Read the following sentences inspired by the poems and answer the questions:

"He stood by his friend through every hardship."

"They love in church and hate in court."

"A true friend walks in when the world walks out."

"I want to grow in love."

1. Identify words that express location, time, direction in each sentence (line) above.
2. What relationship or emotion does each word help to express?

Prepositions for relationship and emotion

Prepositions are words that show the relationship between a noun (or pronoun) and other words in a sentence. They can express location, time, direction, and especially in poetry, relationships and emotions.

Common prepositions of relationship: *by, with, for, through, between, among, beside, against*

Common prepositions of emotion: *in (in love, in sorrow), with (with joy), of (of hope), through (through pain)*

Examples:

She stood **by** her friend **through** the difficult times. (loyalty, support)

They danced **with** joy **at** the celebration. (emotion, location)

He found comfort **in** the words **of** the poem. (emotion, source)

Activity 3.4.6



Fill in the blanks with the correct preposition:

1. True friends stand _____ each other in times of trouble.
2. She was filled _____ gratitude for his kindness.
3. They walked _____ the village, sharing stories _____ their childhood.
4. He spoke _____ great passion _____ the importance of honesty.
5. The bond _____ siblings is _____ the strongest relationships.

Activity 3.4.7



Write five original sentences about friendship or values using at least two prepositions in each sentence.

C. Relative Clauses

Activity 3.4.8



Read the following sentences and answer the questions below:

"A friend who listens is a blessing."

"The poem, which was written about love, moved everyone deeply."

"The values that we learn in childhood shape our character."

"She is the person whom I trust the most."

1. Look at the underlined words in each sentence (who, which, that, whom). What is their role in each sentence?
2. Try removing the relative clause from each sentence. Does the sentence still make sense? What information is lost?

Relative Clauses

A **relative clause** is a group of words that gives additional information about a noun. It usually begins with a relative pronoun: **who, whom, whose, which, or that**.

Defining relative clauses give essential information. Without them, the sentence's meaning is incomplete.

Example: A friend who listens is a blessing. (Which friend? The one who listens.)

Non-defining relative clauses give extra, non-essential information. They are separated by commas.

Example: The poem, which was about friendship, was beautiful. (The sentence makes sense without the clause.)

Usage guide:

who / whom for people

which for things and animals

that for people, things, and animals (in defining clauses only)

whose for possession

Activity 3.4.9



Combine each pair of sentences into one sentence using a relative clause:

1. The girl is my best friend. She helped me during exams.
2. The poem touched everyone's heart. It was about loyalty.
3. I admire people. They stand up for what is right.
4. The teacher is very kind. Her class is always interesting.
5. The book belongs to my neighbor. It is on the table.

Activity 3.4.10



Write five sentences about friendship or values using relative clauses. Use a different relative pronoun in each sentence.

Application activity 3.4



I. Read the short scenario below, then complete the tasks that follow.

Amina and Jean-Paul had been friends since primary school. Jean-Paul began spending time with new friends who mocked Amina for being quiet and shy. Hurt by his silence, Amina shared her feelings. Jean-Paul realized his mistake, apologized, and defended her. He encouraged others to respect differences. The group understood, apologized, and changed their behavior. In the end, they became true friends who supported and valued one another.

1. Write three sentences about this scenario using adjectives and adverbs to describe the characters and their actions.
2. Write two sentences using prepositions to describe the relationship between Amina and Jean-Paul.
3. Write two sentences using relative clauses to give more information about the characters.
4. Write a short paragraph (5–7 sentences) reflecting on the values demonstrated in this scenario. Use at least two adjectives, two adverbs, two prepositions, and one relative clause.

II. Think about the people and experiences that shape your life. Reflect on these three important ideas:

1. **A friend who changed my life:** Someone whose friendship has had a deep impact on you.
2. **The power of kindness:** How small or big acts of kindness can make a difference in the lives of others.
3. **What it means to be loyal:** How loyalty shows itself in friendships, family, or other relationships, and why it matters.

III. Choose one of the topics. Write a paragraph of at least 10 lines expressing your thoughts, feelings, and experiences.

- Focus on **expressing your ideas and emotions creatively**.
- Use vivid, descriptive, and meaningful language to make your poem engaging.
- You can draw from real-life experiences, imagination, or stories you know.

Example poem:

A Friend who changed my life

A friend appeared when I was lost,
Their gentle words outweighed the cost.
Through stormy nights and endless fears,
They wiped away my falling tears.

With every laugh and every cheer,
They made the dark seem bright and clear.
A guiding light when hope seemed small,
A hand to catch me should I fall.

Because of them, I've learned to see
The strength of friendship's loyalty.

3.5: LITERATURE

Learning activities 3.5

A. LITERAL AND FIGURATIVE MEANING

Activity 3.5.1



Read the following expressions and say what they mean:

Expression	
"It's raining cats and dogs"	
"Break a leg"	
"I'm so hungry I could eat a horse"	
"She has a heart of gold"	

Activity 3.5.2



Discuss this question: *"If someone told you **to break a leg** before an exam, would you be worried? Why not?"*

LITERAL vs. FIGURATIVE MEANING

1. Literal Meaning

1. The exact, dictionary meaning of a word or phrase
2. What the words say directly and plainly
3. No hidden or deeper meaning
4. Example: "She fell down the stairs" → She physically lost her balance and fell

2. Figurative Meaning

- The implied or deeper meaning behind words
- Words used in a creative or imaginative way
- The meaning goes beyond the dictionary definition
- Example: "She fell apart after the news" → She became emotionally devastated

3. Common Figures of Speech That Create Figurative Meaning

Figure of Speech	Definition	Example
Metaphor	Describing something as if it were something else	<i>"Life is a journey"</i>
Simile	Comparing using <i>like</i> or <i>as</i>	<i>"Strong as a lion"</i>
Personification	Giving human qualities to non-human things	<i>"The wind whispered"</i>
Idiom	A phrase with a meaning different from its words	<i>"Spill the beans"</i>
Hyperbole	Extreme exaggeration	<i>"I've told you a million times"</i>
Symbolism	Using one thing to represent another	<i>A dove representing peace</i>

Activity 3.5.3



Read the poem *"Growing in Love"* and answer questions that follow it.

GROWING IN LOVE

By Kimani wa Wanjiru

I don't want to fall in love!
No, I don't know, please, thank you.
For in falling,
I might get hurt.
You know a bruise here,
A scratch there.
And I don't want to get hurt
Nobody does.
I don't want to fall in love!

I want to grow in love!
Yes, grow.
For in growing,
I might get a chance
you know, actually get
a chance
To know and experience
What I love.
I want to grow in love!

1. What is the poem about on the surface?
2. What two things does the speaker compare?
3. Which words stood out to you and why?

Activity 3.5.4



Look at the expressions taken from or inspired by the poem. Fill in the table with the literal or figurative interpretation.

Expression from the Poem	Literal Interpretation	Figurative Interpretation
"fall in love"		
"I might get hurt"		
"a bruise here, a scratch there"		
"grow in love"		

Activity 3.5.5



Read the poem again carefully. Answer the following questions.

1. What does "*fall in love*" mean literally? What does it mean figuratively in this poem?
2. The poet says "*a bruise here, a scratch there.*" Is this literal or figurative? What is he really describing?
3. What is the difference between "*falling*" in love and "*growing*" in love as used in the poem?
4. What does the word "*grow*" suggest about how the poet wants to experience love?
5. Why does the poet repeat "*I want to grow in love*" at the end? What effect does this have?

Activity 3.5.6



Read each sentence and write **L** for literal or **F** for figurative. Then explain the figurative meaning where applicable.

- The roses in the garden are growing beautifully.
- Their friendship grew stronger every year.
- He fell off the bicycle and hurt his knee.
- She fell into a deep depression after losing her job. _____
- Love is a garden — it needs constant care and attention. _____
- The child scratched her arm on the fence. _____
- His harsh words left deep scratches on her heart. _____

Application activity 3.5



I. Write your own short poem (8–12 lines) using **at least three figurative expressions**. Your poem should be about one of the following topics:

1. Friendship
2. Growing up
3. Chasing a dream
4. Fear and courage

Requirements:

1. Use at least one **metaphor** or **simile**
2. Use at least one **expression that has both a literal and figurative meaning**
3. Give your poem a title that is itself **figurative**

After writing, underline all figurative expressions and write their meaning in the margin.

II.

Debate: Falling vs. Growing

1. **Group A** argues: *"Falling in love is natural and beautiful, there is nothing wrong with it."*
2. **Group B** argues: *"Growing in love is wiser and leads to stronger relationships."*

Each group prepares arguments using **both literal and figurative language** to support their position. After the debate, the class votes on which group used figurative language most effectively.

B. Persona vs Poet

Activity 3.5.7



Read this extract and discuss the questions that follow. Share answers with the class.

"The reason I'm second-hand
With second-hand spare parts
Is because I'm a man-made man"

- Who is speaking in these lines?
- What kind of person is this speaker?
- Do you think this is the real writer speaking? Why or why not?

1. What is a Persona?

A **persona** is the speaker or voice in a poem. It is the person who is talking in the poem. The persona is **not always the poet**.

The poet may create a character, voice, or speaker to express ideas and feelings.

Example:

If a poem is written from the point of view of a child, an old man, a soldier, or a bird, that voice is the **persona**, not the poet.

2. What is a Poet?

A **poet** is the person who writes the poem.

The poet creates the poem, the ideas, the characters, and the message.

The poet may:

- Speak through a character
- Tell a story
- Express feelings
- Describe events
- Teach a lesson

Important:

Persona = Speaker in the poem

Poet = Writer of the poem

Activity 3.5.8



Read the poem and answer questions that follow

The second creation

The reason I'm second-hand
With second-hand spare parts
Is because I'm a man-made man
Manufactured in Euro-American genetical labs.
Me of the second creation.

The reason I photocopy is because I'm a copycat
They ripped off my God-given brain
And transplanted a complicated gadget.
Where others function voluntarily,
I am remote-controlled
Tune lagging me:
Me of the second creation.

The reason I mime is because I'm a mimic
They slashed out my God-given vocal chords
And replaced them with magnetic vibrations.
Where goats bleat and cats mew,
I only echo:
Me of the second creation.

The reason I'm undefined is because I'm unidentified.
They slashed my God-given nomenclature
And attached on me a laboratory index
A new baptism for me:
Me of the second creation

1. Who is the persona in "The Second creation"? What do we know about this persona from the poem? Is the persona the same as the poet? How do you know?
2. What kind of person is the speaker?
3. What has happened to him?
4. Why is it important to distinguish between the poet and the persona when analysing a poem?

Activity 3.5.9



Write a short poem using a **persona** who is:

1. A street child OR
2. A student under pressure OR
3. A person in a changing society

C. Context, Themes, and Messages

Activity 3.5.10



Read the extract from the second creation and discuss the questions that follow

"They ripped off my god-given brain
And transplanted a complicated gadget
I am remote-controlled"

1. What is happening to the speaker?
2. Is this realistic or symbolic?
3. What problem is suggested here?

1. Context in Poetry

Context refers to the background information that helps us understand a poem better. It explains the circumstances, setting, and influences surrounding the poem, such as the time it was written, the poet's experiences, and the social or cultural environment.

Types of Context:

Historical context – Events happening at the time the poem was written (e.g., war, colonization, independence).

Social context – Society, culture, traditions, and social issues.

Biographical context – The poet's life and personal experiences.

Literary context – The type of poem, literary movement, or style.

Situational context – The situation described in the poem.

Example:

If a poem talks about war, the context may be:

1. A real war
2. Loss of people
3. Patriotism
4. Suffering of citizens

2. Theme in Poetry

Theme is the main idea or central message of a poem. It is what the poem is mostly about.

A poem can have **more than one theme**.

Common Themes in Poetry:

1. Love
2. Death
3. Nature
4. War
5. Patriotism
6. Freedom
7. Discrimination
8. Friendship
9. Childhood

3. Message in Poetry

Message is the lesson, moral, or what the poet wants us to learn from the poem.

The message answers the question:

"What does the poet want us to learn?"

Activity 3.5.11



Re-read 'The Second Creation' on pages 82, then answer the questions below.

The Second Creation

The reason I'm second-hand
With second-hand spare parts
Is because I'm a man-made man
Manufactured in Euro-American genetical labs.
Me of the second creation.

The reason I photocopy is because I'm a copycat
They ripped off my god-given brain
And transplanted a complicated gadget.
Where others function voluntarily,
I am remote-controlled —
Tune lagging me:
Me of the second creation.

The reason I mime is because I'm a mimic
They slashed out my god-given vocal chords
And replaced them with magnetic vibrations.
Where goats bleat and cats mew,
I only echo:
Me of the second creation.

The reason I'm undefined is because I'm unidentified.
They slashed my god-given nomenclature
And attached on me a laboratory index
A new baptism for me:
Me of the second creation

Questions

I.

- a) What problems does the speaker face?
- b) What ideas are repeated?
- c) Why does the speaker mention "Euro-American genetical labs"?
- d) What could "The Second Creation" suggest about history or society?
- e) What is the poet warning us about?
- f) What should people learn from this poem?
- g) Can you relate this poem to situations in your community or country?

II. Discuss the following Questions:

- a) What is the historical and cultural context of "The Second Generation"? What experience is the persona describing?
- b) How does the poem "The Second Generation" explore the ideas of identity, cultural loss, and human values? Support your answer with evidence from the poem.
- c) What is the context of "Growing in Love"? How does the poet use contrast to communicate the poem's message?
- d) How do both poems relate to the broader theme of friendship and values?
- e) How is the message relevant today?
- f) Why is it important to understand theme, context, and message?

D. FORMS OF POETRY

Learning activities

Activity 3.5.12



Carefully read poem extracts A, B, and C. Then discuss the questions.

Extract A

"Dlungwana son of Ndaba!
Ferocious one of the Mbelebele brigade...
Axe that surpasses other axes in sharpness"

Extract B

"My heart it was aching when I saw my mum
Her crying, her shaking disbelief left me numb"

Extract C

"They don't dig, they don't harvest,
Yet they just grow fat."

1. What is each extract talking about?
2. What feelings or ideas are expressed?
3. Which one praises a hero?
4. Which one expresses personal emotions?
5. Which one criticizes society?

What is Epic Poetry?

An epic poem is a long, formal poem that celebrates the extraordinary deeds, power, and greatness of a hero or group of people. Epic poetry has its roots in oral tradition — these poems were originally composed and performed aloud to honour warriors and kings. They use **hyperbole** to exaggerate the hero's deeds, **simile and metaphor** to capture the hero's qualities, and **anaphora** to create a rhythmic, chant-like quality suited to oral performance.

What is Lyric Poetry?

A lyric poem is a short to medium-length poem in which the poet gives voice to their own personal feelings, thoughts, and experiences. The word "lyric" comes from the ancient Greek lyre — a stringed instrument used to accompany sung poetry. Lyric poems are deeply emotional and written in the first person" with "Lyric poems are often deeply emotional and frequently use the first person

What is Satirical Poetry?

A satirical poem uses humour, irony, and clever comparison to criticise or mock individuals, groups, or social systems. The goal of satire is not merely to entertain, but to expose injustice, hypocrisy, or corruption — and to provoke thought or reform. Satirical poets use allegory, irony, and vivid imagery as their weapons.

Activity 3.5.13



Read this poem and answer questions.

Shaka, the Zulu King

Dlungwana son of Ndaba!
Ferocious one of the Mbelebele brigade,
Who raged among the large kraals,
So that until dawn the huts were being turned upside down.
He who is famous without effort, son of Menzi,
He who beats but is not beaten, unlike water,
Axe that surpasses other axes in sharpness;
Shaka, I fear to say he is Shaka, Shaka, he is the chief of the Mashobas.
He of the shrill whistles the lion;
He who armed in the forest, who is like a madman, The madman who is in full view
of the men.

From Dr Alex Coutts; The Story of a Zulu King

1. Why does the poet repeat "He who..."?
2. What do the comparisons (axe, madman) tell us about Shaka?
3. Show how the poet uses hyperbole and metaphor to exaggerate Shaka's deeds.
4. What features make Shaka appear heroic?
5. Explain why this poem is an epic using at least two features. (refer to the notes above)

Activity 3.5.14



Choose a real hero from your community, family, school, or history. Write a 10 line epic praise poem for them. You must include:

1. At least **two praise epithets** (glorifying names or titles)
2. At least **one simile** (comparison using «like» or «as»)
3. At least **one use of hyperbole** (exaggeration)
4. At least **one use of anaphora** (repeat a phrase like «He who...» / «She of...» / «Child of...»)

Activity 3.5.15



Read this poem and answer questions

Someone special

In your life you will meet SOMEONE SPECIAL sometime
Listen now as I tell you how death has took mine
Not a rock or a film star but a father so true
I lost SOMEONE SPECIAL when dad, I lost you
My heart it was aching when I saw my mum
Her crying, her shaking disbelief left me numb
I could not believe he was actually dead
Even after his name in the paper I read
At his funeral I carried his coffin with pride
Trying at all times my great hurt to hide
But my heart at last sank and the tears they did flow
But good memories stay with me where ever I go
His laughter, his smile, his quick cheeky wit
Were qualities that I admire, I admit
All children loved him with passion and fire
He showed love and kindness, which we all should admire
He left many people who cared a great deal
He touched their lives and their hearts he did steal
For to know him was pleasure and only brought joy
I was blessed to have loved him as both man and boy

By **Owen Yeats**

1. Who is the "someone special"?
2. Which examples show that the poem is emotional?
3. How does the poet show love for the father?
4. Why are memories important in the poem?
5. Explain why this poem is a lyric poem. (refer to the notes)

Activity 3.5.16



Write 6–8 lines about someone special in your life.

Instructions:

- Use “I” or “my”
- Express emotions clearly
- Include at least one feeling (love, sadness, happiness)

Activity 3.5.17



Read the following poem and do the activities on it.

A Tick on a Cow

You have seen those crawling larvae
In a pit latrine
They don't dig, they don't harvest,
Yet they just grow fat.

You have been to a university
And seen those healthy wealthy-looking chaps
Who don't swot and don't sweat
Yet just pass exams.

You saw them in church last Sunday
In what angelic robes:
More alms, more blessings, they say.
And yet drive.

Tomorrow this cow will be slaughtered
And its life cast into the pot of forgetfulness:
Where will the tick go?

George Juma Abiola

I. What do the following images represent

Image in poem	What it represents
Larvae in pit latrine	
Wealthy-looking students	
People in church	
Tick on a cow	

II. Read the poem and answer the questions

- What behaviors are shown in the poem?
- Are these behaviors good or bad? Why?
- Why does the poet compare people to larvae and ticks?
- Why are the churchgoers criticized?
- Give examples of irony, comparison and social criticism from the poem.
- What warning is given in the last lines?
- Explain why this poem is satirical.(refer to the notes)

Activity 3.5.18



Write 4–6 lines criticizing a bad behavior in society (e.g., cheating, corruption, laziness)

Instructions:

- Use comparison (like an animal/object)
- Show the problem clearly
- Add a warning or message

Comparative analysis

Activity 3.5.19



Choose the correct answer

1. Which poem is written entirely in the first person?

- A. Shaka, the Zulu King
- B. Someone Special
- C. A Tick on a Cow

2. In *A Tick on a Cow*, what does the cow represent?

- A. A farm animal in danger
- B. Society or the system that sustains parasitic people
- C. The poet himself

3. Which feature is **MOST** distinctive of epic poetry?

- A. Personal emotional expression
- B. Ironical social commentary
- C. Praise epithets and exaggerated celebration of a hero

4. "Shaka, I fear to say he is Shaka" — this line most strongly suggests:

- A. The poet has forgotten the hero's name
- B. The hero is so powerful that even speaking his name carries awe and danger
- C. The poet is being ironic about Shaka's reputation

Lesson Summary: Key Takeaways

Epic poetry celebrates a hero in grand, elevated language using praise epithets, hyperbole, and repetition. It emerges from oral traditions.

Lyric poetry expresses the poet's own personal emotions in first-person voice. It uses imagery, rhyme, and accessible language to create emotional intimacy.

Satirical poetry critiques society using irony, allegory, and comparison. Its purpose is to expose hypocrisy and provoke thought or change.

All three forms use figurative language — but to completely different ends: to praise, to feel, or to challenge.

Activity 3.5.20



Work in small groups. Choose one poem from your school library or a reliable internet source, read it carefully, and analyse it. Prepare a group presentation by identifying the figurative language used and how it adds meaning, the sound devices and their effect on mood, the poetic form, the context of the poem, the main themes and message, and the difference between the persona and the poet. Present your ideas clearly to the class.

3.6. Creative writing

Application activity 3.6



For each of the three forms, write a short poem (8–16 lines) following the conventions of that form:

Epic: Compose a praise poem for a community hero (a teacher, local leader, farmer). Use at least two praise epithets and one simile.

Lyric: Write about a personal memory or feeling. Use first person, at least one metaphor, and end with a line that offers reflection or hope.

Satirical: Choose a problem in your school or community. Create an animal allegory (like the tick and the cow) to expose this problem. End with a warning or a rhetorical question.

3.7 END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT

End of unit assessment



Read the poem below and answer the questions on it.

A steady hand within the howling gale,
The silver **anchor** in a churning sea;
Your laughter is the **wind** upon my sail,
A **symphony** that sets the spirit free.
Clatter, crash! The world may fall apart,
But you are **constant** as the northern star.
A **golden thread** sewn deep within my heart,
Connecting us no matter where we are.

Softly spoken solace in the night,
As **gentle as a feather** on the breeze.
You turn the heavy shadows into light,
And bring the weary mountain to its knees.
The **clock's cold click** may mark the passing years,
Time is described as a 'thief who flees the room.'
You drink the bitter nectar of my fears,
And make the desert of my sorrow bloom.
Like **iron sharpens iron**, so we grow,
Two **climbing vines** around a sturdy wall.
The only certain thing I'll ever know:
You'll **catch the sky** before you let me fall.

A: Poem analysis questions

1. In the first stanza, friendship is described as both an "anchor" and the "wind." How do these two conflicting images work together to describe the support a friend provides?
2. The fourth stanza mentions making a "desert of sorrow bloom." What does this **metaphor** suggest about the transformative power of a friend's presence?

3. Look at the line *"Softly spoken solace in the night."* How does the repetition of the **"s" sound** (alliteration/sibilance) change the mood or "feeling" of that specific verse?

4. The poem describes a friend as being *"as gentle as a feather."*

a. which poetic device did he use?

b. Why is this **simile** effective when placed right before the line about bringing a *"weary mountain to its knees"*?

5. In the fourth stanza, **Time** is described as a "thief who flees the room."

a. which poetic device does he use?

b. By giving **time** human traits, what is the poem saying about the longevity of a true bond?

6. The final line claims a friend would *"catch the sky"* before letting the other fall.

a) which poetic device is used?

b) How does this use of **exaggeration** emphasize the level of trust between the two individuals?

B. Vocabulary

The poem uses the word **sharpen** to describe how friends improve each other. In this context, "sharpening" is a metaphor for personal growth.

1. Fill in the blanks with the correct form of these "Growth" words: (*Refine, Provoke, Cultivate, Temper*)

a) A good friend will _____ your best qualities, helping them grow like a garden.

b) True friendship can _____ your character, making you stronger through shared hardships (much like heat strengthens steel).

c) Sometimes, a friend must _____ you to think differently by questioning your assumptions.

d) Through honest feedback, we _____ our social skills and become more thoughtful.

C. Grammar

1. Rewrite the sentence with an adverb.

a) She arrived in a calm manner.

b) They sang with great joy.

c) He spoke in a private manner.

2) Combine each pair of simple sentences into one complex sentence using a relative clause. Try to vary the relative pronouns.

- a) The woman is a nurse. She comforted the child.
- b) The story was moving. It described true friendship.
- c) The volunteers arrived early. The volunteers saved lives.
- d) I met a man. His advice changed my plans.
- e) The letter was old. It lay on the table.

3) Create three short sentences (one for each task below) that use a preposition to show:

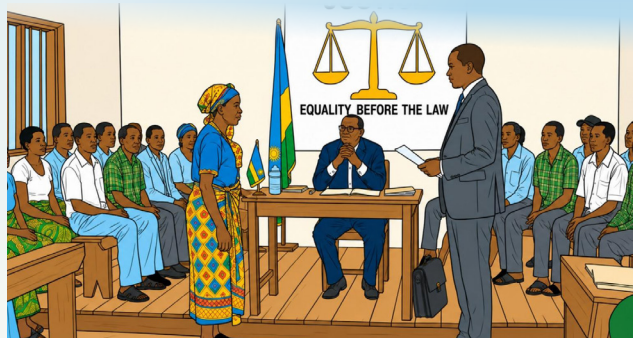
- a) support (e.g., by/with/for)
- b) separation or distance (e.g., from/away), (2 marks)
- c) inclusion/belonging (e.g., among/within). (20 marks)

D. Writing

1. Compose an original poem (at least 12 lines) about friendship or moral values. Use at least two figurative language devices, two sound devices, and appropriate grammar structures (adjectives, adverbs, prepositions, and a relative clause). (20 marks)

UNIT 4

JUSTICE AND HUMAN DIGNITY



Key Unit Competence:

Communicate effectively about justice, human dignity, and human rights issues while promoting fairness and respect for all people.

Learning objectives

By the end of this unit, you will be able to:

Knowledge and understanding

1

1. Identify key features of African drama, including plot, characters, message, and dramatic devices.
2. Recognise and use grammar structures to construct and interpret dialogues, monologues, and narrative sequences
3. Explain themes of justice, equality, and dignity as portrayed in selected plays.

Skills

2

1. Read, interpret, and analyse extracts from African plays.
2. Write short dramatic scenes or dialogues that express justice or moral conflict.
3. Use appropriate sentence types, punctuation, and grammar to show tone, emotion, and motivation.
4. Perform and discuss scenes, using expressive language and body gestures effectively.

Attitudes and values

3

1. Promote justice, equality, and respect for human dignity in everyday life
2. Appreciate literature as a mirror of social and moral realities
3. Show empathy, courage, and fairness when discussing or performing dramatic situations

INTRODUCTION

Have you ever witnessed or experienced a situation where someone was treated unfairly? In this unit, you will explore how issues of justice, fairness, and human dignity are presented through drama. You will read and analyse extracts from plays, focusing on characters, plot, and key themes. You will also practise using language features such as dialogue and expressions of cause and effect to show meaning and emotion. By the end of the unit, you will create and perform your own short dramatic texts to express ideas about justice and human dignity.

Introductory activity



Read the scenario below and discuss the questions that follow

In a local community, a young teacher, Mr. Kamali, discovered that the Local leaders had been misusing funds meant for school improvements. When he reported the issue, some Leaders accused him of lying and tried to force him to resign. Many villagers were afraid to support him because the council was powerful and influential. Mr. Kamali faced a moral dilemma: stay silent to protect himself, or continue to speak out for the rights of the children and the community.

Questions

1. What are the main injustices in this scenario? Who is affected and how?
2. What moral and ethical dilemmas does Mr. Kamali face?
3. Suggest possible actions that Mr. Kamali or the community could take to restore justice.
4. How does this scenario relate to human dignity and fairness?

4.1. Justice, corruption and human rights

Learning activities

A. Reading

Activity 4.1.1



Discuss the statements below. For each one, decide whether it is **fair** or **unfair**. Discuss why you think it is fair or unfair.

Statements:

1. A public official takes money meant for a community project.
2. Everyone is allowed to vote, regardless of gender or wealth.
3. A student is punished for reporting a teacher who is breaking school rules.
4. People are denied access to clean water because of their social status.

Activity 4.1.2



Read the following extract carefully. This is Act One, Scene One of Betrayal in the City by Francis Imbuga. It is early morning at the grave of Adika, the son of Doga and Nina, who was shot and killed under suspicious circumstances. Doga and Nina discover that someone has desecrated their son's grave on the night before an important ceremony.

Extract 1: Act One, Scene One

Stage directions: Early morning. A lonely grave surrounded by dry thorny branches. A wooden bowl sits at the centre of the grave; in it, a few silver coins. When the grave is fully lit, it will be seen that a crack runs right across it. Birds, insects, frogs etc. join in song. A drum beats, stops, beats again and stops. In the distance, a male voice laments. Now the lament fills the air as Doga enters immediately trailed by his wife, Nina, weeping silently. Slowly, they move towards the grave. Suddenly the song dies on Doga's lips. He stands still, transfixed to the spot.

DOGA:

Nina, stop where you are! What sort of mother are you? Do you now fear to set eyes on this evil that has been done on your own son's grave? For hours and hours, you shook with grief. For days you wailed over his still body as those who saw him die unfolded the story. Will you now tremble at the mere sight of the shadow of that evil? Come, come help me put the thorns in place before the morning grows out of our hands.

NINA:

Who would have thought they would follow him even to his grave? Only the final night, yet with it the ceremony is gone.

DOGA:

It is now clear that the man at whose hands my son died lives among us even now. This is proof enough. What we ignored as empty talk now begins to take on grave meaning.

NINA:

But where was Jusper when they did this? We asked him to keep watch, didn't we? Where was he when the murderers followed his brother beyond the grave? Did they get at him?

DOGA:

Come, see for yourself. Smell Nina, smell. Does not the smell of petrol penetrate your nose? Look, it was no common earthquake that made this crack. This is the work of a stray clansman, one who thinks he has the strength to fight those who taught him how to hold a spear. Thank heaven they did not get at him.

NINA:

God be praised. But ... but where is Jusper? I do not understand why he did not shout for help when he saw them do this to his brother's remains!

DOGA:

You forget the boy's illness. We were not sure that he would stay here all night. Besides, what with last night's downpour, they must have tried to do it while he took shelter. When he returned, he frightened them away.

NINA:

He is our only hope. If they should harm him, I will hang myself and raise a curse upon the whole clan.

DOGA:

Hope? I am surprised that you still talk of hope. Nina, we buried our hope the day Adika was gunned down. Come, let us not waste any more time. Get me soil.

DOGA (continued):

Get me soil, did you hear? Soil! We must fill this crack and for a while disguise the evil that lives among us. The ceremony must go on as planned. I do not want the spirits of the dead to turn wild with anger on account of a ceremony unperformed.

NINA:

It would be wrong for us to sit on this evil. We cannot outwit our ancestors. Let us do what is expected of us. Let us send word to the sub-chief and ...

DOGA:

The sub-chief! Who is the sub-chief? A mouse does not share a bowl with a cat.

B. Vocabulary

Activity 4.1.3



I. Use a dictionary or context clues from the extract to explain the following words and expressions as they are used in the text.

No.	Word / Expression	Meaning in Context
1	Transfixed	
2	Lament	
3	Wailed	
4	Desecrated	
5	Appease	
6	Vengeance	
7	stray clansman	
8	Boycott	
9	Kinsman	
10	Soliloquy	

II. Match the words in Column A with their correct meanings in Column B.

Column A	Column B
1. Persecution	a) A formal accusation of wrongdoing
2. Oppression	b) Fair treatment and respect for rights
3. Justice	c) Cruel treatment because of beliefs or identity
4. Accusation	d) Worthiness and respect as a human being
5. Dignity	e) Harsh control or authority over people

III. Write your own sentences using the following words: **appease, vengeance, transfixed, boycott, kinsman**. Each sentence should relate to themes of justice or human dignity.

C. Comprehension Questions.

Activity 4.1.4



Read the Extract again carefully and answer the following questions

1. What has happened to Adika's grave? Describe the condition Doga and Nina find it in.
2. Who is Jusper, and why was he supposed to guard the grave?
3. What reason does Doga give for Jusper's failure to prevent the desecration?
4. Why does Doga want to cover up the desecration and proceed with the ceremony? Do you agree with his decision? Explain.
5. How was Adika killed, according to Doga's account? What does this tell us about justice in Kafira?
6. Doga tells Nina, "*We buried our hope the day Adika was gunned down.*"
 - **Discussion Point:** Justice usually provides a path to closure or a better future. When the system is so corrupt that Adika's killers walk free, hope becomes a "waste of time." Can a community survive if its elders truly believe that hope is dead?
7. Doga refuses to call the sub-chief, famously stating, "*A mouse does not share a bowl with a cat.*"
 - **Discussion Point:** In a just society, the police or chiefs are meant to protect the vulnerable. Why does Doga view the authorities as predators (the cat) rather than protectors?

4.2. Listening.: Facing injustice

Learning activities 4.2

Activity 4.2.1



Discuss the following questions and share with the class.

1. What is justice?
2. What happens when people are denied their rights?
3. Have you ever seen a situation where people were treated unfairly?

Activity 4.2.2



Listen as extract 3 is read, in which Jere and Mulili arrive at Adika's grave to stop the shaving ceremony, while Doga and Nina receive the shocking news about Jusper. Then do the activities that follow.

Extract 3 (from Betrayal in the City)

JERE:

The ceremony is cancelled in the interest of peace.

DOGA:

In the interest of peace? Whose peace?

MULILI:

We want no anymore bloody bloodshed. We have seen enough.

NINA:

You took our all, but you will not take the grave from us. If you do not go now, I shall strip and show you the poor naked bones you have left me. Do you want to be blinded by the nakedness of your grandmother's agemate?

JERE:

Old man, if I had the power, I would let you go on. I would even take part in the ceremony. I knew Adika well.

DOGA:

Do you know that even as we stand here, a stranger who hardly knew him lies in prison because of him?

JERE:

Chagaga is dead. Jusper killed him. Last night. People saw him drag the body to the river. He even confessed it himself.

DOGA:

If Jusper killed Chagaga, then he is not mad. We lack a name for his illness. But days have changed. Kaleka's son, I have nothing else to offer you; take this. May God open your eyes to the suffering of your people.

QUESTIONS

1. Why is the ceremony cancelled?
2. Who is angry about the cancellation?
3. Who killed Chagaga?
4. Who is in prison?
5. What does Doga give to Jere at the end?
6. What is the main theme of the dialogue?
 - a) Love
 - b) Justice
 - c) War
 - d) Education

Activity 4.2.3



Listen again and complete the blank space

- a) "The ceremony is cancelled in the interest of"
- b) "We want no anymore bloody"
- c) "You took our all, but you will not take the from us."
- d) "Chagaga is dead. Jusper killed himnight."
- e) "May God open your eyes to the of your people

4.3.Speaking: Fighting injustice (Dramatic Performance)

Learning activities 4.3

Activity 4.3.1



This extract features Jusper, Tumbo, Nicodemo, and Mulili. Jusper is considering withdrawing from a committee task after his girlfriend Regina was mistreated. Meanwhile, the death of another committee member, Kabito, is reported as an "accident."

Question

When someone is mistreated or when a suspicious death is reported as an 'accident,' what injustices can occur, and how do they affect ordinary people in the community?

Activity 4.3.2



Read the extract below and do activities on it.

Extract 2 (from Betrayal in the City)

JUSPER:

I don't want you to feel I am betraying you. It's just that I can't go on after what has happened. Regina thinks I shouldn't, and I agree with her.

TUMBO:

I warn you that it's too dangerous. It is sabotage. You go off and think about it. We can't do without you at this crucial stage. I know how Regina must feel, but then we can't let our emotions overcome reason.

JUSPER:

I don't mind losing another year if that is what it means to stand for truth and justice.

TUMBO:

If you knew what has happened to one of us on the committee, I am sure you would postpone your eagerness to stand by truth and justice.

MULILI:

Our friend Kabito. He got fatal accident during break.

NICODEMO:

You can't be serious! Fatal did you say?

MULILI:

It is very sad and very sad. He is dead. You see, people come and report accident and I run to spot. Oh, who did me see but Kabito! The ambulance have takes the body away.

TUMBO:

Just what could have happened?

MULILI:

Accident ... Driving under influential alcohol.

NICODEMO:

Just how drunk can one get in the space of one hour?

Comprehension

I. Discuss the following questions.

1. What does this extract teach us about the cost of standing for justice?
2. Do you agree with Jusper's choice to prioritize justice over personal safety or progress? Why?
3. In real life, what challenges do people face when they try to stand for justice?
4. How should society protect people who stand for truth and justice?
5. Have you ever had to choose between doing what is right and what is safe? What did you do?
6. Why is justice important in a community or school setting?

Application activity 4.3



3. write and perform a 3-minute dialogue centered on **selective discipline** or **unequal opportunity** within a school setting on the scenario below.

Scenario:

Two students, **Sam** and **Alex**, are sitting in the hallway. Both were caught using their phones during a test. Sam (the "star" athlete/student) was given a gentle warning and told to "be careful." Alex (a quiet student with no "influence") was given a formal suspension and a zero on the test.

4.4. Language Structures

A. To construct and interpret dialogues and monologues in drama using direct and reported speech

Learning activities 4.4

Activity 4.4.1



Report what each person said in the following scenario

A student complains to the head teacher:

"The prefect punished me unfairly," said Aline.

"I followed the rules," said the prefect.

EXAMPLE:

1. Aline said that the prefect had punished her unfairly.
2. The prefect said that he had followed the rules.

Key notes

1. Present → Past (punished → had punished)
2. Pronouns change (me → her)

Activity 4.4.2



Listen to the following dialogues and convert all statements into reported speech

Dialogue 1: In the court

Judge: "Why did you break the law?"

Accused: "I was defending my rights."

Witness: "I saw everything clearly."

Dialogue 2: School Justice Case

Teacher: "Why were you fighting in class?"

Student: "He insulted me first."

Classmate: "I tried to stop them."

Dialogue 3: Community Conflict

Officer: "Who started the argument?"

Resident: "They refused to listen to us."

Neighbour: "We only wanted peace."

Activity 4.4.3



A. Mini Courtroom Project

1. Helped by the given examples below, Create a **short courtroom drama (1–2 minutes)** that includes:

1. Direct speech (scene acted)
2. Reported speech (narration after)

Example Structure:

1. Scene acted (direct speech)
2. Another student summarizes using reported speech

❖ Scene acted

Judge: "Why were you in the shop after closing hours?"

Accused: "I forgot my phone inside and came back to get it."

Shop Owner: "That is not true! I saw him hiding behind the shelves."

Police Officer: "We found him with stolen items in his bag."

2. Reported Speech (Narration)

The judge asked why the accused had been in the shop after closing hours.

The accused said that he had forgotten his phone and returned to get it.

The shop owner claimed that it was not true and said that he had seen him hiding.

The police officer added that they had found stolen items in his bag.

B. Sentence Types and Punctuation.

Different sentence types create different effects in drama. Characters use them to express emotions, give commands, ask questions, and make statements.

The Four Sentence Types

Type	Function	Punctuation	Example from Play
Declarative	Makes a statement	Full stop (.)	The ceremony is cancelled.
Interrogative	Asks a question	Question mark (?)	Where is Jusper?
Exclamatory	Expresses strong emotion	Exclamation mark (!)	How can we remain silent!
Imperative	Gives a command	Full stop (.) or (!)	Get me soil!

Activity 4.4.4



I. Identify the sentence type and its effect in each of the following lines from the play:

1. "Stop where you are!"
2. "Who would have thought they would follow him even to his grave?"
3. "It is now clear that the man at whose hands my son died lives among us."
4. "God be praised!"

II. Read the play above and identify sentences that:

1. Make a statement
2. Asks a question
3. Expresses strong emotion
4. Gives a command

C. Relative and Adverbial Clauses for Description and Motivation.

a) Relative Clauses

Relative clauses describe or give more information about a noun. They begin with relative pronouns: who, whom, whose, which, that, where, when.

Example: "The man **who betrayed his people** later sought forgiveness."

Example: "The grave, **which had been desecrated**, was found with a crack running across it."

b) Adverbial Clauses

Adverbial clauses explain why, when, where, or how something happens. They begin with subordinating conjunctions: because, although, when, while, if, since, before, after, so that.

Example: "They acted **because they believed in justice.**"

Example: *Although he was poor*, he remained honest."

Activity 4.4.5



I. Combine each pair of sentences using a relative clause

1. Adika was killed in the city. He was Doga's eldest son
2. Jusper guarded the grave. He was Adika's brother.
3. The sub-chief cancelled the ceremony. His brother was suspected of murder.

II. Complete the sentences with appropriate adverbial clauses:

1. Jusper killed Chagaga because _____.
2. Although Nina was terrified, she _____.
3. Doga filled the crack so that _____.
4. The villagers remained silent even though _____.

D. Expressions of Cause and Effect.

Understanding cause and effect helps students explain motivations and consequences in dramatic events.

Key Expressions

Expression	Example
because / because of	He was punished because he broke the law. He was punished because of broking the law.
as a result / consequently	As a result, the village regained peace. consequently, the village regained peace.
therefore / thus	Adika was killed; therefore, his family sought justice.
due to / owing to	Due to the cover-up, the truth remained hidden.
Since	Since no one spoke up, the injustice continued.
so ... that	The people were so afraid that they could not speak.
lead to / result in	Corruption led to the suffering of innocent people. Corruption resulted in the suffering of innocent people.

Activity 4.4.6



Complete the sentences with appropriate cause-and-effect expressions:

1. Jusper became violent _____ his brother was killed unjustly.
2. The ceremony was cancelled. _____, the family felt their traditions were being destroyed.
3. _____ the desecration of the grave, Doga suspected the sub-chief's family.
4. Kabito confronted the leader directly. _____, he lost his life.

E. Expressions of Contrast and Concession.

They connect ideas that **do not agree** or that show a **surprising contrast**.

Expressions of contrast and concession in drama reflect irony, moral conflict, and opposing views.

Key Expressions

- Although / Even though: "Although he was poor, he remained honest."
- Whereas: "Whereas others feared, she stood firm."
- However, / Nevertheless: "The evidence was clear; however, the court freed the suspect."
- Despite / In spite of: "Despite the danger, Jusper confessed publicly."
- While: "While Tumbo preferred caution, Jusper chose truth."

Activity 4.4.7



Join these sentences using the words in brackets

1. Jere follows orders / He sympathises with Doga's family. (Although ...)
2. Mulili claims to serve the nation / He is actually cruel and insensitive. (While ...)
3. Doga lost his son / He continues to fight for dignity. (Despite ...)

F. Participles and Participial Phrases

Participles and participial phrases create vivid stage descriptions and character actions. They are often used in stage directions and narrative writing.

Types of Participles

- **Present participle (-ing):** "Rising slowly, the elder pointed to the accused."
- **Past participle (-ed / irregular):** "Shaken by grief, Nina could barely walk."

Examples

- "Weeping silently, Nina followed her husband to the grave."
- "Transfixed to the spot, Doga stared at the damaged grave."
- "Dressed in a white shirt, Jusper confessed before the crowd."

Activity 4.4.8



Rewrite each sentence using a participial phrase

Example :Jusper laughed wildly. He entered the stage. → Laughing wildly, Jusper entered the stage.

1. Nina was overwhelmed by sorrow. She could not speak.
2. Doga was determined to protect tradition. He filled the crack with soil.
3. The crowd was terrified by Jusper's confession. They threw stones.

G. Emphatic and Inversion Structures for Dramatic Emphasis

Emphatic and inversion structures highlight emotional or moral turning points in drama. They create powerful, memorable lines.

Emphatic Structures

- **Cleft sentences:** "It was Jusper who killed Chagaga." (emphasises the doer)
- **Do / did for emphasis:** "I did tell you the truth!"

Inversion Structures

- **Never again:** "Never again will the innocent suffer in silence."
- **Not only ... but also:** "Not only did they kill Adika, but they also desecrated his grave."
- **Rarely / Seldom:** "Rarely has a community endured such injustice."
- **Only when:** "Only when the people spoke up did change begin."

Activity 4.4.9



Rewrite each sentence using an emphatic or inversion structure:

1. The people have never seen such cruelty. → Never have the people seen such cruelty.
2. Jusper killed Chagaga. (Use a cleft sentence.)
3. The family lost their son. They also lost their dignity. (Use not only ... but also.)
4. People rarely challenged the authorities. (Use inversion.)

4.5 LITERATURE: Key Features in African Drama

Learning activities 4.5

A. Characters and Characterisation

Characters are the people in a play. Characterisation is how the playwright reveals their personalities, beliefs, and motivations. In African drama, characters often represent social types or moral positions.

Methods of Characterisation

- Through dialogue: What characters say reveals who they are.
- Through actions: What characters do shows their values.
- Through stage directions: The playwright's descriptions of movement, tone, and appearance.
- Through what others say about them: Other characters' opinions provide additional insight.
- Through language style: Educated characters may speak differently from uneducated ones.

Character Analysis from *Betrayal in the City*

Character	Key Traits	Evidence
Doga	Dignified, determined, protective of tradition, grieving father	Insists on continuing the ceremony; speaks proverbs
Nina	Brave, motherly, pragmatic, emotionally strong	Threatens to strip; wants to report the crime
Jusper	Courageous, troubled, idealistic, unpredictable	Confesses publicly; says he'll stand for truth even at personal cost
Mulili	Crude, aggressive, uneducated, loyal to power	Broken English; insensitive remarks; bullies others
Jere	Sympathetic, conflicted, follows orders reluctantly	Says he would let the ceremony continue if he had power
Tumbo	Cautious, political, pragmatic, fearful	Compares them to caged animals; avoids confrontation

Activity 4.5.1



Choose one character from the play (*betrayal in the city*) and write a character sketch (150–200 words) explaining their personality, motivations, and role in the theme of justice.

B. Dramatic Devices

Dramatic devices are techniques playwrights use to create meaning, suspense, and emotional impact.

Device	Definition	Example from the Play
Irony	When reality is opposite to what is expected	Mulili claims to want peace while being the most violent character
Symbolism	Using an object or action to represent a deeper meaning	The cracked grave symbolises the broken state of justice in Kafira
Soliloquy	A speech where a character reveals thoughts to the audience	Doga's speech about cold money and the value of life
Foreshadowing	Hints about what will happen later	Doga's proverbs and warnings hint at future violence
Contrast	Placing opposites side by side for effect	Jere's sympathy vs Mulili's cruelty; Jusper's bravery vs Tumbo's caution
Proverbs	Traditional sayings that carry moral lessons	"A mouse does not share a bowl with a cat"

Activity 4.5.2



Find one example of each dramatic device below in the extracts from *Betrayal in the City*

1. Irony
2. Symbolism
3. Soliloquy
4. Foreshadowing
5. Contrast
6. proverbs

C. Common Themes in African Drama

African drama often explores themes that reflect the social, political, and moral realities of the continent. In *Betrayal in the City*, several themes intersect:

Theme	How It Is Explored in the Play
Justice and Injustice	Adika is killed unjustly; the family seeks justice but finds corruption at every level. The legal system protects the powerful.
Betrayal	Those in power betray the people they are supposed to serve. Even within communities, trust is broken.
Power and Corruption	The sub-chief and those in authority abuse their positions. Kabito's death is covered up as an accident.
Human Dignity	Doga and Nina fight to preserve the dignity of their dead son. Nina's threat to strip represents the ultimate defence of dignity.

Tradition vs Modernity	Traditional ceremonies are disrupted by modern political authority. Doga's proverbs clash with the soldiers' orders.
Courage and Sacrifice	Jusper sacrifices his safety to confess and stand for truth. He pays a heavy price.

Application activity 4.5



Create and perform a short dramatic scene on a topic related to justice using dramatic devices such as dialogue, conflict, monologue, aside, and stage directions.

Possible Topics Related to Justice

- Corruption and bribery
- School rules and punishment
- Abuse of power by leaders
- Gender equality
- Child labour
- Environmental justice
- Freedom of speech

They read and listen to their speeches, then work in groups to write and deliver their own persuasive speeches on a national issue (for example, youth participation in governance, gender equality, or community reconciliation).

Steps

1. Research: Each group selects a Rwandan or African figure known for justice, unity, or human rights. Research their life, achievements, and key speeches.
2. Read and Listen: Groups read extracts from their figure's speeches and identify rhetorical devices (repetition, emotive language, direct address, rhetorical questions).
3. Write: Each group writes an original persuasive speech (200–300 words) on a national issue. The speech must include at least three rhetorical devices and two phrasal verbs from the unit.
4. Rehearse: Groups practise delivery, focusing on tone, gestures, eye contact, and pacing.
5. Perform: Each group delivers its speech to the class.
6. Reflect: After all performances, the class discusses which speeches were most persuasive and why.

4.6 END OF UNIT ASSESSMENT

End of unit assessment



Section A: Reading Comprehension and vocabulary

Read the following extract from Henrik Ibsen's *An Enemy of the People* and answer the questions that follow

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN. [going up to him]

Do you dare to--!

MRS. STOCKMANN. [throwing herself between them] Thomas!

PETRA. [catching her father by the arm] Don't lose your temper, father!

PETER STOCKMANN. I will not expose myself to violence. Now you have had a warning; so reflect on what you owe to yourself and your family. Goodbye. [Goes out.]

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN. [walking up and down] Am I to put up with such treatment as this? In my own house, Katherine! What do you think of that!

MRS. STOCKMANN. Indeed it is both shameful and absurd, Thomas—

PETRA. If only I could give uncle a piece of my mind—

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN. It is my own fault. I ought to have flown out at him long ago!--shown my teeth!--bitten! To hear him call me an enemy to our community! Me! I shall not take that lying down, upon my soul!

MRS. STOCKMANN. But, dear Thomas, your brother has power on his side.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN. Yes, but I have right on mine, I tell you.

if you have not got might?

PETRA. Oh, mother!--how can you say such a thing!

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN. Do you imagine that in a free country it is no use having right on your side? You are absurd, Katherine. Besides, haven't I got the liberal-minded, independent press to lead the way, and the compact majority behind me? That is might enough, I should think!

MRS. STOCKMANN. But, good heavens, Thomas, you don't mean to?

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN. Don't mean to what?

MRS. STOCKMANN. To set yourself up in opposition to your brother.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN. In God's name, what else do you suppose I should do but take my stand on right and truth?

PETRA. Yes, I was just going to say that.

MRS. STOCKMANN. Oh yes, right--right. What is the use of having right on your side

MRS. STOCKMANN. But it won't do you any earthly good. If they won't do it, they won't.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN. Oho, Katherine! Just give me time, and you will see how I will carry the war into their camp.

MRS. STOCKMANN. Yes, you carry the war into their camp, and you get your dismissal--that is what you will do.

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN. In any case I shall have done my duty towards the public--towards the community, I, who am called its enemy!

MRS. STOCKMANN. But towards your family, Thomas? Towards your own home! Do you think that is doing your duty towards those you have to provide for?

PETRA. Ah, don't think always first of us, mother.

MRS. STOCKMANN. Oh, it is easy for you to talk; you are able to shift for yourself, if need be. But remember the boys, Thomas; and think a little of yourself too, and of me—

DR. THOMAS STOCKMANN. I think you are out of your senses, Katherine! If I were to be such a miserable coward as to go on my knees to Peter and his damned crew, do you suppose I should ever know an hour's peace of mind all my life afterwards?

A). Comprehension Questions

1. Identify one rhetorical question.
2. Identify one example of irony.
3. Identify the main conflict in the extract.
4. Write two messages from the extract.
5. Describe Dr Thomas Stockmann's character.
6. How is the theme of justice developed in the extract?

B). Vocabulary

Rewrite using the word in brackets.

1. He did not want to accept the decision. (**refused**)
2. She was very worried about the future. (**anxious**)
3. He supports truth and justice. (**stands for**)
4. He lost his job because of his ideas. (**dismissed**)
5. His brother controls the town. (**authority**)
6. He is not brave. (**coward**)

Section B: Grammar and Language Use

a) Rewrite using appropriate phrasal verbs :

run into, give up, call off, take off, take care of

1. She met her old friend at the market.
2. He stopped smoking last year.
3. The meeting was cancelled due to rain.
4. He removed his hat before entering.
5. She looks after her younger brother.

b) Convert the following sentences into reported speech.

1. "I will reveal the truth tomorrow," Jusper said.
2. "We have never seen such courage before," the villagers said.
3. "Do you trust me?" she asked him.
4. "You should submit the essay by tomorrow," the lecturer reminded the students.
5. "We may travel to Nairobi next month," they said.
6. "Why are you making so much noise?" the teacher asked the students.

c). Combine the sentences using relative clauses.

1. The scientist discovered a new element. She works at Oxford University.
2. The novel is very popular. It was written by Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie.
3. The man is my uncle. He is speaking on the stage.
4. I read a book. The book was very inspiring.

d) Rewrite the following sentences according to the instructions:

1. She had just entered the room when the phone rang

Begin with **"Hardly..."**

2. He understood the problem after the teacher explained it

Begin with **"Only after..."**

3. She is intelligent. She is also hardworking.

Begin with **"Not only..."**

4. I had never seen such a beautiful landscape before.

Begin with **"Never..."**

5. He worked very hard. He succeeded in the examination.

(Begin with **"Because..."**)

Section C: Writing a Short Dramatic Scene

Write a short dramatic scene (150–200 words) on one of the following topics:

1. A young person confronts a corrupt official in their community.
2. A family debates whether to forgive someone who wronged them.
3. A courtroom scene where the truth finally comes to light.

Your scene must include: at least three characters with distinct personalities; clear stage directions; a conflict and resolution; at least two phrasal verbs; correct use of direct speech with proper punctuation.

Section D: Speaking and Performance

In groups, perform a 3–5 minute scene based on a justice-related theme. Each student will be assessed on:

- Clarity and expression of dialogue
- Appropriate use of gestures and body language
- Contribution to the group's performance
- Ability to stay in character
- Message about justice or human dignity

UNIT 5

TRADITIONS AND CHANGE



Key Unit Competence:

Analyse and communicate the impact of social and cultural change on traditions and contemporary life while appreciating continuity and innovation.

Learning objectives

By the end of this unit, you will be able to:

Knowledge and understanding

1. Describe key features, themes, and messages in selected African literary works from pre-colonial, colonial, and post-colonial periods
2. Recognize how traditions and social values evolve over time as reflected in literature
3. Use various past tenses and expressions that describe beliefs, customs, and habitual practices

Skills

1. Read and interpret extracts from stories that reflect African traditions and their transformation
2. Use correct grammar (past tenses, expressions of habit, and defining/non-defining clauses) to narrate traditional stories and describe cultural changes
3. Compare and contrast different literary periods and their portrayals of African society.
4. Write short narratives, summaries, or reflections that show the link between cultural traditions and modern life
5. Present orally on traditional customs and their relevance today

Attitudes and values

3

1. Appreciate African traditions and their role in shaping identity and values
2. Respect cultural diversity and continuity while embracing positive change
3. Show pride in African literary heritage and recognize its influence on modern society

Introduction

This unit explores the meaning of tradition and how cultural practices evolve over time. Students engage with African literary texts such as the Mwindo Epic, *The River Between*, and *Things Fall Apart* to examine identity, beliefs, and the impact of change. Through listening, discussion, and storytelling, learners analyse themes, characters, and values across different periods. They develop language skills by using past tenses and relative clauses to recount traditions. Collaborative activities encourage creative retelling of folktales, while reflective writing and presentations help students evaluate which cultural values should be preserved or adapted in modern society.

Introductory activity



Think of ONE tradition from your family or community that has changed or disappeared over time.

- a) Write two or three sentences about it.
- b) Share your reflection with a partner. Discuss: Why do you think the tradition changed? Was the change positive or negative?

Discussion questions

- ❖ What is the difference between a tradition and a habit?
- ❖ Can a tradition be harmful? Give an example and explain your view.
- ❖ How does literature help us understand the traditions of people from other cultures or periods of history?

5.1. Cultural practices

Learning activities 5.1

A. Reading

Activity 5.1.1



1. Which cultural practices in your community have remained the same over time?
2. Which traditions have changed in recent years, and why do you think they changed?

Activity 5.1.2



Reading comprehension



The extract below is taken from *The River Between* by Ngũgĩ wa Thiong'o, one of Africa's most celebrated novelists. This novel is set in Kenya during the colonial period and explores the conflict between African tradition and Christian missionary influence. Read the extract carefully, paying attention to the atmosphere, the characters' feelings, and the language used.

EXTRACT FROM THE RIVER BETWEEN

Mornings were normally chilly and cold in both Kameno and Makuyu. Nyambura felt the cold bite into her skin as she sat on her already full water-barrel. She looked fixedly at her young sister, who was still in the process of filling hers. Then she looked at the pale dark water of the river. It flowed on just as it had done for years, making incessant gurgling sounds as it made its way round the projecting rocks. Nyambura was fascinated and felt attracted to the river. Her breast, glowing with pleasure, rose and fell with a sigh: she felt something strange stirring in her bowels. It was an exhilaration, a feeling of acute ecstasy, almost of pain, which always came to her as she watched the snaky movement and listened to the throb of the river.

The importance of Honia could never be overestimated. Cattle, goats and people drew their water from there. Perhaps that was why it was called 'Cure' and the valley, the valley of life; that is what it was, a valley of life.

During the initiation ceremonies, boys and girls came to wet their bodies here on the morning of circumcision. It had long been discovered that very cold water numbed the skin, making it less painful during the operation. Nyambura thought of this and felt slightly guilty. She looked apprehensively at her sister, who was still drawing water. Nyambura wondered whether such thoughts ever came to Muthoni. She thought not and envied her. For Nyambura had learnt and knew that circumcision was sinful. It was a pagan rite from which she and her sister had been saved. A daughter of God should never let even a thought of circumcision come to her mind. Girls of their age would be initiated this season. Had her father, Joshua, not been a man of God, he, no doubt, would have presented them both as candidates

'Nyambura, sister—'

Nyambura woke up from her wicked reverie. Her sister had spoken to her. Nyambura looked at her and wondered. What was worrying Muthoni? What was gnawing at the young girl's spirit? Nyambura was in no doubt that something was the matter with Muthoni. All through the week and in fact all through the last two months she had noticed something moody and restless in the young girl. This had pained Nyambura. She loved her sister.

Indeed, the two were inseparable. They played and worked together. Nyambura was older, but it was not easy to tell this. Both were fairly tall and well formed; about the same height and looks, though Muthoni's skin was darker. They had the same sharp but strangely restless eyes. Their hair was thick and shiny black. It was tough but to the eyes it looked soft and beautiful to touch.

Nyambura's features seemed hard, restrained. Where she was quiet, Muthoni was vivacious.

So it was not surprising that Nyambura should have noticed this sudden change of spirits. Coming to the river that morning Muthoni had been more withdrawn than ever before. Nyambura was deeply disturbed because her earlier attempts to coax her to reveal her troubles had failed. Now she waited for her to continue. Muthoni was sitting on her own water-barrel.

'I want to tell you something,' she said.

'Oh, please do,' Nyambura responded eagerly, her curiosity sharpened.

'But promise me that you will keep what I tell you to yourself.' This was an appeal, an appeal almost of fear. Nyambura would have laughed but for the earnestness in the voice and look of her sister.

'Well, first tell me about that something,' Nyambura said carelessly. She wanted to make her sister relax and soften the tense look on her face. Muthoni raised her face to Nyambura. This time the appeal was quite unmistakable.

'I have thought and thought again about it. I have not been able to eat or sleep properly. My thoughts terrify me. But I think now I have come to a decision.' She stopped; gazing past Nyambura, she said, slowly and quietly:

'Nyambura, I want to be circumcised.'

For a second Nyambura sat as if her thoughts, her feelings, her very being had been paralysed. She could not speak. The announcement was too sudden and too stupefying. How could she believe what she had heard? How had such words come from Muthoni's mouth? She looked at the river, at the slightly swaying bulrushes lining the banks, and then beyond. Nothing moved on the huge cattle road that wound through the forest towards Kameno. The yellowish streaks of morning light diffused through the forest, producing long shadows on the cattle path. The insects in the forest kept up an incessant sound which mingled with the noise of falling water farther down the valley. They helped to intensify the silence, created by Muthoni's statement.

'Circumcised?' At last Nyambura found her voice. 'Yes.' 'But Father will not allow it. He will be very cross with you. And how can you think of it?' Nyambura could visualize Joshua's fury if he heard of this. 'Besides,' she continued, 'you are a Christian. You and I are now wise in the ways of the white people. Father has been teaching us what he learnt at Siriana. And you know, the missionaries do not like the circumcision of girls. Father has been saying so. Besides, Jesus told us it was wrong and sinful.'

'I know. But I want to be circumcised.'

" why Nyambura asked helplessly"

She knew quite well that her father would not hear of such a thing. Every man of God knew that this was a pagan rite against which, time and time again, the white missionaries had warned Joshua. Perhaps Satan had gone into Muthoni. That was how the devil worked. Nyambura tried to reason with her sister.

Yes, tell me. Why do you want this? You know this is the devil's work. You know how he tempted people. You and I are

Christians. Were we not baptized long ago? Are you not now saved from sin?' Nyambura was becoming passionate. She breathed hard and she felt a warmth inside. She was defending something; she was trying to save her sister.

'I know but—' Muthoni paused. She had never seen her sister like that, with that light in her eyes. She felt weak in the knees and thought she was wrong. But the next moment she jumped up and rushed to her sister. She spoke earnestly and passionately. After all, she too believed in what she was going to do. Nyambura clasped her arms and they remained locked in each other's arms like little children. Nyambura became alarmed at the passion in Muthoni. She spoke gently:

'Father and Mother—'

'Look, please, I – I want to be a woman. I want to be a real girl, a real woman, knowing all the ways of the hills and ridges.'

'But Father, remember him.'

'Why! Are we fools?' She shook Nyambura. 'Father and mother are circumcised. Are they not Christians? Circumcision did not prevent them from being Christians. I too have embraced the white man's faith. However, I know it is beautiful, oh so beautiful to be initiated into womanhood. You learn the ways of the tribe. Yes, the white man's God does not quite satisfy me. I want, I need something more. My life and your life are here,

in the hills, that you and I know.' She spoke now, looking beyond Nyambura as if to some other people. Then she lowered her voice and whispered secretly, 'Father said that at the Mission there is that man – Livingstone – and many women. Those are his wives. And do you think that he, a man, would marry a woman not circumcised? Surely there is no tribe that does not circumcise. Or how does a girl grow into a woman?' Muthoni had now released herself from the grasp. She now stood and looked away from Nyambura.

Nyambura could not say anything. She did not follow Muthoni's logic or line of thought. She had never thought so deeply about these things. She was content to follow whatever her father said was right. And she feared his anger.

A. VOCABULARY

Activity 5.1.3



I. Choose the closest synonym

❖ *Incessant*

- a) Loud
- b) Continuous
- c) Slow
- d) Dangerous

❖ *Apprehensively*

- a) Happily
- b) Fearfully
- c) Angrily
- d) Calmly

❖ *Vivacious*

- a) Quiet
- b) Weak
- c) Lively
- d) Proud

❖ *Stupefying*

- a) Confusing and shocking
- b) Exciting
- c) Boring
- d) Pleasant

II. Complete using appropriate words from the text:

- The river made _____ gurgling sounds as it flowed.
- Nyambura looked at her sister _____, full of fear.
- Muthoni was more _____ and lively than Nyambura.
- Nyambura felt a strange _____ as she watched the river.
- The announcement left Nyambura _____ and unable to speak.

III. Match words to their meanings

Word	Meaning
Exhilaration	a) Extreme happiness
Reverie	b) Deep thought/daydream
Gnawing	c) Persistent worry
Coax	d) Persuade gently

C. Comprehension questions

Activity 5.1.4



I. Read the text and Choose the correct answer

1. Nyambura is fascinated by the river mainly because it:
 - a) Provides water for the community
 - b) Represents her childhood memories
 - c) Creates a deep emotional and physical response in her
 - d) Separates Kamenno and Makuyu
2. The river Honia is called "Cure" because:
 - a) It heals diseases
 - b) It is used in initiation ceremonies
 - c) It sustains life in the valley
 - d) It belongs to the missionaries
3. Nyambura feels guilty because:
 - a) She envies her sister
 - b) She considers circumcision sinful
 - c) She disobeys her father
 - d) She fears the river
4. Muthoni's desire to be circumcised shows:
 - a) Rejection of all traditions
 - b) Total obedience to her father
 - c) Conflict between Christianity and tradition
 - d) Fear of growing up

5. Nyambura's reaction to Muthoni's decision can best be described as:

- a) Supportive
- b) Indifferent
- c) Shocked and fearful
- d) Angry

II. Answer the following questions

1. Explain the symbolic significance of the river in the extract.
2. Why does Nyambura consider circumcision sinful?
3. What internal conflict does Muthoni experience?
4. How does the extract reflect colonial influence on African society?
5. Analyse how the author presents the conflict between tradition and Christianity.
6. Compare Nyambura and Muthoni's attitudes toward culture and religion.
7. Evaluate whether Muthoni's decision is an act of courage or rebellion

5.2. Listening: Cultural Change

Learning activities

Activity 5.2.1



Listen as the text is read and answer questions.

- Why do people keep traditions?
- Why do some traditions change?
- Do young people always agree with old traditions?
- What happens when religion or modern education conflicts with tradition.

Activity 5.2.2



Listen and answer questions that follow

A listening script



During the initiation ceremonies, boys and girls came to wet their bodies here on the morning of circumcision... Nyambura thought of this and felt slightly guilty. She looked apprehensively at her sister. For Nyambura had learnt and knew that circumcision was sinful. It was a pagan rite from which she and her sister had been saved.

'Nyambura, I want to be circumcised.' For a second Nyambura sat as if her thoughts, her feelings, her very being had been paralysed. She could not speak. The announcement was too sudden and too stupefying. How could she believe what she had heard?

'I want to be a woman. I want to be a real girl, a real woman, knowing all the ways of the hills and ridges... The white man's God does not quite satisfy me. I want, I need something more. My life and your life are here, in the hills, that you and I know.'

Comprehension

I. Choose the correct answer:

1. During initiation ceremonies, young people:
 - a) Sing songs
 - b) Wash in the river
 - c) Climb hills
2. Nyambura feels guilty because:
 - a) She wants to join the ceremony
 - b) She believes the practice is wrong
 - c) She fears her sister
3. Nyambura's reaction to her sister's words is:
 - a) Anger
 - b) Silence and shock
 - c) Happiness
4. The sister wants circumcision because:
 - a) She is forced
 - b) She wants to feel mature
 - c) She wants to travel
5. The sister feels that:
 - a) Modern religion fully satisfies her
 - b) Tradition is meaningless
 - c) She needs something more than what she has

II. Listen again and Answer these questions

- A) Why does Nyambura remain silent after hearing her sister?
- B) What internal conflict does Nyambura experience?
- C) Why does the sister reject "the white man's God"?
- D) What does "I want to be a real woman" suggest about her beliefs?

5.3.Speaking: Traditional beliefs and change

Learning activities 5.3

Activity 5.3.1



Think about the following questions and share with the class.

1. One traditional belief you know
2. Whether it is still followed today or not.
3. If it has changed, how it has changed.

Application activity 5.3



I. Prepare a short presentation or dramatized retelling of a traditional story. Your presentation should illustrate both the original version of the tradition and how it has changed or been reinterpreted in modern life.

II.

Create and perform a dialogue between a grandparent who believes traditions must be preserved and a young person who believes traditions should change.

5.4. Language Structures

A. Past Tenses

This section covers four key past tenses used to narrate myths, legends, folktales, and historical events. Study each tense carefully, noting its form, use, and examples drawn from the texts studied in this unit.

1. Simple Past Tense

Form: Subject + Past Tense Verb (regular: -ed; irregular: vary)

Use: To describe completed actions or events at a specific time in the past.

Example 1: 'Nyambura felt the cold bite into her skin.' (The River Between)

Example 2: 'At dawn, we gathered on the ridge.' (Mwindo Epic)

Note: The simple past is the foundation of storytelling — it drives the narrative forward.

Activity 5.4.1



Rewrite the paragraph below changing the verbs into simple past

Last month, we celebrate a cultural ceremony. Many people come from different villages. The elders speak about our traditions and give advice. Some young people do not understand the importance of the event, but they enjoy the food and music.

2. Past Continuous Tense

Form: Subject + was/were + Verb-ing

Use: To describe an ongoing action at a specific time in the past, or a background action interrupted by another.

Example 1: 'Her sister was still in the process of filling hers.' (The River Between)

Example 2: 'The insects in the forest were keeping up an incessant sound.' (The River Between)

Example 3: 'The warriors were advancing while the enemies were retreating.' (Mwindo Epic)

Key Pattern: Past Continuous (background) + Simple Past (interruption): 'Nyambura was sitting on the barrel when Muthoni spoke.'

Activity 5.4.2



Combine each pair of sentences using the Past Continuous and Simple Past:

- a) Okonkwo / sleep. The town-crier / beat his ogene.
- b) The sisters / carry water. Muthoni / make her announcement.
- c) The warriors / fight. The sun / rise.

3. Past Perfect Tense

Form: Subject + had + Past Participle

Use: To describe an action completed before another past action. Shows sequence of events clearly.

Example 1: 'The elders told stories as the fire burned, and the moon had risen high.'

Example 2: 'Okonkwo was the first to bring home a human head. That was his fifth head.' He had already brought four heads before this war.

Example 3: 'He had discerned a clear overtone of tragedy in the crier's voice.'

Key Pattern: By the time + Simple Past ... + Past Perfect (already).

Activity 5.4.3



Write a short paragraph (4–5 sentences) describing what happened in the Mwindo Epic before the battle began, using the Past Perfect tense.

4. Past Perfect Continuous Tense

Form: Subject + had been + Verb-ing

Use: To emphasize the duration of an action that was ongoing up to a specific point in the past.

Example 1: 'Muthoni had been thinking and thinking about it for months.'

Example 2: 'Okonkwo had been ruling his household with a heavy hand for years.'

Contrast with Past Perfect: Past Perfect = completed action. Past Perfect Continuous = emphasizes duration of ongoing action.

Example 3: 'They had been fighting all morning before the river blocked their path.'

Activity 5.4.4



Complete the sentences with the Past Perfect Continuous form of the verb:

1. Nyambura _____ (worry) about her sister for weeks.
2. The warriors _____ (march) for hours when they reached the river.
3. Okonkwo _____ (plan) his response to the threat from the neighbouring clan.

B. Expressions of Belief, Habit, and Custom

African oral and written literature frequently describes traditional practices, beliefs, and habitual customs. The following structures are used to express these ideas with precision and authenticity.

Structure 1: USED TO + Base Verb (past habit / situation that no longer exists)

Example: 'People used to gather under the big tree to share stories.'

Example: 'Women used to fetch water from the river every morning before sunrise.'

Note: 'Used to' implies the habit no longer happens today. It does NOT exist in Present Tense.

Structure 2: WOULD + Base Verb (repeated past action)

Example: 'On moonlit nights, children would play in open fields.'

Example: 'The elders would always tell stories as the fire burned.'

Note: 'Would' is interchangeable with 'used to' for habits, but NOT for past states (e.g., NOT: 'I would be young.' use: 'I used to be young.')

Structure 3: ALWAYS / OFTEN / NEVER / RARELY + Simple Past (frequency adverbs)

Example: 'Okonkwo always worked from cock-crow until the chickens went to roost.'

Example: 'The Oracle rarely permitted Umuofia to go to war without just cause.'

Example: 'Children were never allowed to whistle at night for fear of evil spirits.'

Activity 5.4.5



Rewrite each sentence using '**used to**' or '**would**':

- a) In the past, the whole village gathered for initiation ceremonies. (used to)
- b) Every evening, the king's praise-singer recited the names of heroes. (would)
- c) Young men brought gifts to the elders before receiving blessings. (would)

Activity 5.4.6



Write five sentences about traditions in your community using "used to, would, always, often, or never."

C. Defining and Non-Defining Relative Clauses

Relative clauses add important or additional information about a noun. They are essential tools for explaining cultural ideas clearly and elaborately in both academic writing and literary analysis.

Defining Relative Clauses — Identify **WHICH** person, thing, or idea is being described

Form: ... who / that / which / whose / where + additional information ... (NO commas)

Example 1: 'The river **that** flows between Kameno and Makuyu is called Honia.'

Example 2: 'Initiation ceremonies **that** mark the passage into adulthood are central to Gikuyu identity.'

Example 3: 'Okonkwo is the warrior **who** brought home five human heads.'

Key: Without the defining clause, the sentence is incomplete or changes meaning entirely.

Non-Defining Relative Clauses — Add **EXTRA** information about an already-identified noun

Form: ..., who / which / whose / where + additional information, ... (USE commas)

Example 1: 'Respect for elders, **which is deeply valued in our culture**, teaches humility.'

Example 2: 'Honia River, **which means Cure**, gives life to both Kameno and Makuyu.'

Example 3: 'Okonkwo, **whose father was called Unoka**, was driven by fear of failure.'

Key: The non-defining clause can be removed without changing the core meaning of the sentence.

Activity 5.4.7



Combine the two sentences using a defining or non-defining relative clause. Add commas where necessary.

- a) The Mwindo Epic is a pre-colonial text. It tells the story of heroism and brotherhood.
- b) Ngũgĩ wa Thiong'o wrote *The River Between*. He is one of Africa's greatest novelists.
- c) Circumcision was an important rite. It marked a girl's entry into womanhood.
- d) Joshua was Muthoni's father. His faith was deeply shaped by the missionaries.

Activity 5.4.8



Write three sentences using non-defining relative clauses to describe traditions from your community or from one of the literary texts.

Write three sentences using non-defining relative clauses to describe traditions from your community or from one of the literary texts.

5.5 Literature: African Literary Traditions Across Three Periods (precolonial, colonial and post-colonial)

This section provides detailed analysis of the three key periods. For each period, you will examine the form, purpose and key characteristics with a Short extract to serve as an example. Analysis questions and activities are embedded throughout.

A. Pre-Colonial Literature

Before the widespread introduction of European scripts, African literature was primarily **oral** (often called **Orature**). It was spoken because it was **communal**.

- **Primary Form:** Folk tales, myths, epics (like the *Epic of Sundiata*), proverbs, and riddles.
- **Purpose:** Didactic. It was meant to teach history, morality, and social roles to the youth.
- **Key Characteristics:**
 - **The Collective Voice:** Stories didn't belong to one "author" but to the community.
 - **Performance-Based:** It relied on music, dance, and audience participation (call-and-response).
 - **Anthropomorphism:** Animals (like the Tortoise or Anansi the Spider) were used to satirize human behavior.

An example of pre-colonial african literature: The Mwindo Epic

Background and Context

The Mwindo Epic is one of the most celebrated oral epics of sub-Saharan Africa, originating from the Nyanga people of the Democratic Republic of Congo. It was first transcribed and translated by Belgian anthropologist Daniel Biebuyck in collaboration with Kahombo Mateene in the 1960s, providing the world with a remarkable window into pre-colonial African literary tradition.

The epic centres on Mwindo, a supernatural hero born with extraordinary powers who defies death, battles spirits, journeys to the underworld, and ultimately becomes a wise and just ruler. The Mwindo Epic carries a community's deepest values: courage, justice, humility, respect for elders, and the sacred relationship between humans and the natural world.

Genre: The Oral Epic

The oral epic is one of the oldest literary genres in the world. Key features of the genre include:

- a) A heroic protagonist who undertakes extraordinary challenges.
- b) Supernatural elements: gods, spirits, magical powers, and divine intervention.
- c) A performance tradition: the epic is meant to be sung or chanted by a specialist performer (the bard) to a community audience.
- d) Repetition and formulaic phrases that aid memory and emphasize key values.
- e) A moral framework: the hero's journey teaches important lessons about how to live well.

Reading the Extract: Battle Against Abamburankanda

Myambitagoramba, I bow down,

To tell you of our battle with the enemies of Abamburankanda.

At dawn, we gathered on the ridge,

Eyes sharp, spears ready, hearts full of courage.

I called Kampeta, Rukaragandekwe,

Ndekezi lifted the shield of the fallen,

Bigango, strong and mighty, stood tall,

Whenever someone fell, another jumped forward to take their place.

O King, heroism is not only in fighting the enemies,

But in helping each other, standing together,

And in hearts that never break.

Themes in the Mwindo Epic

Theme	Evidence and Explanation
Heroism and Collective Courage	The epic celebrates not individual glory but shared bravery. 'Whenever someone fell, another jumped forward to take their place.' This reflects the pre-colonial African value of communal responsibility over individual achievement.
Leadership and Wisdom	The narrator addresses the King respectfully, 'I bow down.' Wisdom in leadership is gained through experience, humility, and listening to the stories of warriors. The hero earns authority through action, not birth alone.
Brotherhood and Unity	Warriors are named individually — Kampeta, Bigango, Nshwekure — but act as one. 'Heroism is not only in fighting but in helping each other, standing together.' The text honours interdependence.
Community and Memory	The story is told so it will be remembered and passed on: 'Our story traveled far, carried by those who saw it.' Oral tradition is itself a form of cultural preservation.
Moral Responsibility	The epic ends not with celebration of conquest but with reflection: 'O King, heroism is... in hearts that never break.' True strength is moral, not merely physical.

Activity 5.5.1



Read "the Mwindo Epic" extract and answer the following questions that reflect pre-colonial African literature.

1. In the *Mwindo Epic*, the narrator often interacts with the audience. How does this "communal" style of storytelling reflect the pre-colonial value of the group over the individual?
2. Mwindo starts as a boastful, magically powerful child but ends as a wise king who respects his elders. What does this transformation tell us about the pre-colonial definition of a "good leader"?
3. In this epic, gods and animals are active characters. How does this reflect the pre-colonial African worldview regarding the relationship between man and the environment?

B. Colonial African Literature

As European powers moved in, African literature began to transition into written form, often in European languages (English, French, Portuguese). This era is defined by the **culture clash**.

1. **Primary Form:** The novel and the protest poem.
2. **Purpose:** Resistance and "Writing Back." Authors sought to prove that Africa had a rich culture before the "civilizing mission" arrived.

3. Key Characteristics:

- A. The "Clash of Civilizations":** Focuses on the tension between traditional African values and Western Christianity/Education.
- B. Themes of Alienation:** Characters often feel like "Between Two Worlds" (e.g: the river between).
- C. The "Tragic Hero":** Leaders who cannot adapt to the new colonial law and meet a tragic end.

An example of colonial african Literature: The river between (by Ngũgĩ wa Thiong'o)

Background and Context

Ngũgĩ wa Thiong'o is one of Africa's most significant and politically engaged writers. Born in Kenya in 1938, he wrote *The River Between*, his first novel, while still a student at Makerere University in Uganda. The novel is set in the Kenyan highlands, in the period when Christian missionaries were actively reshaping Gikuyu society through religion and education.

The Honia River, which flows between the two ridges of Kameno and Makuyu, becomes a central symbol: it is simultaneously a source of life ('Honia' means 'Cure'), a boundary between opposing worldviews, and a reminder of the community's shared origins. The novel follows Waiyaki, a young man who dreams of uniting the two ridges through education, and Muthoni, whose desire to be circumcised as both a Christian and a Gikuyu woman leads to tragedy.

Genre: The African Novel

The River Between belongs to the genre of the African novel, which emerged strongly in the 1950s–1970s as African writers began reclaiming their own stories in the aftermath of colonialism. Key features include:

- a) Engagement with colonial and post-colonial politics and identity.
- b) Rich description of landscape as cultural and spiritual symbol.
- c) Characters torn between two worlds: tradition and modernity, African and Western values.
- d) Use of African languages, proverbs, and oral storytelling traditions within the novel form.

Themes in *The River Between*

- a) The conflict between African tradition and Christian missionary influence.
- b) Female identity and the right to self-determination in the figure of Muthoni.
- c) Division within communities: Kameno vs. Makuyu, tradition vs. modernity.
- d) The river as a symbol of continuity, life, separation, and possible reconciliation.
- e) Education and leadership as tools for both liberation and betrayal.

Activity 5.5.2



Read the novel "the River Between" and answer the following questions that reflect colonial african literature

1. Makuyu and Kameno are separated by a river. How does this physical landscape represent the internal conflict of the characters caught between Christianity and Gikuyu tradition?
2. Waiyaki believes that "Western education" can be used to save his people's land. Why does this strategy ultimately lead to his downfall? Is education presented as a bridge or a barrier?
3. Compare the characters of Muthoni and Nyambura. How do their different choices regarding tradition and religion highlight the specific pressures put on African women during the colonial?

C. Post-Colonial Literature

After independence (roughly 1960s onward), the "enemy" changed. The focus shifted from the white colonizer to the **local leader** who failed to deliver on the promises of freedom.

1. **Primary Form:** Satirical plays, political novels, and experimental poetry.
2. **Purpose:** Social critique and the "decolonization of the mind."
3. **Key Characteristics:**
 - A. **Disillusionment:** The realization that independence just brought a new set of "black masters" (e.g., Francis Imbuga's *Betrayal in the City*).
 - B. **Neo-Colonialism:** Exploring how Western powers still control the economy and culture through "remote control."
 - C. **Linguistic Rebellion:** Authors like Ngugi wa Thiong'o began rejecting English to write in indigenous languages (Gikuyu) to truly "decolonize."

An example of post- colonial Literature: A man of the people (Chinua Achebe)

Historical context

The novel is set in the **early 1960s**, soon after countries like Nigeria gained independence from colonial rule.

- Many African nations expected **freedom, progress, and equality**
- Instead, there was **corruption, poor leadership, and political instability**
- Leaders often behaved like the former colonial rulers
- The novel reflects the situation leading to events like the 1966 Nigerian military coup

Political background

The story takes place in a **new African government** after independence.

- Politics is full of bribery, favoritism, and manipulation
- Leaders like Chief Nanga represent the new ruling elite
- Ordinary citizens are often poor and powerless
- Success depends on connections ("who you know")
- The novel criticizes how **democracy is abused** in postcolonial Africa.

Social background

Achebe shows a society divided between **rich and poor**.

- Educated young people (like Odili) struggle to succeed honestly
- A small group of leaders live in **luxury**
- Many people still live in **poverty and unemployment**
- There is conflict between **traditional values and modern life**

Author's Purpose

Chinua Achebe wrote the novel to:

1. Expose corruption and bad leadership
2. Show how independence did not solve all problems
3. Warn Africans about the dangers of greed and misuse of power

Extract from "A man of the People" (by Chinua Achebe)

Activity 5.5.3



Read this extract and answer questions that follow.

A common saying in the country after Independence was that it didn't matter what you knew but who you knew. And, believe me, it was no idle talk. For a person like me who simply couldn't stoop to lick any Big Man's boots it created a big problem. In fact one reason why I took this teaching job in a bush, private school instead of a smart civil service job in the city with car, free housing, etc., was to give myself a certain amount of autonomy. So when I told the Minister that I had applied for a scholarship to do a post-graduate Certificate of Education in London it did not even cross my mind to enlist his help. I think it is important to stress this point. I had had scholarships both to the secondary school and to the University without any godfather's help but purely on my own merit. And in any case it wasn't too important whether I did the post-graduate course or not. As far as I was concerned the important thing was going to be the opportunity of visiting Europe which in itself must be a big education.

My friend Andrew Kadibe, who did the same course the previous year, seemed to have got a big kick out of it. I don't mean the white girls---you can have those out

here nowadays---but quite small things. I remember him saying for instance that the greatest delight of his entire visit to Britain was when, for the first time in his twenty-seven years, a white man---a taxi-driver I think---carried his suitcase and said 'Sir' to him. He was so thrilled he tipped the man ten shillings. We laughed a lot about it but I could so easily see it happen. But much as I wanted to go to Europe I wasn't going to sell my soul for it or beg anyone to help me.

It was the Minister himself who came back to the postgraduate question at the end of his reception without any prompting whatever from me. (As a matter of fact I tried hard to avoid catching his attention again.) And the proposals he made didn't seem to me to be offensive in any way. He invited me to come and spend my holidays with him in the capital and while I was there he would try and find out from his Cabinet colleague, the Minister of Overseas Training, whether there was anything doing. 'If you come as soon as you close,' he said, 'you can stay in my guest-room with everything complete--bedroom, parlour, bathroom, latrine, everything---self-contained. You can live by yourself and do anything you like there, it's all yours.....

1. How does the extract show that **connections are more important than merit** in postcolonial society?
2. In what ways does the extract reflect **corruption and favoritism**?
3. How does Odili represent the **honest but struggling African youth** after independence?
4. What does the Minister's offer reveal about **power and privilege** in postcolonial Africa?
5. How does the extract suggest that **independence has not fully improved society**?
6. Using examples from the extract, discuss the theme of **corruption in postcolonial African society**.

D. Comparative Literature Analysis: Three Periods of African Literature

A major difference across these Three eras is the **intended audience**.

1. **Pre-colonial** stories were for the immediate village.
2. **Colonial** writers often wrote for the "Global North" to justify African humanity.
3. **Post-colonial** writers are often writing to their own citizens, urging them to wake up and demand better governance.

Activity 5.5.4



Having studied all three texts, complete the following comparative analysis table. Use evidence from each text to support your answers.

Element	Mwindo (Pre-colonial)	Epic	The River Between (Colonial)	A man of the people (Post-colonial)
Genre				
Key Tradition Portrayed				
Intended audience				
Role of Community				
Main theme				
Key Message				

5.6 Writing

Activity 5.6.1



Write a reflective paragraph (100- 150 words) about a tradition from your community or country that has changed over time. Your paragraph should:

1. Describe the original tradition and its cultural significance.
2. Explain how and why it changed (due to religion, modernization, education, migration, etc.).
3. Reflect on whether the change was positive, negative, or mixed.
4. Use at least two past tenses and one expression of habit (used to / would / always).

Model Reflective Paragraph

In my grandmother's village, the community used to gather every harvest season under the oldest tree in the valley. Elders would tell stories of ancestors who had worked the same land, while younger members learned the names of medicinal plants, the proper way to greet respected guests, and the songs that accompanied every major life event. This tradition had been practised for generations before it began to fade. As families migrated to cities and formal schooling replaced seasonal rhythms, fewer and fewer young people returned for the harvest gathering. Today, only a handful of elderly community members still maintain the practice. While I believe the changes brought by education and modern life have created important opportunities, I also feel that something valuable has been lost — the sense of belonging and collective memory that the harvest gathering once provided. Perhaps a way forward is to adapt, not abandon: to find new ways to tell our stories that honour both our roots and our future.

Highlighted grammar: used to gather | would tell | had been practised | began to fade | have created | have been lost

Activity 5.6.2



Write a comparative essay (350–500 words) showing how African traditions have evolved across the three literary periods studied in this unit. Use evidence from at least TWO of the three texts: Mwindo Epic, The River Between, and Things Fall Apart.

Essay Structure Guide

Section	What to Include
Introduction	Define 'tradition' and 'change'. State your thesis: how do the three texts show different aspects of how African traditions have evolved?
Body Paragraph 1	Discuss the pre-colonial period (Mwindo Epic): What traditions are celebrated? What values are promoted? Use specific examples from the text.
Body Paragraph 2	Discuss the colonial period (The River Between): How does colonization challenge or disrupt traditional practices? What is the cost of this disruption?
Body Paragraph 3	Discuss the post-colonial period (A Man of the People): How does Achebe portray corruption and leadership failure after independence?
Comparative Analysis	Compare TWO or THREE of the texts: How do they treat the same themes differently? What has changed across periods?
Conclusion	Summarize your main findings. Reflect: What can we learn from these three texts about preserving what is valuable while embracing necessary change?

5.7 End of Unit Assessment

End of unit assessment



Read the following short extract from Things Fall Apart, then answer all questions

Okonkwo ruled his household with a heavy hand. His wives, especially the youngest, lived in perpetual fear of his fiery temper, and so did his little children. Perhaps down in his heart Okonkwo was not a cruel man. But his whole life was dominated by fear, the fear of failure and of weakness. It was deeper and more intimate than the fear of evil and capricious gods and of magic, the fear of the forest, and the forces of nature, malevolent, red in tooth and claw. Okonkwo's fear was greater than these. It was not external but lay deep within himself.

It was the fear of himself, lest he should be found to resemble his father. Even as a little boy he had resented his father's failure and weakness, and even now he still remembered how he had suffered when a playmate had told him that his father was *agbala*. That was how Okonkwo first came to know that *agbala* was not only another name for a woman, it could also mean a man who had taken no title. And so Okonkwo was ruled by one passion – to hate everything that his father Unoka had loved. One of those things was gentleness and another was idleness.

During the planting season Okonkwo worked daily on his farms from cock-crow until the chickens went to roost. He was a very strong man and rarely felt fatigue. But his wives and young children were not as strong, and so they suffered. But they dared not complain openly. Okonkwo's first son, Nwoye, was then twelve years old but was already causing his father great anxiety for his incipient laziness. At any rate, that was how it looked to his father, and he sought to correct him by constant nagging and beating. And so Nwoye was developing into a sad-faced youth.

Okonkwo's prosperity was visible in his household. He had a large compound enclosed by a thick wall of red earth. His own hut, or *obi*, stood immediately behind the only gate in the red walls. Each of his three wives had her own hut, which together formed a half moon behind the *obi*. The barn was built against one end of the red walls, and long stacks of yam stood out prosperously in it. At the opposite end of the compound was a shed for the goats, and each wife built a small attachment to her hut for the hens. Near the barn was a small house, the 'medicine house' or shrine where Okonkwo kept the wooden symbols of his personal god and of his ancestral spirits. He worshipped them with sacrifices of kola nut, food and palm-wine, and offered prayers to them on behalf of himself, his three wives and eight children.

So when the daughter of Umuofia was killed in Mbaino, Ikemefuna came into Okonkwo's household. When Okonkwo brought him home that day he called his most senior wife and handed him over to her.

'He belongs to the clan,' he told her. 'So look after him.'

'Is he staying long with us?' she asked.

'Do what you are told, woman,' Okonkwo thundered, and stammered. 'When did you become one of the *ndichie* of Umuofia?'

And so Nwoye's mother took Ikemefuna to her hut and asked no more questions.

As for the boy himself, he was terribly afraid. He could not understand what was happening to him or what he had done. How could he know that his father had taken a hand in killing a daughter of Umuofia? All he knew was that a few men had arrived at their house, conversing with his father in low tones, and at the end he had been taken out and handed over to a stranger. His mother had wept bitterly, but he had been too surprised to weep. And so the stranger had brought him, and a girl, a long, long way from home, through lonely forest paths. He did not know who the girl was, and he never saw her again.

SECTION A: COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

Read the story and answer questions

1. What does the word *agbala* mean in the text?
2. Explain why Okonkwo feared being like his father.
3. Why was Ikemefuna afraid when he arrived in Okonkwo's household?
4. If you were Ikemefuna, how would you react in this situation?
5. Compare Okonkwo and his father Unoka. How are they different?
6. Do you think Okonkwo is a cruel man? Give reasons for your answer.
7. Evaluate the way Ikemefuna is treated when he arrives. Is it fair?
8. Identify two details in the extract that reflect pre-colonial Igbo life and beliefs.

SECTION B: VOCABULARY

- a) Explain the meaning of the phrase: **"ruled his household with a heavy hand."**
- b) What does **"incipient laziness"** suggest about Nwoye?
- c) Explain the meaning of 'malevolent, red in tooth and claw. and Oral tradition (folktales, myths, legends, proverbs, songs)

SECTION C: GRAMMAR

1.Fill in each blank with the correct form of the past tense (Simple Past, Past Continuous, Past Perfect, or Past Perfect Continuous): (9 marks)

- a) By the time Muthoni _____ (announce) her decision, Nyambura _____ (sense) something was wrong for weeks.
- b) The warriors _____ (fight) bravely when suddenly the enemy _____ (retreat).
- c) Okonkwo _____ (not sleep) for several hours when the town-crier _____ (wake) him.
- d) The community _____ (prepare) for the harvest festival for days before it finally _____ (begin).

2.Rewrite each sentence using the expression given in brackets: (4 marks)

1. In the past, people gathered under the tree for stories. (used to)
2. Every night, the elders told stories to the children. (would)

3.Combine the sentences using a relative clause. Add commas if necessary and state whether it is Defining or Non-Defining: (6 marks)

- a) Okonkwo was a man of war. He was the first to bring home a human head.
- b) The Honia River was called 'Cure.' It flowed between Kamenno and Makuyu.
- c) The Mwindo Epic tells the story of heroism. It originates from the Nyanga people of the DRC.

4. Identify and correct the errors in the following sentences:

- a) Muthoni who she wanted to be circumcised, spoke to her sister at the river.
- b) The Mwindo Epic that it is an oral epic was sung by trained performers.
- c) Okonkwo was the man who his father was considered a failure.

SECTION D: LITERATURE

Say whether the following statements refer to precolonial, colonial or postcolonial African literature.

1. Independence and its challenges
2. Literary works produced under colonial rule that reflect European schooling and forms
3. Conflict between Christian missions and African beliefs under colonial rule
4. Religion (Christianity vs African beliefs)
5. Post-independence reclamation of African culture and history
6. Corruption and leadership failure
7. Heroism and community life

SECTION E: WRITING

Choose one topic

- Write a creative short story (400–500 words) set in contemporary Rwanda that explores the tension between a traditional practice and modern values. Use all four past tenses and at least one relative clause.
- Write a narrative (350–450 words) retelling a traditional story from your community or from one of the texts, showing what changed over time and what value was preserved. Use appropriate past tenses and expressions of habit

UNIT 6

ENVIRONMENT



Key Unit Competence:

Communicate effectively about environmental issues and sustainable practices while promoting environmental protection and responsible resource use.

Learning objectives

By the end of this unit, you will be able to:

Knowledge and understanding

1

1. Explain environmental issues and actions for protection and sustainability.
2. Use appropriate formal and polite expressions in written and spoken communication.
3. Recognise the format, language, and purpose of different types of official documents (letters, reports, notices, memoranda, minutes, and CVs).
4. Recognise the correct punctuation and sentence structure in formal writing.

Skills

2

1. Interpret an article or open letter about environmental protection and summarise key ideas.
2. Write official documents related to environmental awareness or action using correct structure and tone.
3. Use modal verbs to express obligation, advice, or recommendations.
4. Construct conditional sentences to propose possible solutions to environmental problems.
5. Present ideas clearly and persuasively in discussions or debates on environmental conservation.

Attitudes and values

3

1. Demonstrate responsibility and initiative in environmental protection activities.
2. Show respect, courtesy, and professionalism in formal communication.
3. Appreciate the importance of collective community action in maintaining a clean and healthy environment.

Introduction

Our natural environment faces many challenges today, from deforestation and soil erosion to pollution and climate change. In this unit, you will explore how communities can work together to protect the environment. You will also learn how to express your ideas using formal and polite language, write official documents, and use grammatical structures that are essential for professional communication.

Throughout this unit, you will read about real environmental issues, listen to reports, discuss solutions with your classmates, and practise writing letters, reports, and other official documents. By the end of this unit, you should be able to communicate confidently about environmental topics in both spoken and written English.

Introductory activity



Look carefully at the pictures showing different environmental situations.



- What is happening in the picture?
- Is the situation positive or negative? Why do you think so?

6.1. Talking about environmental protection

Learning activities 6.1

A. Reading

Activity 6.1



- ❖ What comes to your mind when you hear the term environmental protection?
- ❖ Why should people protect the environment?
- ❖ What can young people do to help protect nature?

Activity 6.1.2



Observe the photo below and discuss the following questions;



1. What can you see on this picture ?
2. Suppose the man in front of these people is the village leader, imagine three things that he can be talking about.

3. Suggest two pieces of advice you can give to the people who live in that area.
4. What environmental problem or solution does each picture show?

Activity 6.1.3



Read the following open letter carefully.

An Open Letter to the Citizens of Gasabo District

Model open letter (fictional, for classroom use)

Dear Fellow Citizens,

I would like to draw your attention to a matter of great urgency that affects every household in Gasabo District. Over the past five years, our once-beautiful hills have been stripped of their forest cover, our rivers have become dumping sites for industrial waste, and the air we breathe has grown increasingly polluted. If we do not act now, the consequences will be devastating for future generations.

Last month, the Rwanda Environment Management Authority (REMA) conducted a survey that revealed alarming findings. Approximately 40% of the trees along the Nyabarongo River basin have been cut down for charcoal production. Consequently, soil erosion has increased by 25%, and local farmers are reporting a significant decline in crop yields. Furthermore, three factories in the industrial zone have been discharging untreated chemicals into the river, which has led to the death of fish and contamination of drinking water for over 10,000 residents.

As responsible citizens, we must take collective action. REMA would like to request permission from the district authorities to hold an Environmental Awareness Day on 22nd April. During this event, we plan to organise tree-planting activities, conduct clean-up exercises along the riverbanks, and hold workshops on waste management and recycling. We have to work together if we want to restore the beauty of our district.

We should plant at least 5,000 trees this year to replace those that have been lost. Every school, church, and community organisation ought to take responsibility for maintaining a clean environment. If we reuse plastic bottles and adopt proper waste disposal methods, we will reduce pollution significantly. Moreover, the local government must enforce stricter regulations on factory emissions and ensure that companies comply with environmental protection laws.

I kindly urge all citizens to attend the Environmental Awareness Day. Could you please share this message with your neighbours and friends? Together, we can make Gasabo District a model district for environmental conservation. If each person planted just one tree, we would have over 50,000 new trees in our district.

Yours faithfully,

A concerned resident, Gasabo District

Chairperson, Rwanda Environment Management Authority (REMA)

B. Vocabulary

I. Use a dictionary or research on the internet to explain the following words and expressions as they are used in the text:

1. urgency
2. devastating
3. comply
4. conservation
5. collective action
6. soil erosion

II. Match each clue with the correct vocabulary word from the following: urgency, devastating, comply, conservation, collective action, soil erosion.

Clue	Answer
The wearing away of topsoil by water or wind	
Requiring immediate action	
Efforts made by a group of people working together	
Causing great damage or destruction	
The careful management of natural resources	
To act in accordance with rules or laws	

C. Comprehension

Activity 6.1.4



Read the text again carefully and answer the comprehension questions below. When answering comprehension questions, always refer back to the text. Use your own words where possible, but include short quotations to support your answers. Begin your answers with complete sentences, not single words.

1. What is the main purpose of Marie-Claire's open letter?
2. According to the letter, what percentage of trees along the Nyabarongo River basin have been cut down?
3. Identify two consequences of deforestation mentioned in the text.

4. What are the factories in the industrial zone doing that is harmful to the environment?
5. What event does REMA plan to organise, and when will it take place?
6. List three activities planned for the Environmental Awareness Day.
7. What does the author suggest every school, church, and community organisation should do?
8. Explain the meaning of the conditional sentence: "If we reuse plastic bottles and adopt proper waste disposal methods, we will reduce pollution significantly."
9. What tone does the author use in this letter? Support your answer with examples from the text.
10. Do you agree with the author that collective action is the best approach to environmental protection? Give reasons for your answer.

Application activity 6.1



Discuss:

What environmental problems exist in your community? What actions could citizens take to solve them? Present your group's ideas to the class using formal language.

6.2. Listening: Renewable Resources and Sustainable Development

Learning Activities 6.2

Activity 6.2.1



Discuss the following questions:

1. What sources of energy are used in your community? (e.g., electricity, firewood, charcoal, solar panels)
2. Do you know the difference between renewable and non-renewable energy? Give one example of each.

Activity 6.2.2



Listen as the text is read and answer questions that follow

Africa is quickly becoming a continent of clean energy solutions. Across the region, countries are turning to renewable energy sources—solar, wind and hydropower to meet growing energy demands while protecting the environment.

Rwanda, for example, has invested heavily in solar energy. In rural areas where electricity from the national grid was once unavailable, solar panels now power homes, schools, and health centres. The Ruzizi hydropower plant, shared among Rwanda, Burundi, and the Democratic Republic of Congo, generates electricity from the flow of water — a low-direct-emissions renewable source.

Kenya has gone even further. The country now generates more than 90 per cent of its electricity from renewable sources. Its geothermal plants in the Rift Valley use heat from deep underground to produce power. Wind farms along Lake Turkana provide energy to thousands of homes. These projects have created jobs, reduced air pollution, and helped Kenya move closer to its goal of becoming carbon neutral.

However, challenges remain. Many African countries still depend on fossil fuels such as coal and oil. The cost of building renewable energy infrastructure is high, and many rural communities still lack access to reliable electricity. Environmental activists argue that governments must invest more in green energy and that young people should lead the campaign for sustainable development. Experts believe that if African nations continue on this path, the continent could become a global leader in clean energy within the next two decades.

B. Vocabulary

Find words or phrases in the passage that mean:

- a) Energy sources that do not run out:
- b) Harmful gases released into the air:
- c) People who campaign for change:
- d) Development that meets today's needs without harming the future:

Activity 6.2.3



Comprehension Questions

1. Name three types of renewable energy mentioned in the passage.
2. How has solar energy helped rural areas in Rwanda?
3. What percentage of Kenya's electricity comes from renewable sources?
4. What is geothermal energy, based on the passage?
5. What two challenges do African countries still face in moving to clean energy?
6. What do environmental activists say governments and young people should do?

Application activity 6.2



Discuss: If your school received funding to install one renewable energy source, which would you choose: solar, wind, or hydropower? Give two reasons for your choice.

6.3. Speaking: Talking about Climate Change and Environmental Conservation

Learning Activities 6.3

Key Notes: Useful Expressions for Formal Discussions

When giving your opinion: "In my view..." / "I strongly believe that..."

When making a suggestion: "I would like to suggest that..." / "Could we consider..."

When agreeing: "I fully agree." / "That is an excellent point."

When disagreeing politely: "I understand your point, however..." / "I see it differently because..."

Activity 6.3.1



Community Meeting Role-Play

Scenario: Your community is holding a meeting to discuss environmental problems and agree on solutions. Each group member plays one role:

Chairperson — Opens the meeting, gives each speaker a turn, and summarises the decisions at the end.

Community Leader — Describes two or three environmental problems the community faces.

Youth Representative — Proposes practical actions that young people can take.

Government Official — Explains what the government has done so far and what still needs to happen.

Secretary — Listens carefully, takes short notes, and reads out three agreed resolutions at the end.

6.4. Language Structure

A. Formal and Polite Expressions

Learning Activities 6.4

Activity 6.4.1



Read and answer questions.

Re-read these sentences from the open letter:

1. *"I would like to draw your attention to a matter of great urgency."*
2. *"REMA would like to request permission from the district authorities."*
3. *"I kindly urge all citizens to attend the Environmental Awareness Day."*
4. *"Could you please share this message with your neighbours and friends?"*
 - a) What do the expressions have in common?
 - b) Would the sentences sound different if the writer used: "I want to...", "Give me permission", "You must attend", "Share this message"? How?
 - c) In what situations would you use formal and polite expressions?

Key Notes

Formal and Polite Expressions

Formal and polite expressions are used in professional, academic, and official communication. They show respect, courtesy, and professionalism.

Common Formal and Polite Expressions:

Expression	Function	Example
would like to	Polite way to express a wish or desire	I would like to inform you about the meeting.
Kindly	Polite way to make a request	Kindly submit your report by Friday.
Please	Adds politeness to a request	Please ensure that all waste is disposed of properly.
could you	Polite way to ask someone to do something	Could you send me the environmental report?
I am writing to...	Formal opening for official letters	I am writing to express my concern about pollution.

I would be grateful if...	Very polite request	I would be grateful if you could attend the meeting.
May I...	Polite way to ask for permission	May I suggest an alternative approach?

Informal: "I want to talk about pollution."

Formal: "I would like to discuss the issue of pollution."

Informal: "Send me the report."

Formal: "Could you please send me the report?"

Informal: "Come to the meeting."

Formal: "I would be grateful if you could attend the meeting."

Formal expressions are especially important in official letters, reports, emails to authorities, and professional communication.

Activity 6.4.2



Rewrite the following informal sentences using formal and polite expressions:

1. I want to tell you about the pollution in our river.
2. Give me information about the recycling programme.
3. You must come to the community meeting.
4. Help me organise the tree-planting event.
5. I need to talk to the district officer about environmental issues.

B. Modals for Obligation and Advice

Activity 6.4.3



Re-read these sentences from the text and answer the questions

1. "We must take collective action."
2. "We should plant at least 5,000 trees this year."
3. "We have to work together if we want to restore the beauty of our district."
4. "Every school, church, and community organisation ought to take responsibility."
5. "The local government must enforce stricter regulations."
 - a) Which sentences express a strong obligation (something that is necessary)?
 - b) Which sentences express advice or a recommendation?
 - c) What is the difference between "must" and "should"?

Key Notes

B. Modals for Obligation and Advice

Modal verbs are used to express different degrees of obligation, advice, and necessity. In formal writing (such as reports and recommendations), choosing the right modal verb is very important.

Modal Verb	Meaning	Strength	Example
Must	Strong obligation / necessity	Very strong	We must protect our forests.
have to	Obligation (often external rule)	Strong	Factories have to treat their waste before disposal.
need to	Necessity	Moderate-strong	We need to invest in renewable energy.
Should	Advice / recommendation	Moderate	Citizens should participate in clean-up exercises.
ought to	Moral obligation / strong advice	Moderate	Every household ought to reduce its waste.

'Must' expresses the speaker's personal strong feeling about what is right or necessary.

'have to' expresses an external obligation — a rule or law that someone else has imposed.

Compare:

"You must stop littering." (I feel very strongly about this.)

"You have to stop littering." (It is against the law.)

Negative forms: must not = it is forbidden; don't have to = it is not necessary

"You must not dump waste in the river." (It is forbidden.)

"You don't have to attend every meeting." (It is not obligatory, but you can if you want.)

Activity 6.4.4



Write Recommendations

You are an environmental advisor. Write five recommendations for your local community using different modal verbs (must, should, have to, need to, ought to).

Example: The community should organise monthly clean-up exercises to keep public spaces tidy.

C. Conditional Sentences for Recommendations

Activity 6.4.5



Re-read these sentences from the text:

1. *"If we do not act now, the consequences will be devastating for future generations."*
2. *"If we reuse plastic bottles, we will reduce waste."*
3. *If each person planted just one tree, we would have over 50,000 new trees in our district.*

Questions:

1. What word begins the condition (the "if" part) in each sentence?
2. What verb tense is used in the "if" clause of sentences 1 and 2? What about sentence 3?
3. What is the difference in meaning between sentences 1–2 and sentence 3?

Key Notes:

Conditional Sentences (Types 1 & 2)

Type 1 — Real / Likely Conditions

Used for situations that are real or likely to happen. They express cause and consequence.

Structure: If + present simple, ... will + base verb

Examples:

If we plant more trees, we will reduce soil erosion.

If factories treat their waste, the river will become clean again.

If the government enforces stricter laws, pollution will decrease.

Type 2 — Unreal / Hypothetical Conditions

Used for imaginary or unlikely situations. They express what we would do in a different situation.

Structure: If + past simple, ... would + base verb

Examples:

If every citizen planted a tree, we would have thousands of new trees.

If the river were not polluted, people would use it for drinking water.

If I were the district mayor, I would ban charcoal production.

Type 1: The situation is possible and likely. → Use present simple + will

Type 2: The situation is imaginary or unlikely. → Use past simple + would

Note: In Type 2, we use "were" (not "was") for all persons in formal English:
"If I were the president..." (NOT "If I was the president...")

Activity 6.4.6



Complete these conditional sentences with the correct verb form:

1. If the community _____ (organise) a clean-up day, the streets _____ (be) much cleaner.
2. If I _____ (be) the school principal, I _____ (start) a recycling programme.
3. If factories _____ (not stop) polluting, the water supply _____ (become) dangerous.
4. If every family _____ (plant) two trees, we _____ (have) a greener district.
5. If the government _____ (invest) in clean energy, air pollution _____ (decrease).

D. Punctuation in Formal Writing

Activity 6.4.7



Read the following unpunctuated paragraph carefully and add the correct punctuation marks where necessary.

dear sir madam i am writing to inform you about the pollution in our district the factories are releasing chemicals into the river we kindly request that the government takes action please respond to our concerns at your earliest convenience yours faithfully jean kamanzi

Key Notes:

Punctuation and List Formatting in Formal Writing

Feature	Rule	Example
Full stop (.)	Used at the end of a complete sentence.	The meeting will be held on Friday.

Comma (,)	Used to separate items in a list, after introductory phrases, and before conjunctions.	We planted trees, flowers, and shrubs.
Colon (:)	Used to introduce a list, explanation, or example.	The committee proposed three actions: tree-planting, recycling, and awareness campaigns.
Semicolon (;)	Used to join two closely related independent clauses.	Pollution is increasing; we must act now.
Capital letter	Used at the beginning of sentences, proper nouns, and titles.	Dear Mr. Kagame, / The Minister of Environment...
Bullet points	Used in formal documents to list items clearly.	The agenda includes: Environmental report, Budget review

Application activity 6.4



Write a speech to be delivered to all the students in your school about Environmental Protection. Your speech should not exceed 250 words using formal expressions to describe an environmental problem in your community and suggest a solution. Use at least three of the following expressions in your paragraph: I would like to..., kindly, please, could you, we must, we should, if we..., as a result...

Example opening: "I would like to draw attention to the problem of littering in our school compound. We should kindly remind all students to use the dustbins provided..."

6.5. Writing: Official Documents

In this section, you will learn how to write different types of official documents. Each document has a specific format, purpose, and tone. Mastering these formats is essential for professional communication.

A. Official Letters (Formal Letters)

An official letter is a formal written message sent to organisations, authorities, or individuals for professional purposes. It follows a specific structure and uses formal language.

Key Notes

Structure of an Official Letter

1. Sender's address (top right corner)
2. Date (below sender's address)
3. Recipient's address (left side)
4. Salutation (e.g., Dear Sir/Madam, Dear Mr./Mrs. ...)
5. Subject line (brief summary of the letter's purpose)
6. Body (introduction, main content, conclusion)
7. Closing (e.g., Yours faithfully / Yours sincerely)
8. Signature and name

Model Official Letter

Groupe Scolaire Kicukiro
P.O. Box 3471, Kigali
Email: info@gskicukiro.ac.rw
Tel: +250 788 123 456
18th March 2025

The Mayor of Kicukiro District
Kicukiro District Office
P.O. Box 1054, Kigali
Dear Sir/Madam,

RE: REQUEST FOR PERMISSION TO HOLD AN ENVIRONMENTAL AWARENESS DAY

I am writing to kindly request permission to organise an Environmental Awareness Day at Groupe Scolaire Kicukiro on 22nd April 2025, to coincide with Earth Day. The purpose of this event is to educate students and community members about the importance of environmental conservation and sustainable development in line with Rwanda's Vision 2050.

During the event, we plan to organise tree-planting activities along the school grounds and nearby areas, conduct a clean-up exercise along the Nyabarongo riverbanks in partnership with local Umuganda committees, and hold workshops on waste management, recycling, and the continued enforcement of the national plastic bag ban. We would also like to invite officials from the Rwanda Environment Management Authority (REMA) and Kicukiro District environmental officers to address the participants.

We expect approximately 500 students, 30 teachers, and 100 community members to attend. We would be grateful if you could grant us permission and also advise on any support that the district office may offer, such as waste collection materials or transport assistance. Could you please confirm your response by 5th April 2025?

Thank you for considering our request. We look forward to your favourable response.

Yours faithfully,

Jean-Baptiste HABIMANA

Head Teacher, Groupe Scolaire Kicukiro

Activity 6.5.1



Write an official letter to the District Environmental Officer requesting support for a tree-planting campaign in your school. Use the correct format, formal expressions, and appropriate punctuation. Add imaginary receiver's and sender's address.

B. Curriculum Vitae (CV)

A Curriculum Vitae (CV) is a document that summarises your education, skills, work experience, and achievements. It is used when applying for jobs, internships, or academic programmes.

Key Notes:

Structure of a CV

1. Personal Information: Full name, address, phone number, email
2. Personal Profile / Objective: A brief summary of who you are and what you seek
3. Education: Schools attended, qualifications, dates
4. Work Experience: Jobs held, responsibilities, dates (most recent first)
5. Skills: Languages, computer skills, other relevant abilities
6. References: Names and contact details of two or three referees

Model CV

CURRICULUM VITAE

1. PERSONAL INFORMATION

Name: Jeanne MUKAMANA

Date of Birth: 15th June 2005

Nationality: Rwandan

Address: Northern Province; Rulindo District; Base Sector

P.O. Box 456, Kigali, Rwanda

Phone: +250 788 123 456

Email: jmukamana@email.com

2. PERSONAL PROFILE

A motivated and hardworking Senior Six graduate with a strong interest in environmental science and community development. Demonstrates good teamwork, communication, and problem-solving skills. Seeking an internship opportunity to apply knowledge and contribute to environmental conservation initiatives.

3. EDUCATION

2019 – 2025: Gasabo Secondary School — Advanced Level Certificate (Languages)

2016 – 2019: Hope Primary School — Ordinary Level Certificate

4. WORK EXPERIENCE

July 2024: Volunteer, Rwanda Environment Management Authority (REMA)

Responsibilities: Assisted in organising community clean-up events; helped distribute awareness materials.

5. SKILLS

Languages: Kinyarwanda (native), English (fluent), French (intermediate)

Computer skills: Microsoft Word, Excel, PowerPoint

Other: Leadership, teamwork, public speaking

6. REFERENCES

Mr. Jean-Baptiste HABIMANA (Head Teacher) — Tel: +250 788 987 654

Mrs. Marie-Claire UWAMAHORO (REMA Chairperson) — Tel: +250 788 654 321

Activity 6.5.2



Write your own CV following the structure above. Include accurate personal information, your education history, any work or volunteer experience, and your skills. Exchange your CV with a partner for peer review.

C. Report writing

A report is a structured document that presents information about an event, situation, or investigation. Reports are used in schools, businesses, and government to communicate findings and recommendations.

Key Notes:

Structure of a report

1. Title / Heading: Clear and descriptive
2. Introduction: Purpose, background, scope
3. Findings / Main Body: Facts, evidence, observations
4. Conclusion: Summary of main points
5. Recommendations: Suggested actions
6. Prepared by: Author's name, title, and date

Model Report

REPORT ON THE STATE OF THE ENVIRONMENT IN GASABO DISTRICT

1. Introduction

This report presents the findings of a survey conducted by the Rwanda Environment Management Authority (REMA) in February 2025. The purpose was to assess the current state of the environment in Gasabo District and to identify key areas of concern.

2. Findings

The survey revealed three major environmental challenges. First, approximately 40% of the trees along the Nyabarongo River basin have been cut down, mainly for charcoal production. Second, soil erosion has increased by 25% in hilly areas, leading to reduced agricultural productivity. Third, three factories in the industrial zone have been discharging untreated waste into the river, contaminating water supplies for over 10,000 residents.

3. Conclusion

The environment in Gasabo District is deteriorating rapidly. Immediate action is required to address deforestation, soil erosion, and water pollution.

4. Recommendations

The government should enforce stricter regulations on factory emissions.

Communities must organise regular tree-planting campaigns.

Schools ought to include environmental education in their programmes.

Citizens need to adopt proper waste disposal and recycling practices.

Prepared by: Marie-Claire UWAMAHORO, Chairperson, REMA

Date: 28th February 2025

Activity 6.5.3



Write a short report (150–200 words) on the state of the environment in your school or community. Follow the report structure above and use modal verbs in your recommendations.

D. Minutes of a Meeting

Minutes are the official written record of what was discussed and decided at a meeting. They serve as a reference document and help ensure that actions are followed up.

Key Notes:

Structure of Meeting Minutes

1. Heading: Name of the meeting
2. Date, time, and venue
3. Attendance: List of members present and absent
4. Agenda items: Topics discussed
5. Discussions and decisions: Summary of what was said and agreed
6. Action points: Tasks assigned to specific people
7. Date of next meeting
8. Signature of secretary and chairperson

Model Minutes

MINUTES OF THE RWANDA ENVIRONMENT MANAGEMENT AUTHORITY (REMA) MEETING

Date: 10th March 2025

Time: 2:00 PM – 4:00 PM

Venue: Gasabo District Hall, Room 3

Members Present: Marie-Claire Uwamahoro (Chairperson), Jean-Baptiste Habimana, Alice Nyiraneza, Pierre Mugisha, Diane Uwitonze (Secretary)

Absent with Apology: Mayira Nsabimana

Agenda:

1. Opening remarks
2. Review of previous minutes
3. Planning for Environmental Awareness Day
4. Any other business
5. Closing

1. Opening Remarks

The Chairperson welcomed all members and opened the meeting at 2:05 PM.

2. Review of Previous Minutes

The minutes of the meeting held on 20th February 2025 were read and approved without amendments.

3. Planning for Environmental Awareness Day

The Chairperson proposed that the Environmental Awareness Day should be held on 22nd April 2025. Mr. Habimana suggested that local schools should be invited to participate in tree-planting activities. Ms. Nyiraneza recommended that a workshop on waste management be included in the programme. The committee agreed unanimously.

4. Any Other Business

Mr. Mugisha raised the issue of illegal dumping near the river. It was decided that a formal letter should be written to the District Mayor requesting intervention.

5. Closing

The meeting was adjourned at 3:50 PM. The next meeting was scheduled for 7th April 2025.

Minutes prepared by: Diane UWITONZE, Secretary

Approved by: Marie-Claire UWAMAHORO, Chairperson

Activity 6.5.4



Writing Minutes

In groups, simulate a short meeting about an environmental issue in your school. One student acts as chairperson, another as secretary. After the meeting, the secretary writes the minutes following the format above.

E. Memorandum (Memo)

A memorandum (memo) is a brief internal communication sent within an organisation. It is used to inform, remind, or instruct staff about a specific matter.

Key Notes:

Structure of a Memo

TO: (Recipient's name and title)

FROM: (Sender's name and title)

DATE: (Date of the memo)

SUBJECT: (Brief, clear topic)

Body: Short, clear message. State the purpose, provide details, and specify any action required.

Model Memo

MEMORANDUM

TO: All Staff Members

FROM: Jean-Baptiste HABIMANA, Head Teacher

DATE: 19th March 2025

SUBJECT: Participation in Environmental Awareness Day

I would like to inform all staff members that our school will participate in the Environmental Awareness Day on 22nd April 2025. All teachers are kindly requested to encourage their students to take part in the tree-planting and clean-up exercises.

Each department should prepare a list of student volunteers by 10th April 2025. Could you please submit the lists to the office of the Dean of Studies?

Your cooperation is greatly appreciated.

Activity 6.5.5



Memo Writing

Write a memo from the School Environment Club President to all club members informing them about an upcoming tree-planting activity. Include the date, time, venue, and what members need to bring.

F. Notice

A notice is a short formal announcement displayed publicly to inform people about an event, instruction, or important information.

Key Notes

Structure of a notice

1. Heading: "NOTICE" (in capital letters)
2. Title: Brief and clear subject
3. Body: Who, what, when, where, and any instructions
4. Issued by: Name and title of the person issuing the notice
5. Date

Model Notice

NOTICE

ENVIRONMENTAL AWARENESS DAY

All students and staff are hereby informed that the school will hold an Environmental Awareness Day on Tuesday, 22nd April 2025, from 8:00 AM to 2:00 PM.

Activities will include tree-planting, a clean-up exercise along the school perimeter, and a workshop on waste management. All students must wear appropriate clothing and bring gardening gloves.

Attendance is compulsory for all students.

Issued by: Jean-Baptiste HABIMANA, Head Teacher

Date: 20th March 2025

Activity 6.5.6



Write a notice for your school notice board about an upcoming environmental club meeting. Include all necessary details.

6.6 End-of-Unit -assessment:

End of unit assessment



Section A: Critical Reading and Textual Analysis

Read the following extended excerpt from a government proposal and answer the questions that follow.

"The current rate of wetland encroachment in urban peripheries is unsustainable and poses a direct threat to long-term environmental stability. Over the past decade, rapid population growth and unregulated construction have resulted in the steady disappearance of natural drainage systems. If the local government fails to gazette these protected zones immediately, the capital will face irreversible flood damage by 2030, with vulnerable communities being the most affected.

Furthermore, the degradation of wetlands has led to declining water quality, increased pollution levels, and the loss of biodiversity. Experts have repeatedly emphasized that wetlands act as natural filters and buffers, absorbing excess water during heavy rainfall. Without these ecosystems, the city's infrastructure will be placed under immense strain.

We ought to prioritize the relocation of informal settlements; however, this must be balanced with ethical housing solutions that respect human dignity and social equity. Any relocation strategy that ignores community participation risks creating further social instability.

Were the district to invest in 'green sponges' (permeable urban surfaces such as parks, green roofs, and porous pavements), the necessity for multi-billion franc drainage upgrades would be significantly mitigated. In addition, such environmentally conscious investments would align with national sustainability goals and enhance the city's resilience to climate change.

It is therefore recommended that a multi-sectoral approach be adopted, involving government agencies, private stakeholders, and local communities. Only through coordinated and collective action can the current trajectory be reversed and a sustainable urban future secured."

Questions

1. Compare the use of the Type 1 Conditional ("If the local government fails...") with the Type 2 Conditional ("Were the district to invest...") in the text. How does the shift in grammatical mood change the speaker's rhetorical purpose?
2. Explain the technical nuance of the word "mitigated" as used in the passage. Provide a professional synonym that would maintain the formal tone.

3. Based on the text, what is the author's implicit attitude toward current urban planning? Cite specific "polite yet firm" phrasing to support your view.
4. Identify two environmental consequences of wetland encroachment mentioned in the text and explain their impact on urban life.
5. Why does the author emphasize "collective action" in the final paragraph? What effect does this have on the reader?

Section B: Language Use

1. Complete the sentences using the correct form of the verbs in brackets.

- If the Rwanda Environment Management Authority (REMA) _____ (enforce) the plastic ban more strictly last year, the drainage systems _____ (not be) so clogged during the recent floods.
- If I _____ (be) the Minister of Environment, I _____ (allocate) more money to renewable energy projects.
- If communities _____ (protect) wetlands, flooding _____ (reduce) in many urban areas.
- If the government _____ (introduce) stricter laws, pollution levels _____ (decrease).

2. Complete the sentences using: should, must, have to, may, need to

- Factories _____ treat their waste before releasing it into rivers.
- Citizens _____ reduce the use of plastic bags to protect the environment.
- The government _____ take stronger action to prevent illegal dumping.
- Communities _____ work together to solve environmental problems.
- We _____ act now, or the problem may become worse.

3. Rewrite the sentences in the passive voice.

- People are cutting down trees in protected areas.
- The company polluted the river last year.
- Workers discovered the fuel leak near the water source.

4. Join the sentences using the words given: because, therefore, however, although

- Wetlands are being destroyed. Flooding is increasing. (because)
- The company followed safety rules. An accident still happened. (although)
- The government introduced new policies. Pollution has reduced. (therefore)
- The plan is expensive. It is necessary for the environment. (however)

5. Choose the correct word to complete each sentence: (protect, conserve, prevent, reduce)

- We must _____ water for future generations.
- Laws help to _____ environmental damage.

- People should _____ pollution in their communities.
- Trees help to _____ soil erosion.

Section C: Writing

1. Rewrite the following sentences to make them more formal.

- "People are destroying wetlands very fast."
- "The government didn't do enough, so flooding happened."

2. You are the Environmental Compliance Officer for a construction company. During a project, a fuel leak happened near a community water source. Write a formal memo (150–200 words) to your Board of Directors. Include:

- A simple header (To, From, Date, Subject)
- A short explanation of what happened (use passive voice where possible, e.g., "The leak was discovered...").
- Three actions taken to solve the problem (use bullet points).
- Two or three recommendations using modals (should, must, need to).
- One Conditional Type 1 sentence about the company's future (e.g., "If we act quickly, we will...").

UNIT 7

TECHNOLOGY



Key Unit Competence:

Analyse and communicate ideas related to technology and its impact on society while demonstrating responsible and innovative use of technological tools.

Learning objectives

By the end of this unit, you will be able to:

Knowledge and understanding

1. Identify the main ideas, purposes, and characteristics of non-fiction texts.
2. Distinguish between fiction and non-fiction literary works.
3. Recognise and appropriately use grammatical structures such as relative clauses, reported speech, modals for possibility and prediction, and linking words of cause and effect.
4. Explain how technology influences different aspects of life including education, agriculture, and communication.

Skills

1. Interpret non-fiction texts such as articles, essays, and reports on technological impact.
2. Summarise and report ideas from sources using reported speech.
3. Use linking words to show cause-and-effect relationships in speech and writing.
4. Construct sentences with relative clauses to describe technological tools and innovations.
5. Write and present short analytical or reflective paragraphs about technology and society.

Attitudes and values

3

1. Appreciate the importance of using technology responsibly and ethically.
2. Show curiosity, innovation, and critical thinking toward technological advancement.
3. Value traditional knowledge while embracing modern solutions for development.

Introduction

Technology is transforming every aspect of our lives — from the way we learn and communicate to how we grow food and run businesses. In this unit, you will explore how technology influences education, agriculture, and social behaviour. You will read non-fiction texts, listen to reports about innovations, and participate in debates about the benefits and challenges of technology.

You will also develop your grammar skills by learning to use relative clauses, reported speech, modal verbs for possibility and prediction, and linking words of cause and effect. Finally, you will explore non-fiction as a literary form and learn strategies for interpreting non-fiction texts critically.

Introductory activity



1. , List five technologies you use daily at school or at home.
 2. How do these technologies help you? Are there any negative effects?
- Share your findings with the class.*

7.1. Talking about digital innovations

Learning Activities 7.1

A. Reading

Activity 7.1.1



Before you read the text below, discuss the following questions :

1. What do you know about how technology is changing education in Rwanda?
2. Can you name any digital tools used in schools or by farmers in Rwanda?
3. Do you think technology has more advantages than disadvantages? Why

Activity 71.2



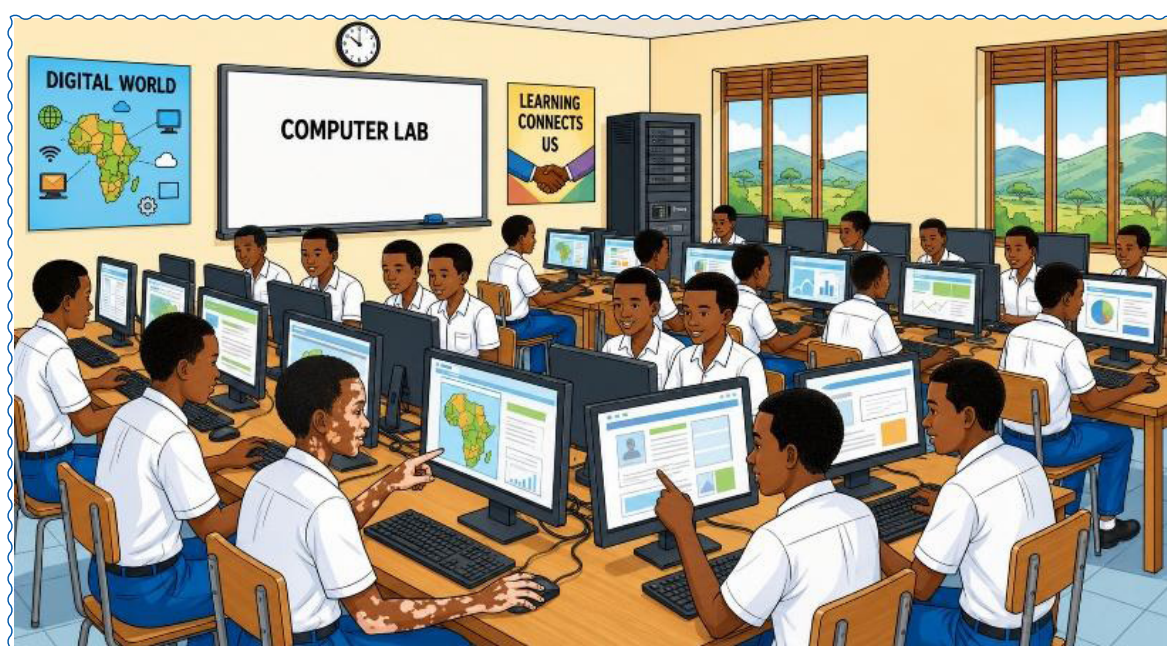
Read the following article carefully.

How Technology is Transforming Rwanda's Future

Rwanda has emerged as one of Africa's leading digital innovators. Over the past decade, the government has invested heavily in technology infrastructure, transforming the country into a hub for innovation and digital services. From smart classrooms to mobile banking and precision agriculture, technology is reshaping the way Rwandans live, learn, and work. This transformation did not happen overnight. It was the result of a deliberate national vision, beginning with Rwanda's ICT Sector Strategic Plan and continuing through ambitious programmes such as Smart Rwanda and the National Broadband Policy. Today, Kigali is often referred to as the "Silicon Valley of Africa," attracting international technology companies and start-ups that see the country as a gateway to the African digital economy.

Technology in Education

In education, the introduction of digital learning platforms has revolutionised the classroom experience. Schools that previously lacked textbooks now have access to online libraries which contain thousands of resources. Teachers use tablets and projectors to deliver interactive lessons, and students who live in remote areas can access educational materials through mobile applications. The Minister of Education stated that technology has improved access to education significantly. The One Laptop Per Child initiative, which was launched several years ago, placed computers in the hands of thousands of primary school children across the country. Furthermore, e-learning platforms such as the Rwanda Education Board's online portal allow teachers to share lesson plans, assessment tools, and training materials. As a result, teaching quality has improved considerably in schools that have adopted these technologies.



However, experts warn that the digital divide remains a challenge, as not all schools have reliable electricity or internet connectivity. In rural areas, some classrooms still rely on traditional chalkboards and printed handouts. The cost of maintaining digital equipment is another obstacle, since devices break down frequently and replacement parts are not always available locally. Due to these challenges, the government has partnered with private telecommunications companies to expand 4G network coverage to remote areas and to install solar-powered charging stations in schools that lack connection to the national electricity grid.

Technology in Agriculture

Agriculture, which employs over 70% of Rwanda's population, has also benefited from technological innovation. Farmers now use mobile phone applications to receive weather forecasts, market prices, and advice on crop management. Drones are being used to monitor large farms, and automated irrigation systems help conserve water. As a result, crop yields have increased in areas where these technologies have been adopted. In addition, the government has introduced smart agriculture programmes that use data analytics to predict pest outbreaks and soil quality levels. Extension workers, who traditionally visited farms in person, can now provide guidance through mobile phone messaging services, reaching thousands of farmers in a single day. Companies such as Zipline have revolutionised agricultural supply chains by using cargo drones to deliver seeds, fertilisers, and veterinary medicines to remote farming communities.

Nevertheless, some farmers argue that the cost of technology is too high and that traditional farming methods are still more practical for small-scale agriculture. Many smallholder farmers, who cultivate plots of less than one hectare, say that purchasing a smartphone or subscribing to a digital advisory service is beyond their financial means. Owing to this, cooperatives and farmer associations have stepped in to share devices and split subscription costs among their members, making technology more accessible to those with limited resources.



Technology and Social Behaviour

The rise of social media and digital communication has significantly influenced social behaviour. Platforms such as WhatsApp, Twitter, and Instagram have become essential tools for connecting people, sharing information, and even conducting business. Consequently, many young Rwandans are now digital entrepreneurs who run online businesses. Mobile money services, particularly MTN Mobile Money and Airtel Money, have transformed how people conduct financial transactions, enabling millions of previously unbanked citizens to save, send, and receive money using their phones. E-commerce platforms are growing rapidly, allowing small traders and artisans to sell products to customers across the country and beyond its borders.

However, there are growing concerns about cyberbullying, misinformation, and excessive screen time, which could negatively affect mental health and social relationships. Health professionals have warned that prolonged use of social media may lead to anxiety, depression, and reduced concentration, particularly among young people. Furthermore, the spread of misinformation through messaging applications has become a growing threat to public safety, as false rumours can cause unnecessary panic or influence public opinion. In response, the Rwanda Utilities Regulatory Authority (RURA) has introduced digital literacy campaigns to help citizens identify fake news and practise responsible online behaviour. Schools have also begun incorporating media literacy into their curricula, teaching students how to evaluate online sources critically.

Technology in Healthcare

The healthcare sector has equally experienced remarkable technological progress. Rwanda became the first country in the world to use drones for routine delivery of blood and medical supplies to rural health centres. Zipline's distribution centre in Muhanga serves hospitals across the country, reducing delivery times from hours to minutes and saving countless lives in emergency situations. Telemedicine services have also expanded, allowing patients in remote villages to consult with specialist doctors in Kigali through video calls. Digital health records now make it easier for medical professionals to track patient histories and coordinate treatment plans. Because of these innovations, healthcare outcomes have improved significantly, with maternal and infant mortality rates declining in regions where these technologies have been deployed.

Looking Ahead: Rwanda's Digital Future

Looking ahead, technology might replace some traditional jobs, but it will also create new opportunities. Rwanda could become a model for how developing nations use technology to drive economic growth. The Kigali Innovation City project, which is currently under development, aims to create a world-class technology campus that will host universities, research laboratories, and multinational tech companies. If the government continues to invest in digital infrastructure, the country will achieve its vision of becoming a knowledge-based economy by 2050. Young Rwandans, who are naturally curious, creative, and entrepreneurial, will play a central role in this transformation. Therefore, it is essential that education systems equip them with the digital skills, critical thinking abilities, and ethical values they need to lead responsibly in an increasingly connected world.

B. Vocabulary

Activity 71.3



I. Find the word from the text above that matches each definition:

1. The gap between those who have access to technology and those who do not ...
2. Changed completely and dramatically ...
3. People who start and run their own businesses ...
4. Using digital platforms to bully or harass someone ...
5. Operated by machines without human involvement ...
6. The artificial supply of water to crops ...

II. Write your own sentences using each of the following words:

1. innovators: _____
2. digital divide: _____
3. automated: _____
4. entrepreneurs: _____
5. misinformation: _____

Activity 71.4



C. Comprehension

Read the passage *“How Technology is Transforming Rwanda’s Future”* again and answer the questions below.

1. What is the central argument of the article?
2. Explain how technology has transformed education in Rwanda. Provide at least two specific examples from the text.
3. Analyse one major challenge affecting the use of technology in schools and explain its impact.
4. Discuss how technology has improved agriculture in Rwanda, using evidence from the passage.
5. Why do some farmers remain hesitant to adopt technology? Explain using details from the text.
6. Examine how social media has influenced both communication and economic activities in Rwanda.

7. Identify and explain two negative effects of social media mentioned in the article.
8. What does the statement by the Minister of Education suggest about the role of technology in learning?
9. What future vision of Rwanda is presented in the article? Support your answer with relevant ideas.
10. To what extent do you agree that technology brings more benefits than disadvantages in Rwanda? Give well-reasoned arguments supported by the text and your own ideas.

7.2. Speaking: Pros and cons of the use of Artificial intelligence (AI) in education.

Learning Activities 7.2

Activity 7.2.1



Answer the following questions:

1. Have you ever heard of artificial intelligence (AI)? What do you know about it?
2. Choose which side you will argue: FOR or AGAINST the use of artificial intelligence (AI)

Key Notes

Useful Expressions for Debate

1. Giving an Opinion "From my point of view..." / "I strongly believe that..." / "From my perspective..."
2. Presenting Arguments "First of all..." / "Furthermore..." / "In addition..." / "Research shows that..."
3. Expressing Possibility "This could lead to..." / "There is a possibility that..." / "This is likely to..."
4. Cause & Effect "Because of..." / "As a result..." / "Therefore..." / "Consequently..."
5. Reporting Evidence "According to the article..." / "Experts believe that..." / "The text shows that..."
6. Agreeing & Disagreeing  Agree: "That is a valid argument because..."  Disagree: "I respectfully disagree because..." / "On the contrary..."
7. Concluding "In conclusion..." / "To sum up..." / "Based on the evidence presented..."

Proposer (For AI in Education)

"**From my point of view**, I think that artificial intelligence can improve education in Rwanda. **First of all**, AI gives students access to learning materials even in rural areas. **Furthermore**, it helps teachers deliver lessons more effectively. **According to researchers**, countries that use AI in schools show better student performance. **In short**, AI is a powerful tool that can transform education in Rwanda for the better."

Opposer (Against AI in Education)

"**I respectfully disagree** with the proposers. **First of all**, many schools in Rwanda lack electricity and internet. **Because of** this, most students cannot access AI tools. **Furthermore**, not all teachers are trained to use technology in class. **In brief**, AI may widen the gap between rich and poor schools rather than help everyone equally."

Activity 7.2.2



Panel Discussion / Debate

Debate: "Should All Schools in Rwanda Replace Textbooks with AI?"

Instructions:

1. Form two teams: Team A (FOR) and Team B (AGAINST).
2. Each team has 10 minutes to prepare their arguments.
3. Each speaker has 2 minutes to present their points.
4. Use modal verbs (might, could, may, will), linking words (because of, therefore, as a result), and reported speech (The Minister said that...) in your arguments.
5. A moderator (chosen by the teacher) will manage the debate and allow rebuttals.

7.3. Listening: Talking about online safety

Listening activities

Activity 7.3.1



Discuss this question: "Have you ever heard of online safety? What do you know about it?"

Activity 7.3.2



Listen as the script is read and answer questions that follow

Online safety is an essential part of using technology responsibly in today's digital world. As more people use platforms like WhatsApp, Instagram, and Twitter to communicate and share information, it becomes important to protect personal data and privacy. Users should create strong passwords, avoid sharing sensitive information such as addresses or bank details, and be careful when interacting with strangers online. In addition, people must learn how to identify suspicious links and messages that may lead to scams or fraud. Practising safe online behaviour helps individuals avoid risks such as identity theft and hacking.

Furthermore, online safety also involves being responsible and respectful when using digital platforms. Problems such as cyberbullying and the spread of false information can harm individuals and communities. Users should think critically before sharing content and verify information from reliable sources to prevent misinformation. It is also important to report harmful behaviour and support others who may be affected by online abuse. By promoting awareness and digital responsibility, individuals can contribute to creating a safer and more positive online environment for everyone.

C. Comprehension Questions

1. What is the main idea of the text?
2. Why is online safety important in today's digital world?
3. Mention two social media platforms referred to in the text.
4. What are two ways users can protect their personal information online?
5. What risks are mentioned that users may face when they are not careful online?

C. Writing

Application activity 7.3



Writing Task

Write a short paragraph (200–250 words) explaining how technology has influenced one aspect of life in Rwanda (education, agriculture, or social behaviour). Use at least two linking words of cause and effect and one sentence in reported speech.

Example opening: "Technology has greatly influenced education in Rwanda. Because of the introduction of digital platforms, students in remote areas can now access learning materials online. The Minister of Education stated that technology has improved access to education significantly. As a result, literacy rates have increased..."

7.4. Language Structure

A. Relative Clauses

Learning activities

Activity 7.4.1



Re-read these sentences from the text

1. "Schools that previously lacked textbooks now have access to online libraries which contain thousands of resources."
2. "Students who live in remote areas can access educational materials through mobile applications."
3. "Many young Rwandans are now digital entrepreneurs who run online businesses."
4. "Social media, which connects millions of people worldwide, has both positive and negative effects."

Questions:

1. What words begin the underlined parts?
2. What does each underlined part do?

Activity 7.4.2



Join each pair of sentences using a relative pronoun (who, which, that, whose, where):

1. Rwanda is a country. It has invested heavily in technology.
2. The farmer received advice through a mobile app. He increased his crop yield.
3. The school has a new computer lab. I study there. →
4. The student won the science award. Her project used artificial intelligence.
5. The application provides weather forecasts. It is very popular with farmers. →
The application

B. Modal Verbs for Possibility and Prediction

Activity 7.4.3



Re-read these sentences from the text and answer the questions given after:

1. "Technology **might** replace some traditional jobs."
2. "Rwanda **could** become a model for developing nations."
3. "If the government continues to invest, the country **will** achieve its vision."

Questions:

1. Which sentence expresses a strong prediction about the future?
2. Which sentences express something that is possible but uncertain?
3. What is the difference between "might", "could", and "will"?

Key Notes:

Modals for Possibility and Prediction

Modal verbs can express different degrees of possibility about the future.

Modal	Degree of Certainty	Example
Will	Certain / Strong prediction	Technology will continue to grow in Rwanda.
May	Possible (50/50 chance)	AI may change the way we learn.
Might	Less certain possibility	Technology might replace some traditional jobs.
Could	Possible (theoretical)	Rwanda could become Africa's tech hub.
Remember! Certainty scale (strongest to weakest): will > may > might/could "AI will transform education." (I am very sure.) "AI may transform education." (It is possible.)		

"AI might/
could
transform
education."
(It is
possible,
but I am not
sure.)

Activity 7.4.4



Complete the sentences with will, may, might, or could:

1. In the next decade, robots _____ be used in Rwandan hospitals. (possibility)
2. If students practise coding, they _____ get better job opportunities. (strong prediction)
3. Social media _____ affect mental health if used excessively. (less certain)
4. Drones _____ become common tools for farming in Africa. (theoretical possibility)
5. Technology _____ continue to change how we communicate. (certain)

Activity 7.4.5



Write four sentences predicting how technology will change Rwanda in the next 20 years. Use will, may, might and could once each.

C. Linking Words of Cause and Effect

Find these sentences in the text:

1. "As a result, crop yields have increased in areas where these technologies have been adopted."
2. "Consequently, many young Rwandans are now digital entrepreneurs."

Questions

1. What do the phrases "**as a result**" and "consequently" tell us?
2. What is the cause and what is the effect in each sentence?

Key Notes: Linking Words of Cause and Effect

Linking words (connectors) of cause and effect show the relationship between a reason and its result. They are essential in analytical writing.

Type	Linking Words	Example
Cause (reason)	because, because of, since, as, due to, owing to	Because of the internet, students can access global resources.
Effect (result)	therefore, as a result, consequently, thus, hence, so	Technology has improved farming. As a result, crop yields have increased.
Important Differences "because" is followed by a clause (subject + verb): "I stayed home because it was raining." "because of" is followed by a noun/noun phrase: "I stayed home because of the rain." "due to" / "owing to" are followed by a noun/noun phrase: "Due to heavy rain, the match was cancelled."		

Activity 7.4.6



Complete the sentences with an appropriate linking word:

- _____ the introduction of mobile banking, many Rwandans can now save money easily.
- Technology has created new jobs. _____, many young people are now self-employed.
- Some students spend too much time on social media. _____, their academic performance has dropped.

4. _____ the lack of electricity in some villages, students cannot charge their tablets.

5. Farmers adopted new irrigation systems. _____, their harvests improved significantly.

Application activity 7.4



Write an essay of about **150 words** on the following topic:

Assume that you are the Minister of ICT and Technology in Rwanda. You have been asked to present a formal report on how technology is influencing one key sector of national development (e.g. education, agriculture, healthcare, or business). Discuss both the positive impact and the challenges that may arise. Your ideas should include:

1. An introduction stating the topic
2. A body explaining the impact with examples
3. Linking words of cause and effect (because of, therefore, as a result, consequently)
4. At least one sentence using reported speech
5. At least one sentence using a relative clause
6. A conclusion with a prediction using a modal verb

7.5. Literature Focus: Non-Fiction

Learning activities 7.5

Activity 7.5.1



Read and discuss the following statements. Decide whether each statement is **NON-FICTION** (real/factual) or **FICTION** (imagined/not real) and give a reason for your choice.

Statements:

1. Kigali is the capital city of Rwanda.
2. A cow learned how to speak English.
3. Lake Kivu is one of the largest lakes in Rwanda.
4. A student walked to school and met a talking tree.

5. Rwanda has improved access to healthcare in recent years.
6. A smartphone flew across the sky and landed in a classroom.

Key Notes

A. Key Features of Non-Fiction

What is Non-Fiction?

Non-fiction is a form of writing that is based on real events, facts, and information. Unlike fiction, which is created from the author's imagination, non-fiction presents true accounts, explanations, arguments, or analyses of real-world topics.

Based on facts: Non-fiction texts present real information, data, and evidence.

Purpose-driven: They are written to inform, persuade, explain, or argue a point.

Structured logically: They use clear organisation with headings, paragraphs, and logical flow.

Formal tone: Most non-fiction uses objective, formal, or semi-formal language.

Use of evidence: Facts, statistics, quotes, and examples support the author's claims.

Author's perspective: The author may express opinions, but these are usually supported by evidence.

B. Difference Between Fiction and Non-Fiction

Feature	Fiction	Non-Fiction
Content	Imaginary events and characters	Real events, facts, and people
Purpose	To entertain, inspire, or provoke thought	To inform, persuade, explain, or argue
Characters	Created by the author	Real people (or no characters)
Setting	Can be imaginary	Real places and times
Style	Creative, descriptive, narrative	Factual, analytical, objective
Examples	Novels, short stories and many plays	Articles, essays, reports, biographies, speeches

Note: Poetry may be imaginative or factual; classify it from its content and purpose, not from form alone.

C. Types of Non-Fiction Literary Works

Type	Description	Example
Article	A piece of writing in a newspaper, magazine, or online publication on a specific topic.	"How Technology is Transforming Rwanda's Future"
Essay	A short piece of writing that presents an argument or analysis on a topic.	"The Impact of Social Media on Youth"
Report	A structured document presenting findings from an investigation or study.	"Annual Environmental Report 2025"
Biography / Autobiography	The story of a real person's life, written by someone else (biography) or by the person themselves (autobiography).	"Long Walk to Freedom" by Nelson Mandela
Speech	A formal address delivered to an audience.	Martin Luther King Jr.'s "I Have a Dream"
Interview	A record of questions and answers between an interviewer and a subject.	"Interview with Dr. Mukarugwiza on AI in Education"

D. Key Strategies to Interpret Non-Fiction

Strategies for Reading Non-Fiction Texts

- 1. Identify the purpose:** Why was this text written? To inform, persuade, explain, or argue?
- 2. Identify the audience:** Who is the intended reader?
- 3. Find the main idea:** What is the central message or argument?
- 4. Distinguish fact from opinion:** Which statements are based on evidence? Which are the author's views?
- 5. Analyse the tone:** Is the author neutral, passionate, critical, or supportive?
- 6. Evaluate the evidence:** Does the author use strong facts, statistics, or examples to support claims?
- 7. Consider bias:** Is the text one-sided, or does it present multiple perspectives?

Activity 7.5.2



Go back to the reading text “How Technology is Transforming Rwanda’s Future” and answer the following:

1. What type of non-fiction text is it? (article, essay, report, etc.)
2. What is the purpose of this text?
3. Who is the intended audience?
4. Identify two facts and two opinions in the text.
5. What tone does the author use? Is the text balanced or biased? Explain.

Application activity 7.5



Writing: Analytical Paragraph and Short Essay

- Write a short essay (200–250 words) on how technology has transformed education in Rwanda.
- Apply all four grammar structures from Lesson 4 within the writing tasks.

7.6. End of Unit Assessment

End of unit assessment



Section A: Reading Comprehension (20 marks)

Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow.

In recent years, Rwanda has made significant progress in the field of technology. The government has invested heavily in digital infrastructure, including high-speed internet and smart classrooms. As a result, many schools now use e-learning platforms, which allow students to access lessons online.

In addition, innovations such as mobile banking and online services have made life easier for citizens. Farmers are also benefiting from technology. For example, some use mobile applications to check weather conditions and market prices, which helps them make better decisions.

However, challenges still exist. Some rural areas lack reliable internet access, and not all students have digital devices. Despite these difficulties, experts believe that technology will continue to play a key role in Rwanda’s development. If more investments are made, the country may become one of the leading technology hubs in Africa.

Questions

1. What are two ways technology has improved education in Rwanda? (4 marks)

2. Give two examples of how technology helps farmers. (4 marks)
3. What does the word “*infrastructure*” mean as used in the passage? (4 marks)
4. Why do experts believe technology will continue to be important in Rwanda? (4 marks)
5. What is one challenge mentioned in the passage, and how can it be solved? (4 marks)

Section B: Language Use (20 marks)

1. Combine the following sentences using relative pronouns.

- a) The student won the coding competition. She is in Senior 5.
- b) Kigali is a city. It is known for its clean streets and digital innovation.
- c) Dr. Mukarugwiza is an expert. Her research focuses on AI in education.

2. Change the following sentences to reported speech.

- a) “I am developing a new farming app,” the engineer said.
- b) “Technology will change education forever,” the Minister stated.
- c) “We have installed solar panels in the school,” the principal explained.

3. Complete the sentences with the correct modal verb (*will, may, might, could*).

- a) In the future, AI _____ help doctors diagnose diseases more accurately. (*possibility*)
- b) If we invest in technology, Rwanda _____ become a leading digital nation. (*strong prediction*)
- c) Self-driving cars _____ become common in Africa one day. (*less certain*)

4. Fill in the blanks with appropriate linking words of cause and effect.

- a) _____ the introduction of e-learning platforms, students can study from home.
- b) Many farmers adopted new technology. _____, food production increased.
- c) _____ some schools lack internet access, students cannot benefit from online resources.

Section C: Literature (10 marks)

- Explain three characteristics of non-fiction texts. (3 marks)
- Give two differences between fiction and non-fiction. (2 marks)
- Name three types of non-fiction literary works and give an example of each. (3 marks)
- Explain two strategies for interpreting non-fiction texts. (2 marks)

Section D: Writing (20 marks)

1. Write a short essay (200–250 words) on the topic:

“How technology has transformed education in Rwanda.”

Use:

- Relative clauses
- Modal verbs
- Linking words of cause and effect

UNIT 8

MEDIA AND DIGITAL COMMUNICATION



Key Unit Competence:

Critically evaluate and communicate information from media and digital platforms while demonstrating responsible and ethical digital citizenship.

Learning objectives

By the end of this unit, you will be able to:

Knowledge and understanding

1

1. Identify types of media and explain their roles in communication.
2. Describe how media content is created, shared, and interpreted, and recognize features of non-fiction media texts (reports, articles, blogs, press releases).
3. Recognize language structures used in media communication such as active/passive voice, direct/indirect speech, connectors, and emphatic structures.

Skills

2

1. Read, Analyse, and evaluate media texts critically for meaning, bias, and credibility.
2. Produce structured media content such as news reports, blog posts, and press releases using accurate grammar and punctuation.
3. Communicate ideas clearly through discussions, debates, and oral presentations on media and digital communication.

Attitudes and values

3

1. Demonstrate honesty, accuracy, and objectivity when reporting or sharing information.
2. Appreciate the role of media as a tool for education and social change.
3. Use digital media responsibly, ethically, and collaboratively.

Introduction

Media and digital communication influence how people receive information, share ideas, and understand events. Newspapers, radio, television, websites, blogs, and social media can educate, entertain, and connect people. However, they can also spread false or misleading information. In this unit, you will explore different types of media and learn how to examine media messages for accuracy, credibility, and bias.

You will also learn how to create news reports, blog posts, and press releases. You will develop your language skills by using the active and passive voice, direct and reported speech, connectors, and emphatic structures. The unit will help you become a critical media user and a responsible, safe, and ethical digital citizen.

Introductory activity



Read the scenario below and discuss the questions that follow.

A message is shared in a Senior 5 class WhatsApp group claiming that all schools will close the following day because of severe weather. The message includes the school logo, but it does not mention its source. Some students immediately forward it to their friends and families. However, another student checks the school's official website and contacts a teacher, who confirms that the message is false.

Later, a student posts a classmate's photograph on social media without permission. Other users add insulting comments, and the photograph is shared widely.

Discussion Questions

1. What mistakes did the students make when using digital media?
2. What should people do before sharing information, photographs, or messages online?
3. How can young people use social media responsibly and safely?

8.1. Social media influence

Learning activities 8.1

A. Reading

Activity 8.1.1



Read the following scenario and discuss the questions that follow

A message appears on social media saying:

"The water in the town's water reservoir is dangerous and may cause illness. People should stop using it immediately."

Discuss

1. If you saw this message online, would you believe it immediately? Why or why not?
2. What should a journalist do before publishing such information?
3. Who should verify whether the information is true?

Activity 8.1.2



Read the following extract from *An Enemy Of The People* carefully and answer the questions that follow

An Enemy of the People by Henrik Ibsen (1882) | Act III — The Editorial Office of the "People's Messenger"

(The editorial office of the "People's Messenger." Hovstad is sitting at the desk, writing. Billing enters with Dr. Stockmann's manuscript in his hand.)

BILLING: Well, I must say!

HOVSTAD (still writing): Have you read it through?

BILLING (laying the manuscript on the desk): Yes, indeed I have.

HOVSTAD: Don't you think the Doctor hits them pretty hard?

BILLING: Hard? Bless my soul, he's crushing! Every word falls like the blow of a sledgehammer.

HOVSTAD: Yes, but they are not the people to throw up the sponge at the first blow.

BILLING: That is true; and for that reason we must strike blow upon blow until the whole of this aristocracy tumbles to pieces. As I sat in there reading this, I almost seemed to see a revolution in being.

HOVSTAD (turning round): Hush! — Speak so that Aslaksen cannot hear you.

BILLING (lowering his voice): Aslaksen is a chicken-hearted chap, a coward; there is nothing of the man in him. But this time you will insist on your own way, won't you? You will put the Doctor's article in?

HOVSTAD: Yes, and if the Mayor will not fall in with the Doctor's project, he will have all the small tradesmen down on him. Moreover, if he does fall in with it, he will fall out with the whole crowd of large shareholders in the Baths, who up to now have been his most valuable supporters.

BILLING: Yes, because they will certainly have to fork out a pretty penny —

HOVSTAD: Yes. And in this way the ring will be broken up, and then in every issue of the paper we will enlighten the public on the Mayor's incapability. In addition, it will be made clear that all positions of trust in the town ought to be put in the hands of the Liberals.

(Dr. Stockmann arrives at the office.)

DR. STOCKMANN: You may set to work and print it, Mr. Hovstad!

HOVSTAD: Has it come to that, then?

DR. STOCKMANN: Yes, print away. Undoubtedly it has come to that. Now they must take what they get. There is going to be a fight in the town, Mr. Billing!

DR. STOCKMANN (continued): This article is only a beginning. I have already got four or five more sketched out in my head.

HOVSTAD: I think it is simply a masterpiece. It is so clear and intelligible. One need have no special knowledge to understand the bearing of it. You will have every enlightened man on your side.

ASLAKSEN: And every prudent man too, I hope?

BILLING: The prudent and the imprudent — almost the whole town.

ASLAKSEN: In that case we may venture to print it.

DR. STOCKMANN: Take care of it as if it were a treasure! No misprints — every word is important. I can't tell you how eager I am to see it in print, and see it burst upon the public —

ASLAKSEN: Yes, but in moderation, Doctor — proceed with moderation.

DR. STOCKMANN: Because it is not merely a question of water-supply and drains now. No — it is the whole of our social life that we have got to purify and disinfect. However, I shall consider the "People's Messenger" my sheet-anchor now, and every single day I will bombard them with one article after another.

HOVSTAD (after Stockmann departs): He may prove an invaluable useful man to us.

ASLAKSEN: Yes, so long as he confines himself to this matter of the Baths. But if he goes farther afield, I don't think it would be advisable to follow him.

(Petra, the Doctor's daughter and a teacher, enters the office.)

PETRA: Here is the English story. I am not going to translate it.

HOVSTAD: Why have you brought it back?

PETRA: Because it conflicts with all your opinions. The burden of this story is that there is a supernatural power that looks after the so-called good people in this world — whereas all the so-called bad people are punished. You know quite well that things do not happen so in reality.

HOVSTAD: You are perfectly right; but an editor cannot always act as he would prefer. He is often obliged to bow to the wishes of the public. Politics are the most important thing in life — for a newspaper, anyway.

PETRA: What I am angry with you for is not having been honest with my father. You talked to him as if the truth and the good of the community were what lay nearest to your heart. Journalists should be honest with those whose causes they champion — and never should self-interest be placed above the public good.

(Aslaksen reports that the Mayor has arrived secretly through the back door.)

PETER STOCKMANN (to Hovstad): The Medical Officer of the Baths is responsible for what happened today. He has addressed a kind of report to the Baths Committee on the subject of certain supposed defects in the Baths.

HOVSTAD: Ah, yes — it is true he did mention something about it.

PETER STOCKMANN: The report has not been placed before the governing body of the Baths. It was put in the hands of certain individuals, and those individuals have seen fit to circulate it widely, doing great injury to the reputation of the Baths.

HOVSTAD: I cannot prevent people from acting when they take the initiative.

PETER STOCKMANN: You ought not to have made it possible, then. Rarely does a newspaper bear so much responsibility for the peace of a community ; and that responsibility must be exercised with care. I appeal to you most earnestly not to print the Doctor's article.

B. Vocabulary

Activity 8.1.3



I. Find words or expressions in the extract that mean the following:

- a) A written document prepared for publication.
- b) A group of powerful or wealthy people in society.
- c) To inform or educate people about something.
- d) Acting carefully and avoiding extreme actions.
- e) The public opinion people have about something.

II. Read the extract again carefully. Replace the words in bold with a word or expression from the passage that has a similar meaning.

- 1. Billing says the Doctor's article will **educate** the public about the Mayor's incapability.
- 2. Dr. Stockmann tells Hovstad to print the article and **protect it carefully** because every word is important.
- 3. Aslaksen says they may **risk** printing the article if most people support it.
- 4. Dr. Stockmann says society must be **cleaned and made healthy** again.
- 5. Peter Stockmann says the article has damaged the **good name** of the Baths.

III. Locate the expressions below in the passage and explain what they suggest.

- A. "Every word falls like the blow of a sledgehammer."
- B. "The ring will be broken up."
- C. "It will burst upon the public."
- "Proceed with moderation."

C. Comprehension

Activity 8.1.4



Read the extract again, discuss, and answer the following questions

1. Where does the scene take place?
2. How does Billing describe Dr. Stockmann's article?
3. In the extract, the newspaper is used to inform the public. How might **social media platforms today** play a similar role in spreading such information?
4. Billing believes the article will strongly influence the town. In today's world, how might a **viral social media post** have the same effect?
5. Peter Stockmann says that newspapers carry great responsibility for the peace of a community. Do you think **social media users also carry responsibility** when sharing information online? Explain.
6. If this story happened today, which digital platforms might people use to discuss the issue of the Baths?

Application activity 8.1



Scenario

Imagine that the events in the extract happen **today in your town**. A doctor discovers that the water in a public swimming pool is polluted and dangerous. A journalist receives this information and must decide how to inform the public.

In groups of **3–4 learners**, prepare a **short media report** to inform the public about the issue.

8.2. Listening: Media bias

Learning activities 8.2

Activity 8.2.1



- Here we have two statements about the same event:

Statement A:

"The town leaders successfully solved the water problem and protected the citizens."

Statement B:

"Town leaders delayed action and ignored warnings about the dangerous water."

discuss:

1. Which statement sounds **more positive** about the leaders?
2. Which one sounds **more critical**?
3. What words show the writer's opinion?
4. Why might different media sources present the same event differently?

Activity 8.2.2



Role-Play Interview

Situation: A journalist is interviewing different people about the issue of polluted water in the town's baths.

Task

Work in **pairs**:

1. **Student A:** Journalist
2. **Student B:** Interviewee (doctor, town leader, citizen, or social media user)

The journalist asks questions such as:

1. What do you think about the problem in the baths?
2. Should the news be published immediately?
3. How can media avoid spreading biased information?
4. What advice would you give to people who read news on social media?

8.3. Speaking: Misinformation and responsible communication

Learning activities 8.3

Activity 8.3.1



Discuss the following questions:

- What is **misinformation**?
- How can misinformation spread on **social media**?
- How do young people usually communicate today?
- What problems can happen when people share information on social media?

Listen carefully as a conversation between Makenga and Shyaka is being read to you. Do the tasks that follow.

DIALOGUE

Makenga: Hello Shyaka, I saw a message on social media saying that something serious happened in our community. Many people are sharing it online.

Shyaka: I saw that message too. But I am not sure if it is true. Sometimes people share information without checking the facts.

Makenga: That is true. Our teacher always reminds us that we should verify information before sharing it online.

Shyaka: Yes, last week I almost shared a story that turned out to be false. Fortunately, I checked another website before posting it.

Makenga: Social media is useful for communication, but misinformation can spread very quickly.

Shyaka: Exactly. Young people must be careful. We should always check reliable sources and think before we share anything online.

Makenga: I agree. If everyone shares information responsibly, it will be easier to stop rumours and misinformation.

Activity 8.3.2



Listen again carefully to the conversation between **Makenga and Shyaka** and complete the sentences with the missing words.

1. Makenga saw a message on _____ saying that something serious happened in the community.
2. Shyaka was not sure if the message was _____.
3. Their teacher advises them to _____ information before sharing it online.
4. Shyaka almost shared a story that turned out to be _____.
5. Social media is useful for communication, but _____ can spread very quickly.
6. Young people should check _____ sources before sharing information.
7. Makenga says that sharing information _____ can help stop rumours.

Activity 8.3.3



With reference to what you have heard, answer the following questions in full sentences

- a) What advice does Makenga mention about sharing information online?
- b) Why can misinformation spread quickly on social media?
- c) What should young people do before sharing information online?

Activity 8.3.4



Scenario: Youth Voices Against Misinformation

- In recent years, social media has become a powerful tool for communication. However, false information about countries, leaders, and communities sometimes spreads quickly online.
- **Your school is organizing a Youth Digital Responsibility Forum where students will discuss how young people can use media responsibly and help stop misinformation.**
- You have been selected to deliver a **short speech to fellow youth** on the topic:
"How Can Young People Help Fight Misinformation Online?"
- Write a **short speech** addressing other young people.

Your speech should include:

- **One example** of how misinformation spreads online.
- **Two actions** young people can take to stop misinformation.
- **One recommendation** using modal verbs such as **should, must, or ought to**.
- A closing message encouraging responsible digital communication.

8.4. Language Structures

Learning activities 8.4

Activity 8.4.1



Read the short extract and discuss the questions that follow

"You may set to work and print it, Mr. Hovstad!" (Dr. Stockmann)

"He stated that great injury had been done to the reputation of the Baths."

"It is true he did mention something about it." (Hovstad)

- A) In the first line, Dr. Stockmann speaks directly. Which two punctuation marks signal that these are his exact words?
- B) The second sentence begins "He stated that...". Is this direct or reported speech? How do you know?
- C) Compare: "I will print it." → He said he would print it. What happened to the verb tense? Why?
- D) Look at Hovstad's line. He is reporting something the Doctor did — but not quoting him directly.

What reporting verb is used, and what tense follows it?

A.

1. DIRECT AND INDIRECT SPEECH

(For quoting and reporting information in news, media & digital communication)

Direct and indirect speech are used to **report what someone said accurately or in summary form**, especially in modern communication such as:

1. 📺 News reports (TV, radio, online news)
2. 🎙️ Interviews (journalists, podcasts, YouTube shows)
3. 📱 Social media posts (X/Twitter, Facebook, Instagram captions)
4. 🌐 Blogs and digital articles
5. 💬 Online discussions and reports

They help journalists and digital creators **communicate information clearly and professionally**.

2. DIRECT SPEECH (QUOTING)

Direct speech shows the **exact words of the speaker**

Used when accuracy and originality are important

Uses quotation marks (" ")

Example (Media context):

The minister said, **"Digital technology is transforming Rwanda's economy."**

Used in:

1. News headlines
2. Interviews
3. Live reports
4. Social media quotes

MAIN USES IN MEDIA & DIGITAL COMMUNICATION

✓ Direct speech

1. Gives exact quotes from leaders, experts, and witnesses
2. Makes news more authentic and powerful

✓ Indirect speech

1. Summarises long interviews or speeches
2. Makes reports shorter and easier to read

Journalists often **combine both styles** in one article for clarity and impact.

These verbs make news writing more professional:

1. stated that
2. explained that
3. reported that
4. emphasized that
5. confirmed that
6. announced that
7. revealed that
8. added that

Example:

The spokesperson **confirmed that** the project would expand digital access.

Activity 8.4.2



Read each scenario carefully. Choose the reporting verb that best captures the speaker's **attitude** or the **situation's tension**.

- **Scenario:** A witness in a trial is asked if they saw the suspect. They look down at their hands and speak very quietly, finally saying, "Yes, I was there."

1. The witness _____ that he had been at the scene.

- A) claimed
- B) admitted
- C) urged
- D) stated

- **Scenario:** The CEO spoke to the press about the company's new environmental policy. She stood tall and made a formal, public announcement: "We will reduce our carbon footprint by 50%."

2. The CEO _____ that the company would reduce its carbon footprint.

- A) denied
- B) insisted
- C) declared
- D) warned

- **Scenario:** A young boy is accused of breaking a window. He stamps his foot and says for the third time, "I didn't do it! I was at my friend's house!"

3. The boy _____ that he had broken the window.

- A) denied
 - B) admitted
 - C) stated
 - D) warned
- **Scenario:** A doctor looks at a patient's X-ray and says, "If you don't start exercising, your heart health will deteriorate rapidly."

4. Which verb best captures the gravity of the doctor's message?

- A) The doctor **said** that the patient should exercise.
 - B) The doctor **warned** that the patient's health would deteriorate.
 - C) The doctor **insisted** that the patient exercises.
 - D) The doctor **claimed** that exercise was necessary.
- **Scenario:** A coach sees her team losing energy in the final minutes. She shouts from the sidelines, "Keep running! Don't give up now! You can win this!"

5. The coach _____ her players to keep running.

- A) told
- B) urged
- C) stated
- D) admitted

Activity 8.4.3



Choose the most appropriate reporting verb for each sentence. Justify your choice.

1. The journalist _____ (said / claimed / insisted) that the water was safe, but no tests had been done.
2. The editor _____ (told / warned / denied) her team that publishing unverified information would damage the paper's credibility.
3. The Mayor _____ (admitted / declared / urged) that he had known about the contamination for weeks.

B. Active and Passive Voice

Activity 8.4.4



Read the short extract below and discuss the questions that follow

"Billing laid the manuscript on the desk."

"The report has not been placed before the governing body of the Baths — it was put in the hands of certain individuals, who have seen fit to circulate it widely."

"In that case we may venture to print it."

1. In the first sentence, who performs the action? What is the subject, and what is the verb?
2. In the Mayor's speech (second extract), who placed the report? Is the responsible agent clearly named? Why might the Mayor choose to omit it?
3. "It was put in the hands of certain individuals." What does this passive construction achieve in terms of the Mayor's rhetorical strategy?
4. News headlines often use the passive. Why? Consider: *"Contamination discovered in town Baths"* vs. *"Dr. Stockmann discovered contamination in town Baths."*

Activity 8.4.5



Read the notes in the box below and answer the questions that follow

► Active voice

The subject performs the action. This is the default, most direct construction.

Structure: Subject + verb + object

Billing laid the manuscript on the desk.

► Passive voice

The subject receives the action. The agent (the person or thing performing the action) may be expressed with **by**, or omitted entirely.

Structure: Subject + to be (in the appropriate tense) + past participle (+ by + agent)

The manuscript was laid on the desk (by Billing).

Passive tense forms — full reference table:

Tense	Active	Passive
Present simple	They print the article.	The article is printed.
Present continuous	They are printing it.	It is being printed.
Past simple	They printed it.	It was printed.
Past continuous	They were printing it.	It was being printed.
Present perfect	They have printed it.	It has been printed.
Past perfect	They had printed it.	It had been printed.
Future simple	They will print it.	It will be printed.
Modal	They must print it.	It must be printed.

► When to use passive voice in media and digital communication:

Purpose	Example
To focus on the action/result, not the actor	The article was published on the front page.
To omit an unknown or irrelevant agent	The files were leaked overnight.
To maintain objectivity in formal reporting	The report was submitted to the committee.
To obscure responsibility (rhetorical strategy)	Mistakes were made in the reporting process.
To foreground the affected party	The community was informed of the contamination.

► The passive with **get** (informal / journalistic)

In less formal writing and spoken news commentary, **get** can replace **be** in the passive.

The editor got fired after the misinformation scandal. (informal)

The story got published despite the Mayor's objections. (informal)

► Passive with two objects (ditransitive verbs)

Verbs like *give*, *send*, *show*, *tell*, *offer* take two objects in the active. Either object can become the subject of the passive:

The committee sent Hovstad the report. → Hovstad was sent the report. / The report was sent to Hovstad.

Transform each passive sentence into the active voice. Supply a logical subject where none is given.

1. The report had not been placed before the governing body.
2. The article was being read by Billing when Hovstad entered the office.
3. Several facts in the story were found to be inaccurate.

Activity 8.4.6



The following paragraph is from a news report. Underline all passive constructions, then discuss why the journalist chose the passive in each case.

"A statement was issued by the Baths Committee yesterday, in which it was confirmed that the water supply had been tested and found to contain dangerous levels of contamination. The Medical Officer's report had been reviewed by three independent experts. It has now been decided that the Baths will be closed until further notice. Members of the public are urged to avoid the area."

C. Connectors of contrast and Addition

Activity 8.4.7



Read the paragraph below and answer the questions that follow

"Yes, and if the Mayor does not fall in with the Doctor's project, he will lose the support of all the large shareholders in the Baths. Moreover, if he does fall in with it, he will fall out with the small tradesmen. In that case we may venture to print it. However, I don't think it would be advisable to follow him if he goes too far."

1. The word "Moreover" appears in Hovstad's argument. Does it introduce an idea that adds to or contrasts with what came before?
2. What does "However" signal? Does the idea that follows agree with or contradict the previous sentence?
3. Can you replace "Moreover" with "In addition" without changing the meaning? What about replacing "However" with "Nevertheless"? Are there any subtle differences?
4. Think about a news article or blog post you have read recently. Which connecting words were used to structure the argument?

Activity 8.4.8



Read the notes in the box below and discuss the use of connectors of contrast and addition:

Connectors of Contrast and Addition

► The role of connectors in formal writing

Connectors (also called discourse markers or linking adverbials) organize ideas within and between sentences. In journalism, editorial writing, and digital communication, they signal logical relationships to the reader. At B2 level, it is important to know not only the meaning of each connector but also its **register** (formal / neutral / informal), **position** in the sentence, and **punctuation**

► Connectors of addition

Connector	Notes & Example
Moreover	Adds a point that reinforces or strengthens the previous one. Usually sentence-initial + comma. "The report was accurate. Moreover, it was the first to expose the scandal."
Furthermore	Similar to moreover; adds a further, often stronger point. Common in academic and editorial writing. "The data was clear. Furthermore, it had been independently verified."
in addition	Adds supplementary information. Sentence-initial + comma, or mid-sentence. "In addition to the water tests, three experts reviewed the report."
Besides	Adds an afterthought or extra supporting reason. "Besides, the public has a right to know."
also / too / as well	Less emphatic; used within a clause, not usually sentence-initial. "The article was also published online."

► Connectors of contrast

Connector	Notes & Example
However	Introduces a contrasting idea. Always sentence-initial or after a semicolon + comma. Cannot join two clauses with a comma alone (comma splice error). "He agreed to publish. However, he had his own motives."
nevertheless / nonetheless	Concedes a point then contradicts it. Stronger than however. "The evidence was disputed. Nevertheless, the article ran on the front page."
Whereas	Directly contrasts two clauses within one sentence. It is a subordinating conjunction — it cannot start a standalone sentence. "Petra valued honesty, whereas Hovstad was guided by self-interest."
while / whilst	Like whereas; may also suggest simultaneity. Common in British English. "While Aslaksen urged moderation, Billing called for action."
Yet	Adds a surprising or unexpected contrast. Often mid-sentence. "The report was ready, yet no one dared to publish it."
on the other hand	Balances two opposite points. Often used to introduce a counterargument. "The press has a duty to inform. On the other hand, it must avoid causing panic."

► Critical punctuation note

AVOID the comma splice: Do not join two independent clauses with a comma alone when using however, moreover, or furthermore.

- × Incorrect: The article was ready, however the Mayor objected.
- ✓ Correct: The article was ready. However, the Mayor objected.
- ✓ Correct: The article was ready; however, the Mayor objected.

Activity 8.4.9: Join the two sentences using the connector in brackets. Pay careful attention to punctuation.

1. The article was well-written. It contained several factual errors. [however]
2. The newspaper apologised for the misinformation. It published a full correction the following day. [moreover]
3. Digital media reaches a global audience in seconds. Traditional print journalism requires far more time to distribute. [whereas]
4. The community was not informed of the contamination for weeks. Independent journalists had already begun investigating. [nevertheless]

Activity 8.4.10



Identify the error in each sentence and rewrite it correctly.

1. The editor agreed with the decision, however she had serious reservations.
2. Whereas the article was factually correct.
3. He was an experienced journalist, moreover he had covered similar stories before

D. Adjectives and Adverbs of Manner

Activity 8.4.11



Read the sentences below and discuss the questions that follow

"Every word falls like the blow of a sledgehammer." (Billing)

"It is so clear and intelligible." (Hovstad)

"He may prove invaluablely useful to us." (Hovstad)

"I can't tell you how eagerly and passionately I want to see it burst upon the public." (Dr. Stockmann)

1. In "clear and intelligible", what word class are these words? Which noun do they describe?
2. In "invaluably useful", which word modifies which? How does the adverb change the meaning of the adjective?
3. Billing says words fall "like the blow of a sledgehammer." This is a simile. What does it tell us about the tone and impact of Dr. Stockmann's article?
4. "Eagerly and passionately" modify the verb "want". How do they shape the reader's / listener's impression of Dr. Stockmann's character at this moment?

Activity 8.4.12



Study the details in the box below and do the exercises that follow

► Adjectives: position, order, and degree

Adjectives describe or modify nouns. At B2 level, you are expected to use adjectives accurately in terms of position, degree, and word order.

Attributive vs. predicative position:

Attributive (before noun)	Predicative (after linking verb)
"a clear, intelligible article"	"The article is clear and intelligible."
"a prestigious independent newspaper"	"The newspaper is prestigious and independent."

Adjective order (when multiple adjectives precede a noun):

Opinion → Size → Age → Shape → Colour → Origin → Material → Purpose + Noun

a sensational new digital investigative report

a reliable independent French media source

Gradable vs. non-gradable adjectives:

Most adjectives are **gradable** (they can be modified by very, quite, rather, fairly, extremely): *very clear, fairly objective*. Some adjectives are **absolute** or **non-gradable** (they cannot be modified by very): *unique, impossible, essential, invaluable*. These are modified by **absolutely, completely, utterly**: *absolutely essential, completely impossible*.

► Adverbs of manner: formation, position, and degrees

Adverbs of manner describe how an action is performed. They are typically formed by adding **-ly** to an adjective.

Adjective	Adverb	Note
Calm	calmly	Standard -ly formation. "The journalist spoke calmly."
Objective	objectively	"She reported objectively on the crisis."
Eager	eagerly	"He eagerly awaited the publication."
Passionate	passionately	"She argued passionately for the public's right to know."
Invaluable	invaluably	"He proved invaluably useful." (modifies an adjective)
Good	Well	"The article was well written." (irregular)
Hard	Hard	"He worked hard on the report." (not "hardly" — different meaning)
Fast	Fast	"The news spread fast." (no -ly form)

Position of adverbs of manner:

Adverbs of manner typically appear **after the verb** (and its object if there is one). They can also appear sentence-initially for emphasis:

The reporter spoke calmly and objectively. ✓ (after verb)

She carefully reviewed the facts before publishing. ✓ (before verb — also acceptable)

Calmly and objectively, she addressed the committee. ✓ (sentence-initial — emphatic)

She spoke calmly the crowd. × (adverb cannot go between verb and object)

► Adverbs modifying adjectives (intensifiers and downtoners):

Adverbs can modify adjectives to intensify or reduce their force. At B2 level, range and precision matter:

Effect	Examples in media contexts
Amplifier	extremely accurate, remarkably clear, utterly irresponsible, deeply misleading
Booster (non-gradable)	absolutely essential, completely unverified, entirely groundless
Downtoner	fairly objective, somewhat biased, rather one-sided, slightly misleading

Choose the correct form (adjective or adverb) to complete each sentence. Then identify what word it modifies.

1. The editor read the report _____ before approving it for publication. (careful / carefully)
2. Dr. Stockmann's article was _____ and easy for the public to understand. (clear / clearly)
3. The journalist responded _____ to the Mayor's accusations. (confident / confidently)
4. It was a _____ researched piece that presented all sides of the argument. (thorough / thoroughly)

Activity 8.4.13



Rewrite each sentence by adding a precise adjective or adverb from the box. More than one answer may fit explain your choice.

urgently / biased / thoroughly / independent / accurately / deeply / impartial

1. The reporter verified all sources before publishing the story.
2. The newspaper called for an investigation into the contamination.
3. The committee reviewed the complaint and dismissed it without proper consideration.
4. The coverage of the event was criticised for presenting only one perspective.

E. Punctuation for Quotation and Emphasis

Activity 8.4.14



Read the following text extract and discuss the questions that follow

Dr. Stockmann: "Take care of it as if it were a treasure! No misprints — every word is important."

Hovstad: "I don't think it would be advisable to follow him if he goes too far."

Peter Stockmann stated that great injury had been done to the reputation of the "People's Messenger."

1. What do the quotation marks around "People's Messenger" indicate? Is this the same function as when quotation marks enclose a full spoken line?
2. In Dr. Stockmann's line, there is an em dash (—) before "every word is important." What effect does this create? Could a comma or full stop replace it — and would the meaning change?

3. Look at this sentence: *The editor said: "Verify your facts before you publish."* What does the colon signal here, and where is it placed relative to the quotation marks?

4. Why is an exclamation mark used in "Take care of it as if it were a treasure!" rather than a full stop?

Activity 8.4.15



Read the notes in the box below and complete the tasks that follow

Punctuation for Quotation and Emphasis

► Uses of quotation marks:

Use	Example
Titles of articles, sections, episodes	The article "Truth or Consequence" was published in 2024.
Coined terms / technical jargon	The report described what it called a 'media blackout'.
Irony or distancing	The so-called 'independent' investigation was funded by the accused.
Newly introduced terms	He coined the phrase 'citizen journalism' in his article.

► The colon in quotation and listing

A colon is used after an introductory clause to present a direct quotation, a list, or a summarising statement. Note: both items on either side of a colon must be grammatically complete independent clauses, or the left side must be a complete clause.

- ✓ The editor had one rule: verify everything before publication.
- ✓ The report made three demands: transparency, accountability, and reform.
- × He said that: the report was inaccurate. (No colon after 'that')

► The em dash (—) for emphasis and interruption

The em dash is a powerful punctuation tool in journalism and formal writing. It creates a more dramatic pause than a comma and a less final stop than a full stop. It has several specific uses:

Function	Example
Add emphasis after a build-up	No misprints — every word is important.
Insert parenthetical information	The editor — under considerable pressure — agreed to delay publication.
Signal an abrupt interruption	"The article is ready, but —" She was cut off mid-sentence.
Introduce a surprising conclusion	He read every line carefully, checked every source, made every call — and still got the story wrong.

Add the correct punctuation mark (quotation marks, colon, em dash, or exclamation mark) in each sentence.

1. The journalist declared This is the most important story of the year.
2. The report stated one thing above all journalists must verify their sources.
3. The article was biased it presented only one side of the story.
4. The editor replied We cannot publish unverified information.

F. Emphatic Structures / Inversion

Activity 8.4.16



Read the short extract below and discuss the questions that follow

Peter Stockmann (to Hovstad): "Rarely does a newspaper bear so much responsibility for the peace of a community. You must not print this article."

1. In "Rarely does a newspaper bear...", is the word order the same as in a standard declarative sentence? What would the standard order be?
2. Why does the Mayor begin with "Rarely" rather than placing it mid-sentence? What rhetorical effect does this have on Hovstad?
3. Compare these two sentences. Which sounds more emphatic? Why?
 - a) A newspaper rarely bears so much responsibility.
 - b) Rarely does a newspaper bear so much responsibility.
4. Can you identify a similar inversion structure used in news headlines or formal speeches you have heard or read?

► What is emphatic inversion?

In standard English declarative sentences, the order is Subject + Auxiliary + Main Verb. Emphatic inversion reverses this to: **Negative/Restrictive Adverb + Auxiliary + Subject + Main Verb**. This structure is characteristic of formal writing, political speeches, editorials, and news commentary. It gives special weight to the opening adverb, signalling to the reader that what follows is exceptional, extreme, or morally significant.

► Triggers: negative and restrictive adverbs

Adverb / phrase	Normal word order	Emphatic inversion
Never	We have never seen such manipulation.	Never have we seen such manipulation.
Rarely	A report rarely attracts so much attention.	Rarely does a report attract so much attention.

Seldom	Editors seldom face such pressure.	Seldom do editors face such pressure.
Hardly	The ink had hardly dried when the controversy began.	Hardly had the ink dried when the controversy began.
Scarcely	The article had scarcely been published when it was retracted.	Scarcely had the article been published when it was retracted.
Not until	The public did not learn the truth until the article was printed.	Not until the article was printed did the public learn the truth.
Not only	The article was not only inaccurate but also misleading.	Not only was the article inaccurate, but it was also misleading.
Only then	They only then understood the full impact of the story.	Only then did they understand the full impact of the story.
Little	They little realised the damage this story would cause.	Little did they realise the damage this story would cause.
No sooner... than	He had no sooner published the article than he was summoned.	No sooner had he published the article than he was summoned.

► How inversion works: the auxiliary rule

When the original sentence has an auxiliary verb (*have, be, will, can, could, would, should*), that auxiliary moves before the subject. When there is no auxiliary, a **dummy auxiliary** (*do / does / did*) is introduced:

With existing auxiliary	With dummy do/does/did
Never have journalists faced such a dilemma.	Rarely does an editor make such a decision.
Not until then had the truth emerged.	Seldom did a story cause so much controversy.
Hardly had the story broken when calls began.	Little did the public know what would follow.

► “Not only...but also” — a special case

This structure inverts the first clause, but the second clause (introduced by *but also*) returns to normal order:

Not only did the article expose the contamination, but it also named those responsible.

Not only was the newspaper accused of bias, but it also faced legal action.

► Rhetorical effect and register

Emphatic inversion is always **formal**. Its use in speech or writing signals a heightened register: political speeches, newspaper editorials, formal reports, and literary texts. In everyday spoken English or informal writing, it would sound unnatural. At B2+, using inversion correctly and appropriately demonstrates sophisticated command of formal expression.

Activity 8.4.17



A. Rewrite each sentence using emphatic inversion, beginning with the word or phrase in brackets

1. A report like this has never caused such public outrage. [Never before...]
2. A journalist rarely faces such pressure from authorities. [Rarely...]
3. The community did not understand the danger until the article was published. [Not until...]
4. The paper had hardly been distributed when the Mayor demanded a retraction. [Hardly...]
5. The article was not only inaccurate — it was also deliberately misleading. [Not only...]
6. They little imagined that the story would lead to a national inquiry. [Little...]

G. Modal Verbs for Advice and Recommendation

Activity 8.4.18



Read the extract below and discuss the questions that follow

Aslaksen: "Yes, but in moderation, Doctor — you ought to proceed carefully."

Hovstad: "I don't think it would be advisable to follow him if he goes too far."

Peter Stockmann: "You must not print this article."

1. In "you ought to proceed carefully", is Aslaksen giving a direct order or a moral suggestion? How is this different from the Mayor's "You must not print this"?
2. Compare the force of the following three sentences:
 - a) You should verify your sources.
 - b) You ought to verify your sources.
 - c) You must verify your sources.

Which is the strongest obligation? Which is the most open to refusal?

3. Hovstad says “it would be advisable to follow him if...” This is not a modal verb, but it expresses the same kind of meaning. What is this structure called, and what modal does it approximate?

4. What would change in meaning if the Mayor had said “You don’t have to print this article” instead of “You must not print this article”?

Activity 8.4.19



Read and discuss the notes in the box below then do the exercises that follow

Modals for advice, obligation, and recommendation

Modal verbs are central to professional and ethical communication in media, journalism, and digital contexts.

► Core modals: meaning and strength

Modal	Meaning	Example in media context
Must	Strong obligation / internal conviction	Journalists must verify all facts before publishing.
must not	Strong prohibition — absolutely not allowed	Editors must not suppress evidence in the public interest.
have to	Obligation from external rules or circumstances	Reporters have to comply with the press code of ethics.
don’t have to	Absence of obligation — not required but permitted	You don’t have to name your source if it puts them at risk.
Should	Advice / professional recommendation	News articles should present both sides of an argument.
ought to	Moral duty / strong recommendation (slightly more formal than should)	Editors ought to take responsibility for what they publish.
need to	Practical necessity — an action is required	Digital platforms need to address the spread of misinformation.
needn’t	No practical necessity — not required	You needn’t publish the names of minor witnesses.
had better	Strong advice with implied warning (informal/neutral)	You had better verify those figures — the editor will check.

► Critical distinction: must not vs. don’t have to

must not = prohibition	don’t have to = no obligation
Journalists must not reveal confidential sources. (It is forbidden.)	Journalists don’t have to reveal their sources. (It is not necessary / they are not required to.)

► Modal verbs for past situations: retrospective evaluation

At B2 level, modals combine with the perfect infinitive (**modal + have + past participle**) to evaluate past actions — expressing criticism, missed obligation, or regret:

Structure	Meaning & Example
should have + past participle	Past advice that was not followed — mild criticism. "Hovstad should have been more honest with Dr. Stockmann."
ought to have + past participle	Past moral duty that was neglected. "The editor ought to have checked the source before publication."
must have + past participle	Logical deduction about the past. "The Mayor must have known about the contamination for months."
needn't have + past participle	Action was done but was unnecessary. "Hovstad needn't have delayed the article — it was already verified."
could have + past participle	Possibility that existed in the past but was not realised. "He could have published the story months earlier."

► Semi-modals and modal-equivalent expressions

Several non-modal phrases express similar meanings and are common in formal and journalistic writing:

Expression	Equivalent modal / use
be required to	must / have to — formal, rule-based obligation. "All journalists are required to follow the press code."
be obliged to	must — formal; used in professional and legal contexts. "The editor was obliged to issue a retraction."
be advised to	should — formal recommendation. "Readers are advised to consult multiple sources."
it is advisable to	should — impersonal recommendation. "It is advisable to verify information before sharing it online."
it is essential / vital that + should	must — formal obligation. "It is essential that journalists should remain independent."

Rewrite each sentence using the modal perfect structure in brackets. Reflect on whether the action was or was not carried out.

1. It was a mistake for Hovstad not to be honest with Dr. Stockmann. [should have]
2. The Mayor knew about the contamination — I'm certain of it. [must have]

3. Aslaksen delayed publication, but it wasn't actually necessary. [needn't have]
4. The newspaper had the chance to break the story first, but missed it. [could have]

8.5. Media Types and Digital Content Creation

Learning activities

Activity 8.5.1



Read the scenario below and discuss the questions that follow

One morning, learners in a secondary school hear that a **youth environmental campaign** took place in their community over the weekend. Some learners heard about it **on the radio**, others **saw pictures on social media**, while another group **read about it in a newspaper**. A few students also watched a **short video online** showing young volunteers cleaning the streets.

1. Through which channels did the students receive the information?
2. Which of these sources do you use most often to get information?
3. Why do people share news and information through different media?
4. Can you give examples of media you use every day?

1. Types of Media

Media refers to the **different channels used to communicate information, ideas, and messages to the public**. Media helps people stay informed about events in society and share knowledge with others.

There are several main types of media.

a) Print Media

Print media includes information that is **printed on paper and distributed physically**.

Examples:

- Newspapers Magazines Books Posters Brochures

Print media often provides **detailed information and permanent records of events**.

b) Broadcast Media

Broadcast media communicates information through **audio or audiovisual signals transmitted to many people at the same time**.

Examples:

- Radio Television Live broadcasts

Broadcast media is useful for **quickly sharing information with large audiences**, especially during important national events or emergencies.

c) Digital Media

Digital media refers to **information created, shared, and accessed using digital devices and the internet**.

Examples:

Online newspapers Websites Podcasts Video platforms

Online learning platforms

Digital media allows information to be **shared instantly across the world**.

d) Social Media

Social media is a form of digital media that allows users to **create, share, and interact with content online**.

Examples:

1.Facebook X (Twitter) Instagram WhatsApp YouTube

Social media enables people to **communicate quickly, exchange opinions, and participate in discussions**

Creating Media and Digital Content

Media professionals and ordinary citizens create content to **inform, educate, entertain, or persuade audiences**. Digital communication has made it easier for people to produce and share information.

Three common forms of media writing include:

1. News reporting
2. Press releases
3. blog posts

What is News Writing?

News writing is the process of **reporting recent events clearly, accurately, and objectively for the public**.

A good news report answers these six questions:

- Who was involved?
- What happened?
- Where did it happen?
- When did it happen?
- Why did it happen?
- How did it happen?

Writing Press Releases

A press release is a **formal announcement sent to media organizations to inform the public about an event or important development.**

It is commonly used by:

1. organizations
2. schools
3. government institutions
4. companies
5. NGOs

Structure of a Press Release

1. Headline
2. Date and location
3. Main announcement
4. Additional details
5. Contact information

Example

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

School Launches Digital Media Day

Kigali — Green Hills Secondary School will organize a Digital Media Day next Friday to encourage learners to explore digital communication and creativity.

The event will include workshops, student presentations, and discussions about responsible use of social media. According to the organizers, the event aims to develop learners' communication and digital skills.

For more information contact:
Green Hills Secondary School Media Club

Writing Blog Posts

A blog post is an **informal article published on a website where writers share ideas, opinions, or experiences.**

Blog posts often:

- explain ideas
- share experiences
- give advice
- discuss social issues

Example Blog Post

Why Media Literacy Matters for Young People

Today, young people receive information from many different sources such as television, radio, and social media. While this provides many opportunities to learn, it also requires learners to think critically about the information they receive.

Media literacy helps individuals Analyse information carefully, identify reliable sources, and avoid misinformation. Developing these skills allows young people to become responsible digital citizens.

Activity 8.5.2



A. Match each type of media with its example

Type of Media	Example
1. Print media	a) Television
2. Broadcast media	b) Newspaper
3. Digital media	c) Website
4. Social media	d) Instagram

Activity 8.5.3



Read the news report below before answering the questions that follow

Students Lead Tree-Planting Campaign

Students from several secondary schools in Kigali organized a tree-planting campaign on Saturday to promote environmental protection. The activity took place near a community park where volunteers planted more than 300 trees.

According to the organizers, the campaign aims to encourage young people to participate in protecting the environment. Local leaders praised the initiative and encouraged more youth to support environmental activities.

Comprehension Questions

- 1.What event is reported in the article?
- 2.Where did the activity take place?
- 3.Who participated in the campaign?
- 4.What was the purpose of the activity?

Application activity 8.5



I. Write a short news report (120–150 words) about one of the following events:

- A school debate competition
- A sports tournament
- A community cleaning campaign

II. Write a blog post (150–180 words) on one of the following topics:

- Responsible use of social media
- The role of media in education
- How digital communication connects people around the world

8.6. END-OF-UNIT ASSESSMENT

End of unit assessment



SECTION A. Reading Comprehension and vocabulary

Read the following extract carefully, then answer all questions that follow.

Text: From a Digital News Editorial

The following is an extract from an online editorial published in a national newspaper's digital platform, discussing the role of social media in spreading public health information.



Rarely has a public health crisis been shaped so powerfully by social media. When reports of contaminated water first surfaced in the region, they were not announced by government authorities or broadcast on national television. Instead, they were posted by a local doctor on a community forum — and within hours, the message had been shared thousands of times.

The speed with which information travels today is both an asset and a threat. Moreover, the responsibility for verifying that information no longer rests solely with professional journalists. Every citizen who shares a post, forwards a message, or comments on a story is, in some sense, acting as a communicator.

However, this democratisation of communication has come at a cost. Misinformation has been spread widely — sometimes deliberately, sometimes carelessly — and the damage it causes to communities can be severe. The article that should have been verified before publication was posted within minutes of being written. Corrections, by contrast, are rarely shared as widely as the original false claim.

Nevertheless, social media platforms must not be regarded only as tools of confusion. They have also been used to organise communities, challenge authority, and bring injustice to light. Young people, in particular, ought to understand both the power and the responsibility that come with digital communication. Not only must they learn to identify reliable sources, but they must also develop the habit of pausing before they share.

1. Comprehension Questions

Answer the following questions in complete sentences. Use evidence from the text in your answers

1. How did information about the contaminated water first reach the public? Why is this significant?
2. According to the editorial, what are the two contrasting consequences of the speed of social media communication?
3. What does the writer mean by “the democratisation of communication”? Use context clues from the text to explain.
4. The writer states: “Corrections, by contrast, are rarely shared as widely as the original false claim.” What problem in digital communication does this sentence identify?
5. The writer concludes that social media “must not be regarded only as tools of confusion.” Do you agree? Support your answer with one example from the text and one from your own experience.
6. The editorial says the contamination story was posted by a doctor, not announced by the government. What does this suggest about trust in traditional institutions today?
7. Identify one way in which the situation described in this editorial is similar to the situation in the Ibsen extract you studied in class. Explain your comparison.
8. The writer uses the phrase “sometimes deliberately, sometimes carelessly” to describe how misinformation is spread. What is the difference between these two types of misinformation? Which do you consider more dangerous, and why?

2. Vocabulary

The words and expressions below are taken from the editorial in Section A or from the unit texts. Match each word or expression in Column A with its correct meaning in Column B.

Column A — Word / Expression	Column B — Meaning
1. democratisation of communication	a) A process in which information is checked for accuracy before being published
2. misinformation	b) The act of restoring responsibility or credit to the correct person or source
3. verification	c) False or inaccurate information spread, regardless of intent
4. credibility	d) The quality of being trusted and believed
5. editorial	e) The process of making communication accessible to all citizens, not just professionals
6. attribution	f) A newspaper article that expresses the opinion of the publication or its editors

1. Complete each sentence with the correct form of the word given in brackets. Make any necessary changes.

1. The committee stated that the report was _____ and would be immediately withdrawn. (verify)
2. She spoke _____ and _____ about the dangers of unverified online content. (calm / objective)
3. The newspaper's _____ on this issue was compromised by its close relationship with the government. (independent)
4. The _____ of false information online is a growing concern for educators and policymakers. (spread — use a noun form)
5. Digital platforms have a _____ responsibility to protect users from harmful content. (profession)

2. Read the two statements below describing the same event. Answer the questions that follow.

Statement A: *"Town authorities acted swiftly to manage the water situation and protect public safety."*

Statement B: *"Town officials delayed their response while residents suffered the consequences of contaminated water."*

1. Identify one word or phrase in each statement that reveals the writer's attitude towards the town authorities.

Statement A: _____

Statement B: _____

2. Which statement appears more factual and objective? Justify your answer.

3. Rewrite Statement B in a neutral, objective register, removing any bias.

SECTION B :Language use

A. Rewrite each sentence as reported speech. Choose a precise reporting verb from the box and justify your choice in brackets.

claimed / warned / urged / admitted / stated / insisted

1. The editor: "This article will damage our reputation — do not publish it."
2. The journalist: "I verified every source before writing this report."
3. The Mayor: "There is absolutely no contamination in the water supply." (but there was)

B. The following sentences contain errors in reported speech. Identify the error and rewrite the sentence correctly.

1. She said that the article is ready and they can publish it tomorrow.
2. He told to the editor that he will resign if the story is not printed.

C. Transform each sentence as instructed.

1. The youth association launched the digital awareness campaign last week. → [passive]
2. The contaminated water report had been submitted to the committee by the Medical Officer. → [active]
3. Several journalists are investigating the story. → [passive, omit agent]

D. Read the news headline below and rewrite it as a complete passive sentence in the past tense. Then explain why the passive is appropriate in news headlines.

"Youth Association Launches Awareness Campaign"

Passive sentence: _____

Explanation:

E. Fill in the blank with the most appropriate connector. Be ready to explain your choice.

1. The report was accurate and well-written. _____, it contained one unverified claim that undermined its credibility.

2. The journalist checked three different sources; _____, she consulted a medical expert before publishing.
3. Traditional media relies on professional editors and fact-checkers, _____ social media allows anyone to publish without verification.

F. One sentence below contains a punctuation error related to connectors. Identify it, explain the error, and rewrite the sentence correctly.

- a) The article was published online. However, many readers questioned its accuracy.
- b) The story went viral, moreover it was shared by several public figures.
- c) Whereas print media is often regulated, social media remains largely uncontrolled.

G. Choose the correct option and identify what it modifies.

1. The broadcast journalist presented the findings _____ and without personal opinion. (objective / objectively)
2. It was a _____ produced documentary that challenged the government's version of events. (thorough / thoroughly)
3. She felt _____ uncomfortable about publishing the story without further evidence. (extreme / extremely)

H. Correct the error in adverb placement in each sentence.

1. The editor reviewed carefully the facts before approving the article for publication.
2. She reported accurately and objectively the events to the committee.

I. Add the missing punctuation in each sentence (quotation marks, colon, em dash, or exclamation mark).

1. The editor had one firm rule verify before you publish.
2. Never share unverified content the consequences can be irreversible.
3. The journalist declared this story must be told.

J. Explain the difference in effect between the following two sentences:

- a) *No misprints, every word is important.*
- b) *No misprints — every word is important.*

K. Rewrite each sentence using the emphatic inversion structure indicated.

1. A journalist has never faced such intense pressure to suppress a story. [Never before...]
2. The community only began to demand answers after the full report was published. [Only after...]
3. The article was not only accurate but also the first to expose the wrongdoing. [Not only...]

L. Identify and correct the inversion error.

"Rarely a digital platform takes responsibility for the misinformation it allows to spread."

M. Complete each sentence with the most appropriate modal expression from the box.

must / must not / should / ought to / need to / don't have to

1. Journalists _____ always verify the identity of their sources before publishing a story.
2. A newspaper _____ be used as a political tool — this compromises its independence.
3. You _____ reveal your source's name if doing so would put them in danger.
4. Digital platforms _____ develop clearer systems for flagging unverified content.
5. The editor felt that reporters _____ be more careful when covering sensitive community issues.

N. Rewrite each sentence using a modal perfect structure to evaluate the past situation.

1. It was wrong for the journalist to publish the story without checking the facts. [should have]
2. I am certain the editor knew about the inaccuracies before publication. [must have]
3. The newspaper missed the opportunity to be the first to break the story. [could have]

SECTION C Writing Production

Choose **ONE** of the following writing tasks. Write your response in the space provided on the answer sheet or on a separate sheet.

- **Situation:** A local doctor has discovered that the water at a community swimming pool has been found to contain dangerous levels of bacteria. Local authorities have not yet made an official announcement.

Task: You are a journalist for an online news platform. Write a news report (180–220 words) to inform the public about this situation.

Your report must include:

- A clear, factual headline
- Answers to the 5Ws and 1H (Who, What, Where, When, Why, How)
- At least one direct quotation from a source (doctor, witness, or official)
- Objective, formal register without personal bias

- **Situation:** Your school's digital magazine has asked you to contribute a blog post addressed to young people about the responsible use of social media.

Task: Write a blog post (200–240 words) titled: *"Think Before You Share: How Young People Can Fight Misinformation Online"*

Your blog post must include:

- An engaging opening paragraph addressed to young readers
- At least one emphatic inversion structure (Never..., Rarely..., Not only...)
- At least two connectors of contrast or addition
- At least two modal verbs expressing advice or obligation
- A concluding call to action

PROJECT: Digital Voices for Change

(Units 7 & 8 – Technology / Media and Digital Communication)

Project Overview

Technology and media have transformed how people communicate, learn, and participate in society. In Rwanda, digital platforms are increasingly used to promote education, entrepreneurship, community development, and innovation.

In this project, you will investigate how **media and technology influence society today**.

You will Analyse online articles or blog posts, discuss **ethical issues in digital communication**, and collaborate to produce a **digital newsletter or a podcast episode** highlighting the **positive impact of technology in Rwanda**.

This project helps you develop **research skills, media literacy, communication abilities, and responsible digital citizenship**.

Project Tasks

Step 1: Research and Investigation

investigate how technology and media influence society in Rwanda.

Research Activity

Search for **online articles, news reports, or blog posts** about technology and media in Rwanda.

Then discuss the following questions:

1. What technological innovation is described in the article?

2. How does it benefit society?
3. What challenges or ethical issues are mentioned?
4. How can young people use technology responsibly?

Take notes and summarize your findings.

Step 2: Media Ethics Discussion

Technology and digital media bring many opportunities, but they also require responsible use.

Discuss the following questions in your group:

- Why is it important to verify information before sharing it online?
- What problems can arise from spreading false information on social media?
- How can digital platforms be used positively to promote community development?
- What rules should people follow to communicate respectfully online?

Step 3: Content Creation

Each group will produce **one of the following media products**.

Option A: Digital Newsletter

Create a **two-page digital newsletter** highlighting positive technological developments in Rwanda.

Suggested tools: Microsoft Word Google Docs Canva PowerPoint

Option B: Podcast Episode

Create a **3–5-minute podcast episode** discussing the role of technology in society.

Your podcast should include:

- An **introduction to the topic**
- A **discussion of one technological innovation**
- An explanation of **how it benefits society**
- A short section about **responsible digital communication**
- A **conclusion summarizing the discussion**

Learners may use a **smartphone or simple recording application** to record the podcast.

Step 4: Presentation: Each group presents their project to the class.

Presentation Guidelines

Students should:

1. Explain the topic they investigated
2. Present their newsletter or play their podcast recording
3. Discuss the positive impacts of technology
4. Explain the ethical guidelines they developed

After each presentation, other learners may ask questions

UNIT 9

GENDER EQUITY AND EMPOWERMENT



Key Unit Competence:

Communicate effectively about gender equity and empowerment while promoting equal participation, inclusion, and social justice.

Learning objectives

By the end of this unit, you will be able to:

Knowledge and understanding

1

1. Explain the concept of **gender equity and empowerment** and how drama can promote fairness and respect.
2. Identify how **dramatic texts portray gender roles, equality, and social issues**.
3. Recognize features of a **dramatic script** (plot, setting, dialogue, conflict) and language structures used in drama such as reported speech and conditionals.

Skills

2

1. Read and interpret **dramatic extracts and dialogues** related to gender issues.
2. Write and perform **short dramatic scenes or dialogues** that promote gender equity and mutual respect.
3. Analyse themes, characters, and conflicts in plays and express opinions confidently in discussions.

Attitudes and values

3

1. Respect and value **both genders equally** in communication and daily life.
2. Show **empathy, fairness, and cooperation** when interacting with others.
3. Appreciate drama as a tool for promoting **equality, empowerment, and positive social change**.

Introduction

Gender equity and empowerment mean that women and men have equal rights, opportunities, and responsibilities in society. Promoting fairness between genders helps build communities based on respect, cooperation, and equal participation in education, leadership, and development. In this unit, you will explore how dramatic texts portray gender roles, equality, and empowerment. Through reading, discussion, and creative writing, you will analyse characters, conflicts, and themes in plays that address gender issues while developing language skills such as reported speech, conditional sentences, and emotional expressions. By writing and performing short dramatic scenes, learners will also reflect on how drama can challenge inequality and encourage respect, fairness, and positive social change.

Introductory activity



Read the following statements and discuss

- A. In a family, only girls are expected to cook and do housework.
 - B. A school chooses a boy as class leader even though a girl performed better in leadership activities.
 - C. In a company, both men and women are given equal opportunities to become leaders.
 - D. A girl is told that science subjects are only for boys.
1. Which situations show **fair treatment**?
 2. Which situations show **gender inequality**?
 3. How can people promote **gender equity** in schools and communities?

9.1. Gender roles

Learning activities 9.1

A. Reading

Activity 9.1



Observe the picture and discuss the following questions

- a) What activities do you see in the picture?
- b) Do boys and girls usually share these responsibilities equally in your community?
- c) How might too many household chores affect a child's education or future opportunities?

d) Do you think every child should have equal opportunities to study and grow? Why?

Activity 9.1.2



Read the Extract from *The Crucible* by Arthur Miller– Act One, then do tasks that follow

Abigail: Gah! I'd almost forgotten how strong you are, John Proctor!

Proctor (*looking at Abigail now, the faintest hint of a knowing smile on his face*): What's this mischief here?

Abigail (*with a nervous laugh*): Oh, she's only gone silly somehow.

Proctor: The road past my house is a pilgrimage to Salem all morning. The town's mumbling witchcraft.

Abigail: Oh, posh! (*Winningly, she edges closer with a confidential, wicked air.*) We were dancin' in the woods last night, and my uncle leaped in on us. She took fright, is all.

Proctor (*his smile widening*): Ah, you're wicked yet, aren't y'! (*A trill of expectant laughter escapes her; she dares come closer, feverishly searching his eyes.*) You'll be clapped in the stocks before you're twenty.

(*He takes a step to go; she springs into his path.*)

Abigail: Give me a word, John. A soft word. (*Her intense desire wipes the smile from his face.*)

Proctor: No, no, Abby. That's done with.

Abigail (*taunting*): You came five miles to see a silly girl fly? I know you better.

Proctor (*setting her firmly aside*): I came to see what mischief your uncle's brewin' now. (*With final emphasis:*) Put it out of mind, Abby.

Abigail (*grasping his hand*): John—I am waitin' for you every night.

Proctor: Abby, I never gave you hope to wait for me.

Abigail (*anger rising—she can't believe it*): I have something better than hope, I think!

Proctor: Abby, you'll put it out of mind. I'll not be comin' for you more.

Abigail: You're surely sportin' with me.

Proctor: You know me better.

Abigail: I know how you clutched my back behind your house and sweated like a stallion whenever I came near! Or did I dream it? It's *she* put me out—you can't pretend it was you. I saw your face when she did, and you loved me then and you do now!

Proctor: Abby, that's a wild thing to say—

Abigail: A wild thing may say wild things. But not so wild, I think. I've seen you since she put me out; I've seen you nights.

Proctor: I have hardly stepped off my farm this sevenmonth.

Abigail: I have a sense for heat, John, and yours has drawn me to my window. I've seen you looking up, burning in your loneliness. Do you tell me you've never looked up at my window?

Proctor: I may have looked up.

Abigail (*softening*): And you must. You are no wintry man. I know you, John. I know you. (*She weeps, clutching him desperately.*) I cannot sleep for dreamin'; I cannot dream but I wake and walk the house as though I'd find you comin' through the door.

Proctor (*gently pressing her away, with sympathy but firmness*): Child—

Abigail (*with a flash of anger*): How do you call me child!

Proctor: Abby, I may think of you softly from time to time. But I'll cut off my hand before I'll ever reach for you again. Wipe it out of mind. We never touched, Abby.

Abigail: Aye, but we did.

Proctor: Aye, but we did not.

Abigail (*bitterly angry*): Oh, I marvel how such a strong man may let such a sickly wife be—

Proctor (*angered, at himself too*): You'll speak nothin' of Elizabeth!

Vocabulary

Activity 9.1.3



I. Find lines in the dialogue that show:

1. Abigail teasing Proctor.
2. Proctor warning Abigail about her behavior.
3. Strong emotions between the two characters.
4. i) Which words in the extract show **conflict between the characters**?
ii) How do these words help the writer show **emotion and tension in the scene**?

II. Match the words from the extract with their correct meanings.

Word	Meaning
1. Mischief	a. Feeling of sadness caused by being alone
2. Pilgrimage	b. Behavior intended to tease or provoke someone
3. Wicked	c. Naughty or morally wrong behavior
4. Taunting	d. A journey made by many people to a particular place
5. Loneliness	e. Trouble or playful wrongdoing

III. Complete the sentences using the words below.

mischief — wicked — taunting — pilgrimage — loneliness

- a) The villagers made a _____ to Salem to hear news about witchcraft.
- b) Abigail's _____ words angered Proctor.
- c) Proctor believes Abigail is causing _____ in the town.
- d) A person may feel deep _____ when they live without companionship.
- e) Proctor calls Abigail _____ because she behaves in a troublesome way.

Comprehension questions

Activity 9.1.4



A. Read the extract again and answer the following questions

1. What is the **conflict** between Abigail and Proctor in this conversation?
2. Do you think Abigail is treated fairly in this situation? Explain your answer.
3. Identify two lines in the dialogue that show **strong emotions** from Abigail. What feelings do these lines express?
4. What does this dialogue suggest about relationships and responsibility between men and women?
5. How can mutual respect help promote **gender equity in relationships**?
6. What lesson about **respect and fairness in relationships** can readers learn from this scene?

9.2. Speaking: Equal opportunities

Learning activities

Activity 9.2.1



I. Read the following statement and discuss the questions that follow

"Boys and girls should have the same opportunities in education, leadership, and employment."

Discuss

- What does **equal opportunity** mean?
- Can you give examples of situations where boys and girls should have equal opportunities?
- What problems may occur when one gender is denied opportunities?
- How can schools promote **equal opportunities for boys and girls**?

Activity 9.2.2

Read *The Crucible*, identify a short scene, and act it out for the class.

Application activity 9.2



Imagine your school is organizing a **Gender Equity Awareness Day**. Students are invited to give short speeches about equal opportunities. Prepare a **short speech** on the topic:

"Why equal opportunities for boys and girls matter."

Your speech should include:

- A short explanation of **equal opportunities**.
- One example of **gender discrimination**.
- One suggestion to promote **fair opportunities for everyone**.

9.3. Listening: Combating discrimination

Learning activities

Activity 9.3.1



- Discuss these questions:
- What chores do children usually do at home?
- At what age should children start helping in the house?
- What does the word "freedom" mean to you? Can a child experience a lack of freedom? How?

Activity 9.3.2



Listen carefully to the excerpt of the poem "A freedom song" as being read to you and do the task that follows

A Freedom Song – Marjorie Oludhe Macgoye

Atieno washes dishes,
Atieno plucks the chicken,
Atieno gets up early,
Beds her sucks down in the kitchen,
Atieno eight years old
Atieno yo.

Since she's my sister's child
Atieno needs no pay
While she works my wife can sit
Sewing each sunny day,
With her earning I support
Atieno yo.

Atieno's sly and jealous
Bad example to the kids
Since she minds them, like a school girl
Wants their dresses, shoes and beads.
Atieno ten years old,
Atieno yo.

Questions

A. Circle the best answer

1. What is the poem mainly about?

- (A) A girl who is happy to help her family with household chores
- (B) A young girl who is exploited as an unpaid child worker by a relative
- (C) A child who disobeys her employer and refuses to work
- (D) A community that celebrates traditional family values

2. How old is Atieno at the beginning and at the end of the poem?

- (A) Six and nine years old
- (B) Eight and twelve years old
- (C) Eight and ten years old
- (D) Ten and fifteen years old

3. Who is the narrator of the poem?

- (A) Atieno herself
- (B) A sympathetic neighbour
- (C) The man who exploits Atieno
- (D) A social worker.

4. The phrase "Atieno yo" is repeated at the end of each stanza. What emotion do you think it conveys? Tick (✓) all that apply.

- (A) Celebration and joy
- (B) Sadness and resignation
- (C) A lament or cry of protest
- (D) Indifference

Application activity 9.3



The poem illustrates several forms of discrimination. Work on and complete the table below, then share your findings with the class.

Form of Discrimination	Evidence from the Poem	How Could It Be Combated?
Child labour/exploitation		
Gender-based discrimination		
Economic / class inequality		
Stereotyping/labelling		

9.4 Language Structure

A. Expressing Emotion and Emphasis in Dramatic Writing

Dramatic writing often expresses strong emotions such as anger, regret, hope, or disappointment. Writers use different language structures to show characters' feelings, explain causes and consequences, and emphasize important ideas in a story. Some of these structures include **reported speech**, **conditional sentences**, and **expressions such as "I wish" and "If only."**

Learning Activities

Activity 9.4.1



Read the short scenario inspired by the poem "**A Freedom Song**". Read the poem carefully, then imagine this short dramatic scene:

A local labor inspector visits the home after hearing rumors about a young girl working there. The Uncle (the speaker in the poem) is trying to defend himself.

The Uncle says: "I am supporting her! I promised my sister I would look after her child. If I didn't provide this home, she would be wandering the streets. She is a sly girl; I wish she weren't so jealous of my own children's clothes."

The Inspector replies: "She is only ten. If she were in school, she would have a future. I suggest you stop this immediately."

Analyze the language used in the scenario and the poem:

- The Uncle says he "promised" to look after Atieno. If you were the sister, how would you report his words?
 - Example: "He promised that..."

- b) Look at the Uncle's excuse: *"If I didn't provide this home, she would be wandering the streets."* * Is she currently wandering the streets? Is the Uncle using this "if" to make himself look like a hero or a villain?
- c) The Uncle says, *"I wish she weren't so jealous."* * Does the Uncle actually care about Atieno's feelings, or is he using this "wish" to complain about her?
- d) In the poem, the Uncle says, *"Since she's my sister's child, Atieno needs no pay."* How does this make you feel? How could you report this opinion using a strong verb like **claimed** or **insisted**?

Activity 9.4.2



Read the notes in the box below then do the exercises that follow

Reported Speech

A) Reporting questions

Use **asked**, **wanted to know**, **wondered** etc.

Yes/No questions

Use **if** or **whether**.

1. Abigail asked, "Do you love me, John?" → Abigail asked John **if he loved her**.
2. Proctor asked, "Have you been waiting for me every night?" → Proctor asked Abigail **whether she had been waiting for him every night**.
3. Abigail said, "Will you come for me again?" → Abigail wanted to know **if John would come for her again**.

Wh-questions

Keep the **question word** (what, why, how, where)

- Proctor asked, "What mischief is here?" → Proctor asked Abigail **what mischief was there**.
- Abigail asked, "Why do you call me child?" → Abigail asked John **why he called her a child**.
- Abigail said, "How can such a strong man let such a sickly wife be?" Abigail asked John **how such a strong man could let such a sickly wife be**.

b) Reporting commands and instructions

We use **told**, **asked**, **ordered**, followed by (not) **to + verb**.

1. "Put it out of mind, Abby." Said Proctor → Proctor told Abigail to put the matter out of her mind.
2. 'Give me a soft word, John,' said Abigail. → Abigail asked Proctor to give her a soft word.

c) Reporting advice and opinions

We often use verbs such as **advised**, **recommended**, **suggested**, **warned**.

Examples:

1. A student said: "Girls should have the same rights as boys." → The student advised that girls should have the same rights as boys.
2. The teacher said: "Do not allow children to work instead of studying." → The teacher warned the learners not to allow children to work instead of studying.
3. A learner said: "We should protect young girls from exploitation." → The learner suggested protecting young girls from exploitation.

D) Reporting Suggestions

We often use verbs such as suggested, proposed + **gerund** or + **that clause**

Examples:

1. "Let's share the household chores," Aline said. → Aline suggested sharing the household chores/ Aline suggested that they should share the household chores.
2. "Why don't boys and girls participate equally in class activities?" the teacher said. → The teacher proposed encouraging equal participation in class activities

E) Reporting Requests

We often use verbs such as asked, requested, begged + **object + to-infinitive**

Examples:

1. "Please allow girls to join the football team," the students said. → The students asked the teacher to allow girls to join the football team.
2. "Could you respect everyone's role at home?" the mother said. → The mother asked the children to respect everyone's role at home.

F) Reporting Advice, Warnings, and Obligation

We often use verbs like advised, warned, urged, reminded + **object + to-infinitive verb**

(+ **object + not to-infinitive**)

Examples:

1. "You should treat boys and girls equally," the teacher said. → The teacher advised the learners to treat boys and girls equally.
2. "Do not judge people based on gender," the principal said. → The principal warned the students not to judge people based on gender.
3. "Do not forget that everyone deserves respect," she said. → She reminded them not to forget that everyone deserves respect.

G) Reporting Promises, Refusals, and Offers

We often use verbs such as promised, refused, offered, agreed + **to-infinitive**

Examples:

1. "I will support girls' education," the community leader said. → The community leader promised to support girls' education.
2. "I won't accept discrimination in my class," the teacher said. → The teacher refused to accept discrimination in the classroom
3. "Yes, I will share the responsibilities at home," he said. → He agreed to share the responsibilities at home.

H) Reporting Feelings, Thoughts, and Opinions

We often use verbs like thought, believed, felt, claimed, admitted, explained, insisted + **that-clause**

Examples:

1. "Girls are capable of becoming leaders," the teacher said. → The teacher believed that girls were capable of becoming leaders.
2. "It was unfair to exclude girls from the discussion," he said. → He admitted that it had been unfair to exclude girls from the discussion.
3. "Everyone should have equal opportunities," she said. → She insisted that everyone should have equal opportunities.

I. Change into reported speech

1. A learner said, "**Atieno works all day.**"
2. A student said, "**Girls should go to school.**"
3. The teacher asked, "**Why is Atieno working instead of studying?**"
4. A student said, "**Children deserve protection.**"
5. A learner said, "**Society must stop exploiting young girls.**"

II. Complete the sentences using asked, suggested, advised, explained, warned.

1. The teacher _____ that girls should have equal opportunities.
2. A learner _____ why Atieno was not in school.
3. A student _____ helping vulnerable children in the community.
4. The teacher _____ the learners to respect children's rights.
5. A learner _____ that child labour harms young girls

B. Conditional Sentences (Types 1–3 and Mixed)

Conditional Sentences (Types 1–3) and «If only» / «I wish»

Conditional sentences explore causes, effects, and alternative realities—the very heart of drama and reflection. They link a condition (if-clause) to a result (main clause). "If only" and "I wish" are emotional shortcuts to express these same ideas, particularly regret or longing.

1. Type 1 (Real Possibility): Used for situations that are possible or likely.

a) **Structure:** If + present simple, ... will + infinitive.

b) **Example:** «If Adhiambo speaks up, she **will** get into trouble.»

c) This reflects a possible future consequence.

2. Type 2 (Unreal Present/Future): Used for hypothetical or imaginary situations in the present or future, or for giving advice.

- **Structure:** If + past simple, ... would + infinitive.

- **Example:** «If Atieno **had** money, she **would buy** her own shoes.»

- This imagines a different present. She doesn't have money, so this is a fantasy.

- **"If only" / "I wish" (for Present Regret/Longing):** These express the same idea with more emotion.

- **"If only I had money."** (I don't, and I really want it).

- **"I wish I didn't have to work."** (I do have to work, and I hate it).

3. Type 3 (Unreal Past): Used to imagine a different past and express regret. It's about things that are already decided and cannot be changed.

4. Structure: If + past perfect, ... would have + past participle.

Example: «If the uncle **had paid** Atieno, she **would have received** wages for her work»

This explores a different past. Her mother was not alive, so this is a source of deep regret.

"If only" / "I wish" (for Past Regret): This is the most direct way to express regret.

- **"If only her mother had been alive."**

- **"I wish her mother had not died."**

5. Mixed conditionals

Mixed conditionals combine past conditions with present results.

Structure: If + past perfect → would + verb

Example:

If Atieno had received education, she would be living a different life today.

More examples:

- If society had promoted gender equality earlier, many girls would enjoy better opportunities today.
- If Atieno had been protected as a child, she would feel confident today.

Activity 9.4.3



I. Read the statements about A Freedom Song. Based on the poem's context, choose the correct conditional structure that accurately reflects the reality vs. the hidden meaning.

1. The Uncle justifies his actions by saying Atieno is "family." Which sentence correctly analyses the reality of her situation using a Type 2 Conditional?

- A) If Atieno is his sister's child, she will not need any pay.
- B) If Atieno were treated as a true family member, she would not sleep on sacks in the kitchen.
- C) If Atieno had been his daughter, she would have gone to school.
- D) If Atieno works hard, the wife will sit and sew all day.

2. Look at the "Excerpt from 'A Freedom Song' by Marjorie Oludhe Macgoye" where Atieno is ten years old and still working. Which Mixed Conditional best expresses the long-term impact of the Uncle's choice?

- A) If the Uncle had paid Atieno, she would buy beads today.
- B) If the Uncle provides a bed, Atieno will be happy.
- C) If the Uncle had sent Atieno to school years ago, she would be literate today.
- D) If the Uncle were kind, he would have given her shoes.

3. Evaluate the "I wish" structure. Which of these expresses a past regret regarding Atieno's mother?

- A) I wish Atieno has a better life than her mother.
- B) If only the uncle had paid Atieno, the girl wouldn't have been exploited.
- C) I wish the Uncle were more responsible for his niece.
- D) If only Atieno doesn't have to pluck the chickens every morning.

II. Atieno is ten years old now. She dreams of a different life. Complete her thoughts using "I wish" or "If only" based on the cues.

- 1. (She doesn't go to school.) I wish _____.
- 2. (The children she minds have pretty dresses and shoes.) If only _____.
- 3. (She is treated like a servant, not family.) I wish my aunt _____.
- 4. (She imagines what would have happened if her parents hadn't died.) If only my parents _____.

Application activity 9.4



Read the paragraph below. Then, report what each person said by choosing the most accurate reporting verb for their specific intent.

"During the Gender Equality Forum, the **Head Girl, Aline**, stood up and said, 'Let's organize a mixed-gender sports tournament to build teamwork.' The **School Captain, Eric**, immediately shook his head and declared, 'I will not play if the rules include mixed teams.' The **Principal** walked to the microphone and stated, 'You must respect every student's right to participate in school activities.' Finally, the **local representative** added, 'I truly believe that the future of our community depends on how we treat our daughters today.'"

9.5 Literature

Drama Writing Techniques

Drama is a form of literature written to be **performed on stage**. It presents a story through **dialogue, actions, and stage directions** rather than long narration. In drama, writers use characters, conflict, and dramatic techniques to communicate important messages to the audience.

Elements of a Script

Learning activities 9.5

Activity 9.5.1



Read the following paragraph and discuss the question there below

Imagine that a group of students want to turn the story of Atieno from the poem into a **short play**. They decide to include characters such as Atieno, her aunt, and a neighbor. The story will show how Atieno works hard at home and how someone suggests that she should have the opportunity to go to school. **Dramatic techniques** help make a play interesting and meaningful

Questions

1. Who would be the **main characters** in this play?
2. Where might the events of the play take place?
3. What message could the play communicate about **fair treatment and opportunities**?

1. Elements of a Script

A **script** is the written text of a play. It includes several important elements:

Title – the name of the play.

Characters – the people or roles in the story.

Dialogue – the spoken words of the characters.

Stage directions – instructions that describe movements, emotions, or actions of characters.

Example:

Atieno: (sadly) I work all day, but I wish I could go to school.

2. Plot Structure, Setting, and Conflict

Plot – the sequence of events in a story.

A typical plot includes:

- **Beginning** – introduces characters and setting
- **Middle** – shows the main conflict or problem
- **Ending** – resolves the conflict

Setting – the place and time where the story happens.

Conflict – the main problem or struggle faced by the characters.

Example:

Conflict: Atieno works all day and cannot attend school.

Activity 9.5.2



Read the following paragraph and discuss the questions below:

Title: *A Chance for Atieno*

Atieno: (tired) I have washed the dishes and cleaned the kitchen.

Neighbor: (kindly) Atieno, children should have the chance to study.

Questions:

1. What is the **title** of the play?
2. Who are the **characters**?
3. Which sentence shows **stage directions**?
4. Which words or stage directions show a character's feelings or emotions?

Application activity 9.5



Create a short dramatic scene (6–8 lines) based on Atieno's story that includes:

- a) a title
- b) two or three characters
- c) a clear **setting**
- d) a **conflict** related to unequal opportunities
- e) a **solution promoting fairness and empowerment**

9.6. End of Unit Assessment

End of unit assessment



SECTION A: Reading Comprehension

Read the extract below carefully and answer the questions that follow.

Extract

Abigail: Give me a word, John. A soft word.

Proctor: No, no, Abby. That's done with.

Abigail: You came five miles to see a silly girl fly? I know you better.

Proctor: I came to see what mischief your uncle's brewin' now. Put it out of mind, Abby.

Abigail: John—I am waiting for you every night.

Proctor: Abby, I never gave you hope to wait for me.

Abigail: I know how you clutched my back behind your house and sweated like a stallion whenever I came near! Or did I dream it?

Proctor: Abby, that's a wild thing to say.

Abigail: I've seen you since she put me out. I saw your face when she did, and you loved me then and you do now!

Proctor: Abby, I may think of you softly from time to time. But I'll cut off my hand before I'll ever reach for you again.

Questions

1. Who are the two main characters speaking in the extract?
2. What does Abigail ask from John Proctor?
3. Why does Proctor say he came to Salem?
4. What do Abigail's words reveal about her feelings toward Proctor?
5. Why does Proctor insist that Abigail should forget about their past relationship?

6. Do you think Proctor's decision to end the relationship is responsible? Explain your answer.
7. What message about respect and responsibility in relationships can be learned from this dialogue?

SECTION B: Vocabulary

Using the extract, explain the meaning of the following words as used in the text.

- a) Mischief
- b) Wild
- c) Hope
- d) Soft word

SECTION C

1. Read the following exchange from a dramatic script:

1. Chief: "If you leave this village to find work in the city, do not expect to come back to your lands."
2. Student Report: "The Chief said that if I left the village, I couldn't come back."

Question:

Which reporting verb would more accurately capture the **tone** and **authority** of the Chief, and how does changing "said" to "**warned**" or "**threatened**" alter the listener's perception of the conflict?

2. In *A Freedom Song*, the Uncle says: "Atieno's sly and jealous... wants their dresses, shoes and beads." If a social worker reports this by saying, "**The Uncle claimed that Atieno was envious of his children's possessions,**" what does the word "**claimed**" suggest about the social worker's belief in the Uncle's honesty?

- A) The social worker fully believes the Uncle.
- B) The social worker is neutral and has no opinion.
- C) The social worker doubts the Uncle's description of Atieno.
- D) The social worker is confused by the Uncle's statement.

3. Analyse the following reported question: "*The inspector asked why did the girl sleep in the kitchen.*"

Question: Identify the grammatical error in this sentence and rewrite it correctly. Then, explain why the "question word order" must be removed when moving from direct to reported speech.

4. Contrast these two reports:

- *Report A:* The teacher **suggested** that the girls should join the debate team.
- *Report B:* The teacher **urged** the girls to join the debate team.

Question: In a society where girls are often discouraged from speaking out, which reporting verb (suggested or urged) implies a stronger sense of **responsibility** and **advocacy** from the teacher? Justify your answer.

5. A character in a play says: *"I am so sorry I forgot your birthday! I will buy you the biggest cake tomorrow, I promise!"*

Question: Write a one-sentence report of this dialogue that incorporates both the character's **feeling** (apology) and their **commitment** (promise) without using the word "said."

- "If the community **had invested** in a local school ten years ago, Atieno **would not be** working as a domestic servant today."

Question: Explain the relationship between the two parts of this sentence. Does the sentence imply that it is still possible to change Atieno's childhood? Why is a **Mixed Conditional** more effective here than a standard Type 3?

- Compare these two "wish" structures:

1. *Sentence A:* I wish Atieno **had** a bed to sleep on.

2. *Sentence B:* I wish Atieno **had had** a bed to sleep on when she was eight.

Question: Which sentence expresses **current dissatisfaction** with her living conditions, and which expresses **regret** about a past that is already over? How does the change in tense shift the "mood" of the speaker?

- a) "If everyone **treated** domestic workers with dignity, laws for their protection **would be** unnecessary."

Question: Is this sentence describing a **real possibility** (Type 1) or a **hypothetical ideal** (Type 2)? Based on the themes in *A Freedom Song*, why would the author likely use Type 2 to describe this situation?

- b) A character says: *"If I report my boss for unfair treatment, I will lose my job."*

Question: If the character changes this to: *"If I reported my boss, I would lose my job,"* how does the speaker's **level of certainty** about taking action change? Which sentence sounds like a "plan," and which sounds like a "fearful thought"?

5. At the end of *The Odyssey*, a suitor might say: *"We died because we were greedy."*

Question: Rewrite this realization using an **"If only"** structure (Type 3) to express deep, tragic regret. Then, explain how this grammatical structure emphasizes the **finality** of their mistake.

SECTION D: Literature – Drama

- a) What is **conflict** in a dramatic text?
- b) Identify the **conflict** between Abigail and Proctor in the extract.
- c) Name two **elements of a dramatic script**.
- d) What **theme** can be identified from this dialogue?

SECTION E: Writing

Write a short paragraph (6–8 sentences) on the topic:

"Why Respect and Equal Opportunities Are Important in Relationships and Society."

Your paragraph should include:

- a) one example of unfair treatment
- b) one suggestion to promote equality and respect.

SECTION F: Speaking (Oral Assessment)

Prepare a **short speech (1–2 minutes)** on the topic:

"How Young People Can Promote Gender Equity and Empowerment."

Your speech should include:

- the meaning of gender equity
- one example of unequal treatment
- one suggestion to promote fairness in society.